

БОЛКОВА А.А.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING COUNTRIES

Новосибирск
2014

МИНИСТЕРСТВО ОБРАЗОВАНИЯ И НАУКИ РФ
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Пособие предназначено для самостоятельной работы студентов первого курса всех направлений и специальностей университетов. Цель пособия - развитие навыков работы с адаптированной и неадаптированной художественной и научно-популярной литературой. Оно может быть использовано также для дополнительного общеразвивающего и дополнительного профессионального образования. Курс построен в соответствии с технологией разноуровневого обучения.

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INTRODUCTION

Данное учебное пособие представляет собой практикум по обучению чтению и страноведению студентов неязыковых программ. Цель пособия - развитие навыков работы с адаптированной и неадаптированной художественной и научно-популярной литературой. Пособие направлено на формирование профессиональной иноязычной компетентности, включающей все виды речевой деятельности: чтение (просмотровое, ознакомительное, поисковое, аналитическое с опорой на аутентичность материалов; тексты бытовой, общекультурной, страноведческой направленности; аудирование (аудиоматериал озвучен носителем языка); письмо: практические рекомендации и клише для написания аннотации, реферата, сообщения; алгоритмы обучения студентов разным видам чтения; клише для ведения дискуссии; говорение: обучение ведению беседы на профессиональные темы, умению сделать сообщение, доклад, презентация, выступление (практические рекомендации, клише), а также формирование коммуникативной компетенции.

Пособие содержит интересный материал, максимально приближенный к реалиям жизни и быта англоязычных стран. Это оригинальные тексты об англоязычных странах, их природе, культуре, достопримечательностях, о системе образования, о знаменитых художниках, композиторах, государственных деятелях, спортсменах, знаменитых людях, рассказы известных английских и американских авторов, главы из произведений художественной, страноведческой английской, американской и австралийской литературы. Каждый отрывок из произведений классической и современной литературы предваряется краткой информацией об авторе.

Пособие предназначено для самостоятельной работы студентов первого курса всех образовательных программ университетов. Оно может быть использовано также для повышения квалификации слушателей дополнительного общеразвивающего и дополнительного профессионального образования.

Материал курса разделён на три части: Module I Reader и Module II English-Speaking Countries, Module III Методические рекомендации по самостоятельной работе.

Module I Reader включает в себя адаптированные тексты для чтения уровня Elementary, адаптированные и неадаптированные главы из произведений зарубежных авторов для уровня Pre-Intermediate, главы из произведений зарубежных авторов для чтения и обсуждения для уровня Intermediate. Цель раздела – способствовать расширению и обогащению словарного запаса и более тонкому и глубокому пониманию нюансов английской речи.

Цель раздела Texts for Discussion обучить студентов обсуждать выдвинутую проблему, т.е. уметь изложить свою точку зрения и отстоять её, уметь выразить согласие и несогласие с говорящим, выразить сомнение, сожаление по поводу сказанного, дополнить, уточнить выступление и подвести итог дискуссии. Module III включает методические рекомендации по обучению дискуссии и необходимые клише.

Module II English-Speaking Countries представляет собой статьи по истории, географии, политическому устройству, системе образования, культуре и искусству англоязычных стран.

Module III дает студентам алгоритмы работы с текстами для чтения, словарями, новой лексикой, клише для анализа текста.

В приложение вынесены фонды контроля - тесты и вопросы для самопроверки с ключами.

Глоссарий, представляющий собой словарь терминов с объяснением их значений на английском языке, поможет в работе с книгой.

В основу данной работы положен дифференцированный подход, Пособие реализует дидактические принципы систематичности, последовательности, доступности и посильности, решает проблему обучения студентов работе с литературой и знакомит с культурой стран изучаемого языка, способствует расширению социокультурного кругозора студентов.

MODULE I READER

Part I READER FOR ELEMENTARY STUDENTS **Some interesting things to read** Text 1 **Funny stories**

1.

A friend of mine who lives in England decided to go over to France for a trip. When he returned I asked him how he liked it. "Terrible," was the answer. "I couldn't get a nice cup of tea anywhere. Thank goodness I'm back." I asked him, "Didn't you have any good food while you were there?" "Oh, the dinners were all right," he said. "I found a little place where they made quite good fish and chips. Not as good as ours, but they were eatable. But the breakfasts were terrible: no bacon or porridge. I had fried eggs and bacon but it took them too long to make them. They gave me rolls. And when I asked for marmalade, they brought strawberry jam. And you know, they said it was marmalade?" "But didn't you eat any of the famous French food?"

"What? Me? Of course not! Give me good old English food every time! None of these fancy bits for me!"

2. An Expensive Breakfast

Once the king of a small country was travelling about Holland. He stopped at an inn in a little village to have breakfast. He ordered some boiled eggs, coffee, bread and butter for breakfast.

The king ate two eggs with bread and butter, took a cup of coffee and asked the innkeeper, "How much must I pay for my breakfast?" The innkeeper answered: "A hundred florins."

The king was very much surprised and said, "What? A hundred florins for a little bread and butter, a cup of coffee and two eggs? It is very expensive! Are eggs scarce in your village?"

"No, sir," answered the innkeeper, "there are a lot of eggs in our village, but kings are very scarce nowadays."

3. Two Americans were travelling in Spain. One morning they came into a little restaurant for lunch. They did not know Spanish and their waiter did not know English. They wanted him to understand that they wanted some milk and sandwiches. So one of them took a piece of paper and began to draw a cow. He was finishing his drawing, when the waiter looked at it and ran out of the restaurant. He was back again soon, but he brought no milk. He put down in front of the two men two tickets for a bull fight.

4. Once a young Englishman invited his girlfriend to a French restaurant. The menu was written in French and he did not know French. As he did not want to look ignorant before the girl, he pointed to some lines in the menu and said to the waiter, "I think, we shall have some of that." The waiter looked where the man was showing and said, "I'm sorry, sir, but that's what the band is playing."

A Parrot

5. A man had a speaking parrot. But the parrot could only say one phrase. The phrase was, "There is no doubt about it". The man got tired of the parrot and decided to sell it. He took the parrot to the market in the cage and shouted, "Who wants my speaking parrot, twenty pounds for my parrot!"

A man who was walking by and heard these words came up to the cage and asked, "Parrot, are you really so clever that you cost twenty pounds?" "There is no doubt about it!" said the parrot.

The man liked the answer so much that he paid for the parrot and brought him home. But time passed and the parrot never said anything else. The man came up to the cage one day and said, "What a fool I was when I bought you once at twenty pounds!" "There is no doubt about it," said the parrot.

There is no doubt about it.- Несомненно (Можете не сомневаться).

44-74Text 2

How To Be Fit

Hello. Our program today is called "How To Be Fit". The whole world admires the beautiful models and film stars you so often see on TV. They are tall, slim, long-legged. You see them and you want to look like them.

But do you know how to do it? The problem is that people eat too much today. Besides, who can refuse a piece of nice sweet cake or a cup of sweet chocolate? Some people can. Our guest today is the famous Linda Martin, a film star. She will tell you how she keeps fit.

"Hello. My name is Linda Martin. Let me tell you a few important things about my life. I don't get up very early but I begin my day with exercises. I go out and run about my house twenty times. Then I get hungry and have breakfast. I have a big glass of orange juice and then a cup of coffee. At about one I have my lunch. At lunch I eat a lot of vegetables: cabbage, carrots, peas, fresh cucumbers, a piece of rye bread and a cup of tea without sugar, of course. Sometimes I don't have any lunch at all if I'm at work. I don't like to have meals in public places. I sometimes have dinner in the evening when I'm hungry or when I have guests at home. I don't like to receive guests because we usually eat a lot of meat and fish and other heavy things which don't help you to be fit. My motto is 'Eat to live, but not live to eat.' And, dear ladies, always remember you are as old as you look. That's why I have always played only young girls".

Text 3

University Life in England

The University of Oxford is a collection of colleges. Some of these colleges were founded hundreds of years ago. The University is only an administrative centre which arranges lectures for all the students of the colleges, holds examinations and gives degrees.

Every college has students of all kinds; it has its medical students, its engineers, its art students, etc.

The Tutorial system is one of the ways in which Oxford and Cambridge differ from all other English universities. Every student has a tutor who plans his work. Each week some students come to see him and he discusses with them the work which they have done. This system has its advantages.

The academic year in England is divided into three terms, which usually run from about the beginning of October to the middle of December, from the middle of January to the end of March and from the middle of April to the end of June or the beginning of July.

Terminal examinations are held at the end of the autumn, spring and summer terms. Final examinations are taken at the end of the course of studies. If a student fails in an examination he may be allowed to take the exam again. Only two reexaminations are usually allowed. For a break of

discipline a student can be fined a sum of money, for a serious offence he may be expelled from the university.

British universities usually keep to the customs of the past. Upon graduation at Oxford University all the students have to wear long black gowns and "students' leaps".

Text 4

In the American College / University

The period of study in an American college or University is four years. Each year comprises two terms or semesters. The first, fall term, usually begins the last week of August and continues until the middle of December with approximately four weeks intermission for the Christmas holidays. The second semester begins in January and continues until the end of May. The students are usually given three to five days for the Easter holidays. In addition to the regular academic year, many colleges offer courses of study during the summer months. These sessions are attended by students who are interested in making up coursework or by those who would like to accelerate their program. The average student is expected to take 15 or 16 credits each semester. In this way he may earn 32 credits during the academic year. When the student has accumulated more than 30 credits he passes to the next class and becomes a second-year student or sophomore. After a student has successfully completed four years of study and acquired 124 or 150 credits he becomes a candidate for the degree of Bachelor of Arts or Bachelor of Science and is ready for graduation.

Text 5

Australian English

My name is Susan Butler and I am Publisher for "The Macquarie Dictionary" publishing company. I have been working on the dictionary since it first started in 1970. The Macquarie Dictionary was first published in 1981. It is recognised as the national dictionary of Australian English. What makes Australian English different from other Englishes of the world? Well — its history for a start. When the British government established a convict settlement at Sydney Cove they did not think about the linguistic consequences. As time went by, the convicts and settlers took English and adapted it to their new home by changing the meaning of

words or borrowing new ones to suit. An easy way for English to expand in Australia to meet the needs of the settlers was to borrow from the Aboriginal languages, particularly in describing the flora and fauna. Some animals were named this way, such as, the kangaroo, koala and wombat. The kookaburra, a popular Australian bird that sounds like a human laughing, was also named this way.

If you visit Australia you might notice that there are differences between the older generation and the younger generation, and between the people who live in the city and those who live in the bush (country). It seems that the younger generation living in the cities tend to take their fashionable colloquialisms from America.

It is noticeable that, despite the size of Australia, everyone sounds the same. Our spelling on the whole reflects our British tradition but we are increasingly influenced by American English. We have ended up somewhere between the two. We spell colour as color or colour, but surprisingly we spell metre as metre, not meter.

Text 6

American Customs

Americans are very punctual. It is important to be on time at business, social and public events. If you must miss an appointment for any reason, telephone ahead to the person you were supposed to meet, saying that you won't be able to come.

When you are invited to a home where food will be served it is best to let your host or hostess know in advance if you are on a diet. It is all right, however, to say, "No, thank you," if you would rather not eat or drink what is being served. No further explanation is needed, but if you would like to explain, people are interested.

In some homes the atmosphere is quite formal. In others, it is informal and you may sit at the kitchen table to eat dinner. Informality is a way of taking you into the warmth of the family circle.

It is not always customary to sit at a dinner table as we do in Russia. When you are at a party you may be walking from one sitting-room to another, talking to the guests with a glass of wine in your hand. Food is served in one of the rooms and you can help yourself to whatever you like and whenever you liked.

The Americans may have a party on one occasion in several houses at a time. The party starts in one house where they have some light wine and snacks, and then move on to another house and still another, travelling

from house to house, taking drinks and food with them; and previous arrangements are made about what food each family cooks. Normally three or four houses are involved. Such a party is called progressive dinner.

Generally Americans tend to be fairly informal. They often (but not always) address each other by their given names on first meetings. They also tend to abbreviate a lot. For example, Mass. Ave. means Massachusetts Avenue. Do not be surprised and ask what these abbreviations mean.

New Year's Day has traditionally been the occasion for starting new programs and giving up bad habits. People talk about "turning over a new leaf." Many Americans make New Year's resolutions, promising themselves and their families to improve their behaviour. Typical New Year's resolutions are to spend less money, give up smoking, begin a diet, or control one's temper. To Americans the closing of one calendar year and the opening of another is a serious, yet happy occasion.

Text 7

Afternoon tea

It's believed that the habit of drinking afternoon tea at five o'clock became widespread in the middle of the 19th century throughout the upper class of English society because dinner, which had previously been taken during the day, was being moved closer to the evening as result of the upper class rituals becoming increasingly complicated. Anna, the 7th Duchess of Bedford is often credited with the invention of the tradition of afternoon tea in the early 18-10's. Traditionally dinner was not served until 8:30 or 9:00 in the evening and the Duchess often became hungry, especially in the summer when dinner was served even later. She ordered a small meal of bread, butter, and other niceties, such as cakes, tarts, and biscuits, to be brought secretly to her boudoir. When she was exposed she was not ridiculed, as she had feared, but her habit caught on and the concept of a small meal, of niceties and perhaps tea, became popular and eventually known as 'afternoon tea'. Obviously the origins of the well-known British tradition of afternoon tea cannot be credited only to one woman, but evolved over a period of time, as many cultural customs do.

Text 8

Enrico Caruso

The famous Italian singer Enrico Caruso sang in many countries of Europe. He visited Russia, France, Germany, Spain and many other countries. Everywhere he was a great success and his name was well known all over the world. Caruso knew that he was famous, but he liked to repeat the sentence: "No man is so well known as he thinks he is".

Once he was invited to the USA to give some concerts. When he was driving to New York, his car broke down and he had to stay at a farmhouse. Caruso could not repair his car and asked the farmer to help him. The farmer agreed to do it. While the farmer was repairing the car, Caruso was invited into the house to have a rest. When the farmer finished the work, he entered the house, too. He informed the great singer that his car was ready and he could drive on. Caruso was very glad to hear it. He paid the farmer for the work and gave him a photo. It was a picture of Enrico Caruso. On the back side of the photo Caruso wrote his name. He thought it would be pleasant for the farmer to have a picture of the famous singer. The farmer took the picture, looked at it very attentively, then he looked at Enrico Caruso. He realized that it was the picture of the man whose car he had repaired. He wanted to know the name of the man, so he read what was written on the back side of the picture. After that he cried out: "How lucky I am! You are Robinson Crusoe! I've never dreamed of receiving the greatest traveller in the world in my poor house!"

Text 9

They Followed His Advice

The name of George Bernard Shaw, the famous English playwright, is very popular both in Great Britain and in many other countries. His plays are often staged in various countries. His plays are always a great success. B. Shaw is also famous for his gift of wit. There are many stories about B. Shaw in which his gift of wit is demonstrated. B. Shaw was also brave and honest. He was never afraid to tell the truth. Here is a story illustrating it. Once B. Shaw was invited to a party. When he arrived he saw many famous people among the guests. There were many scientists, composers, writers and public figures. The guests were treated to a very delicious dinner. They talked a lot. Some of them tried to make speeches. The only person who kept silent was B. Shaw. He listened to all those present but he didn't say a word. Everybody knew that B. Shaw was very good at making short and witty speeches. Therefore he was asked to say something. He agreed to make a speech and stood up. The guests stopped talking and looked at the famous playwright. He said that among all those

present he knew at least twenty well-known men who were corrupt. He added that he could prove it. Many of the guests expressed their protest and left the party. B. Shaw sent a letter to each of the twenty men. All the letters were alike: "Everything has come out. Get away quickly". They received the letters and followed B. Shaw's advice.

Text 10

A Sad Story

Three men came to New York for a holiday. They came to a very large hotel and took a room there. Their room was on the forty-fifth floor. In the evening the young men went to the cinema. When the film was over, they went to a restaurant and had supper there. They came back to the hotel very late. "I am very sorry", said the clerk of the hotel, "but our lifts do not work at night. If you don't want to walk up to your room, you can sleep in the hall". "No, no", said one of the three men, "no, thank you. We shall walk to our room". Then he said to his friends, "I think I know how to make it easy for us to walk up to the forty-fifth floor. On our way to the room I'll tell you some jokes, then you, Peter, will tell us some interesting stories". So they began to walk up to their room. At last they came to the thirty-fourth floor. They were very tired by that time, and they decided to have a rest. "Well", said Tom, "now it is your turn, Peter. Tell us a story with a sad end". "I'll tell you a story", said Peter. "It will not be long, but it will be sad enough. Listen. We have left the key to our room in the hall downstairs".

Text 11

What His Life Was Worth

Robert Burns, the great Scottish poet, loved common people and wrote for them. Though he had little formal education, he was well-read and talented. He began to be recognized as a poet when his first poems were published in 1786. He was known as a very witty man. One day when Burns was walking near the docks, he heard a cry for help. He ran towards the water. At that moment he saw a young sailor jump off a boat that stood near the dock. The sailor began to swim towards the man who was calling for help. Though it was not easy, the sailor saved the man. The man who was saved from drowning was a very rich merchant. He thanked the brave sailor and gave him a shilling. The sailor was embarrassed. A large crowd of people gathered round them. All the people considered the sailor to be a hero. They were displeased when the rich man gave the brave

soldier only a shilling. Many of the people shouted loudly and protested against it. But the rich merchant did not pay any attention to them. At the moment Robert Burns approached the crowd and wondered what the matter was. He was told the whole story. He was not surprised at the behavior of the rich merchant and said: "Let him alone. The gentleman is the best judge of what his life is worth".

Text 12

Global Rock Challenge

Australian entrepreneur, Peter Sjoquist, recently captivated an audience with his Global Rock Challenge presentation. Speaking about the success of an idea which started 16 years ago in Australia and is now used in New Zealand, Fiji, Great Britain and the USA, Peter said, "Rock Challenge is designed to link teenagers around the world in a commonality of purpose, and respect for themselves and for others."

Rock Challenge is a friendly competition between secondary age kids, providing students with an opportunity to produce a piece of live entertainment set to music. The students are encouraged to express their creativity through song and dance. In Australia, Rock Challenge attracts 50,000 competitors each year. The final competition is shown on prime-time television.

Anyone taking part in a production or in the audience has to agree not to smoke, take drugs or drink alcohol throughout the competition. One student said, "It is brilliant. It definitely shows that you can have a good time without taking drugs. I have friends who have given up smoking just so they can take part. "Rock Challenge is all about working together, working with friends, parents, police officers, teachers, the media and entertainment professionals. The motto for Rock Challenge is: "Winning is great. Being in it is better."

Famous People of English-Speaking Countries

Text 13

Politicians and Great People Harriet Tubman

Harriet Tubman was born into slavery in 1821 and began working in a field at an early age. She was illiterate. That means she never learned how to read or write. Tubman escaped to the North in 1849 and then returned to the South to help lead more than 300 slaves to freedom. She continued to work for the equal rights of black people until the day she died in 1913.

Abraham Lincoln (1809-1865)

The life story of the sixteenth president of the United States is famous, because it has become the typical story of American success. Abraham Lincoln was born in a log cabin to a poor family and grew up to become the President of the United States. He only attended school for a total of about one year. With the help of his stepmother he taught himself how to read and write.

Abraham Lincoln is well-known and loved by Americans for his honesty, intelligence, and humanity. When Lincoln was elected president in 1860, the question of slavery had become the most controversial national issue. Lincoln strongly opposed slavery. About six weeks after his inauguration, the American Civil War began. The Civil War was a war between the North and the South over the issue of slavery. In 1863, Lincoln issued the Emancipation Proclamation, giving political freedom to three million blacks living in the South. The Proclamation restored the anti-slavery clause which had been cut from the Declaration of Independence. Abraham Lincoln was assassinated by John Wilkes Booth, a popular young actor, during a theater performance at Ford's Theater in Washington, D.C.

Princess Diana

Princess Diana was born in 1961, into a very wealthy and aristocratic family. Her ancestors acquired the title of earl from king Charles I in the 17th century. For the next three centuries they felt comfortable at the royal court, holding various positions and bearing various titles. In 1980 Diana appeared on the world stage as the future bride of Charles, the next king of England. They married on July 29, 1981 in St. Paul's Cathedral in London. Even though they had two children, William and Harry, Diana and Charles soon became unhappy together.

As a single woman Diana put all of her energy into her two sons and her charity work. In 1997 she started a romance with Dodi Fayed, son of the owner of Harrods. Soon after the two were tragically killed in a car

crash in Paris. She was a very English Rose, whose early death stunned a nation into silence.

Text 14

Sportsmen

David Robert Joseph Beckham

David Robert Joseph Beckham OBE, /ˈdævɪd ˈbeɪkəm/ (born 2 May 1975) is an English former footballer. He has played for Manchester United, Preston North End, Real Madrid, Milan, Los Angeles Galaxy, Paris Saint-Germain and is captain of both Manchester and England. Fans love Beckham and call him the "Golden Boy of English Football". He is also famous for his hairstyles.... Beckham is married to Victoria Adams - one of the Spice Girls. They have two sons Brooklyn and Romeo, and they are favourite stars of the British press. The Beckhams live in Cheshire, not too far away from Manchester United's home ground.

Michael Jordan

Michael Jordan is one of the best players in the history of basketball. He was born on February 17, 1963 in Brooklyn, New York. As a teenager, Michael hated losing. However, he always spent a lot of time playing basketball. When he understood he was good at the game, it became his dream. He did not want to have an ordinary life. Journalists asked him once and he answered: "I did not want to have an eight to five job. I wanted something else".

In 1984 he started his career in the NBA as a Chicago Bulls player. He did not play for three seasons from 1998-99 through 2000-01, but returned to play the game he loves with the Washington Wizards in 2001. Michael Jordan is not only famous as a basketball player. In 1996 he starred in the film called "Space Jam". Although "Air Jordan" is one of the most popular sportsmen on earth, he is still shy and friendly. He and his wife Juanita have three children: Jeff, Marcus and Jasmine, who love playing basketball with their father.

Text 15

British Artists

William Hogarth

William Hogarth (1697-1764) is one of the greatest English painters. In his pictures he reflected social life and in many of them the beauty of his painting was accompanied by satire. The "Marriage-a-la-Mode", "The Election Entertainment" were painted to show the life very satirically. In 1742 Hogarth painted "The Graham Children" where he brilliantly used his delicate colours to show the charm of childhood.

John Constable

John Constable (1776-1837) was fond of the place where he was born and spent his childhood on the river Stour. He saw very beautiful woods, greens in nature and, being very talented, reflected nature's colours in his sketches which he then composed into pictures. He painted the landscape without any changes and the trees or other objects were in his paintings very true to life. He is said to be the first landscape painter in England.

William Turner

William Turner (1775-1851) began his activity in art as a watercolour master. Light and atmosphere were his characteristic feature. Turner is a super colourist. In 1805 he painted "The Shipwreck". He showed a terrible disaster at sea. Green was a colour that Turner particularly disliked. In "Snow Storm" he reflected with the help of snow the idea of survival and even in our days it looks very prophetic. It is considered one of his most original paintings. He studies colour very seriously and is said to anticipate the art of Impressionists and abstract painters of the 20th century. In his "Rain, Steam and Speed" (1844) he worked much on the colour interrelation.

Thomas Gainsborough

Thomas Gainsborough (1727-1788). A very lyrical painter who successfully connected man and nature. A very strong psychologist, he painted mostly women on the background of a scenery. He liked blue colours best of all. His portraits are optimistic and the light and shade of colour are in full harmony with the lines. Situated near the Baker Street tube station, these attractions are two of the most popular that London has to offer.

Madame Tussaud

Madame Tussaud first arrived in the capital in 1802 bearing the sculptured heads of executed French aristocrats and ever since "her" wax

models have been pulling in the crowds. The exhibition is split into several sections in which visitors can see replicas of the famous and the infamous from both past and present. Models include politicians like Margaret Thatcher and Lenin, pop stars like the Beatles, and royalty like Prince Charles and Lady Di. Next to Madame Tussaud's you can find the Planetarium which is basically a cosmic theme park. Here you can discover everything you need to know about the universe and there are numerous displays including a 30-minute virtual reality presentation. These fascinating sites are really worth seeing but be prepared to queue and take a full wallet!

Text 16

Musicians

The Beatles

The Beatles were the most famous pop group of the 1960s. Their music was not only popular in Britain, but all over the world. Members of the band were John Lennon, Ringo Starr, George Harrison and Paul McCartney. They were working-class boys from Liverpool. Some well-known songs by the Beatles are "Yesterday", "Strawberry Fields Forever", "Lucy In the Sky With Diamonds" and "Michelle Ma Belle". They also starred in two films, "A Hard Day's Night" in 1964 and "Help!" in 1965. Paul McCartney who used to sing and play bass for the Beatles, established his own group called Wings, which played for ten years. In 1991 he also wrote his first piece of classical music called the Liverpool Oratorio.

Paul's daughter Stella is a top British fashion designer. John Lennon learnt to play harmonica at the age of 12 but he wanted to be a millionaire not a musician. He met Paul McCartney in 1955 and they started the Beatles in 1960. John Lennon was shot in New York outside his own house on December 8, 1980. George Harrison died on November 29, 2001, at the age of 58.

Elvis Presley

Elvis Presley was born in 1935, in East Tupelo, Mississippi. His family was poor. They moved to Memphis, Tennessee in search of better opportunities. What influenced Elvis and his music? First, there was his mother Gladys. For his eleventh birthday, Elvis wanted a rifle. Gladys convinced him to get a guitar. Then, there were the revivals, or religious meetings, he went to. Elvis was influenced by the gospel music sung at these revivals. Finally, there was Memphis. Memphis was a centre for blues music.

Elvis became a truck driver. One day in 1954, he stopped in at the Memphis Recording Studio, and, just for fun, recorded a song. Sam Phillips, the studio head, heard the song and immediately recognized Elvis's potential. He called Elvis back for a real recording session. The session was nearly a disaster. Elvis sang a sentimental country ballad. Phillips was not at all impressed. He heard Elvis and the band fooling around with a blues song called "That's All Right, Mama". Before long, Elvis's first record was made.

Elvis was an instant hit on the radio and soon went on tour. By 1955, Elvis had three songs on the national charts and had signed a contract with RCA.

Teenagers loved Elvis and rock and roll. The music critics of the time, however, were unimpressed. They found Elvis "unspeakably untalented and vulgar" with "no discernible singing ability". Elvis and rock and roll were blamed for the nation's problems. The music was called "criminal", and "a threat to democracy". Yet his popularity only grew.

Elvis's career was interrupted in the late 1950s, when he went into the army. When he came out, at his manager's urging he turned to acting. Most of his films were not very good, but they were financially successful. In 1968 Elvis returned to live performances. But to many people, these performances were like a bad imitation of his former self. Elvis died in 1977, at the age of 42. Was he a failure? The answer — from musicians and fans — is *no*.

The Beatles replaced Elvis in the early 1960s as the most important figures in rock. When asked about Elvis and rock, the Beatles' John Lennon said simply: "Before Elvis there was nothing".

Madonna

Some people say that Madonna is neither a great singer nor a good actress, but millions of fans still admire and love her. She was born in Bay City, Michigan on August 16, 1958 in a family of Italian origin. Her real name was Madonna Louise Ciccone. After the death of her mother she and her three sisters and four brothers were brought up by her father and stepmother. She grew up in Pontiac, Michigan, in the suburbs of Detroit. Madonna began her career as a completely unknown girl singing sweet songs, which quickly caught on and brought her popularity. One of her most famous songs from her earlier period is 'Material Girl', in which the artist imitates the famous film sequence by Marilyn Monroe. Her image often changes. First a girl with long dark hair, she turns into a short haired

blonde. Madonna is also known as an actress. Perhaps her biggest success was playing the leading role in the musical 'Evita', where she co-starred with Antonio Banderas. Today the singer is one of the richest and most powerful celebrities in show business.

Duncan Gifford

23, pianist Duncan Gifford has firmly established himself one of Australia's most talented young musicians. Duncan is in his fifth year at the Moscow Conservatoire, studying in the class of the internationally acclaimed master teacher, Professor Lev Vlassenko. Duncan is the winner of every major Australian piano competition and was named ABC Young Performer of the Year in 1989. Duncan has since embark on a promising international career, winning the Concerto Section of the 198 World Piano Competition (Young Artist Division) in Cincinnati USA. In July 1992 Duncan was placed third in the Sydney International Piano Competition! and in 1996 third in the Montreal International Piano Competition.

Duncan has appeared as soloist with the Sydney, Melbourne and Adelaide Symphony Orchestras, the Australian Chamber Orchestra, the Sydney Youth Orchestra and the Australian Pops Orchestra. He has toured in Europe as soloist with the Australian Youth Orchestra, and has been guest soloist with the Penang and National Symphony Orchestras of Malaysia. He has performed throughout Australia, Asia and the South Pacific, and regularly appears in Moscow and the former Soviet Union. He has broadcast many times on national radio. Duncan's first CD was released in 1993.

Text 17

Writers

William Shakespeare

William Shakespeare was the best and most famous playwright of all time. William Shakespeare was born on 23rd April 1564 in the small town of Stratford. Little is known about his childhood, but there is some evidence to show that he got married when he was 18 and that he had three children. Unfortunately, this is all that history knows about his private life. Around 1592, Shakespeare moved to London where he started writing. During these early years in London he wrote, among others, such plays as "A Midsummer Night's Dream", one of the funniest comedies he ever wrote, and "Romeo and Juliet" - a love story set in the beautiful Italian

town of Verona. One thing is sure, with these and other plays, Shakespeare became England's leading playwright.

Shakespeare was a very prolific playwright and was full of ideas. Between 1604-1605 he wrote the tragedies "Macbeth", "King Lear" and "Othello" which today are considered to be classics. After writing "The Tempest" Shakespeare came back to Stratford where he died on 23rd April 1616, at the age of 52. Although he died so long ago, his works are still read all over the world and are an endless source of inspiration for many contemporary film directors and writers.

George Gordon Byron

Lord George Gordon Byron was born in 1788 and was the most famous English romantic poet. His works were already famous during his lifetime and influenced romantic writers all over Europe. Imaginative and passionate, Byron was able to put into words all the fears and hopes he felt inside. Byron loved travelling, especially in southern countries. He spent the years 1809-1811 in Mediterranean countries, admiring nature, art and women. The result of the trip was "Childe Harold's Pilgrimage", which brought him sudden fame across Europe.

Who was Agatha Christie?

Who was Agatha Christie (1890-1976)? With her 78 crime novels, Agatha Christie has the distinction of being the world's best-selling writer, and "The Mousetrap", one of her 19 plays, has run longer than any other production in the history of the British theatre. Agatha Christie was born in Torquay, a fashionable coastal resort in southwest England, in September 1890. Her father, Frederic Miller, was an American keen on amateur theatricals. Despite her mother's view that no child should be allowed to read until the age of eight, so as not to damage eyes or brain, Agatha managed to find books to read, including Jules Verne's science fiction. She liked devising word and number puzzles. Her formal schooling did not start until she was 13, and two years later she went to France to study history, art, and dancing.

When Mr. Miller died, Agatha's mother fell ill. Advised to seek a warmer climate, she chose Egypt and left for Cairo with Agatha, who was then 20. By the 1970s she was regarded as the queen of mystery writers. She died in 1976 at the age of 85. It is impossible to say exactly how many

of her books have been sold, but it is more than a billion copies in English and another billion in 63 foreign languages. In 1995 her sales were still running at three million a year. She is the most widely published author of any time in any language, being outsold only by The Bible.

Ernest Hemingway

Ernest Hemingway was one of the most famous American novelists and short story writers of the 20th century. Before he started writing literature, he was a journalist, which had an impact on his style of writing. His sentences were short and the vocabulary simple and very accurate, just like in newspapers. This made his books easy to read.

Hemingway's literature was influenced by his experiences: the Civil War in Spain, World War II, and the many trips he made while he lived in Europe. The first one was a background for a best-selling novel "For Whom the Bell Tolls", which brought him enormous popularity. In 1952 Hemingway received a Pulitzer Prize for a short story "The Old Man and the Sea" and two years later he won the Nobel Prize for Literature. Towards the '60s his popularity declined and, troubled by his fading physical and artistic potential, Ernest Hemingway committed suicide in 1961.

Famous Cities of English-Speaking Countries

Text 19

Main Cities of the UK

Glasgow

Glasgow is a city in southwest Scotland. It lies on both sides of the River Clyde. Glasgow is Scotland's main industrial and shipbuilding centre and the third largest city in the United Kingdom. Glasgow's history stretches back a long way. There were probably fishing communities living along the banks of the Clyde as early as the Stone Age. During the early years of the first century AD Celtic tribes, with druids as priests, lived in the area. Glasgow's name is derived from the Celtic *gleschu*, which meant "dear green spot". Glasgow is a city in southwest Scotland. It lies on both sides of the River Clyde. Glasgow is Scotland's main industrial and shipbuilding centre and the third largest city in the United Kingdom.

Brighton

Brighton, on the south coast, is a famous seaside resort. There are entertainments of all kinds. Brighton Pier is a popular place to spend a few hours, especially if the weather is not good enough to stay on the beach. Brighton is also well known as a conference centre, all the major political parties, as well as the Trade Union Congress, may hold their conferences there in autumn.

Canterbury

Canterbury is a town in Kent with a population of about 120,000. It is the religious capital of England because its cathedral is the seat of the Archbishop of Canterbury who is head of the Church of England. From the 12th to the 15th centuries, it was a place of pilgrimage. Thousands of people came to pray at the shrine of a former Archbishop of Canterbury who was murdered in the Cathedral in 1170. His name was Thomas Becket. The best-known Canterbury pilgrims are probably those who appear in the book by Geoffrey Chaucer, "The Canterbury Tales". It was written in the 14th century, when the pilgrimage had become a rather pleasant holiday for the groups of people who travelled together for protection and companionship. "The Canterbury Tales" is a collection of stories told by the members of a group of pilgrims.

Cambridge

Cambridge must be one of the best-known towns in the world. The principal reason for its fame is its University, which started during the 13th century and grew rapidly, until today there are more than twenty colleges. Every year, in summer, thousands of folk music fans arrive in Cambridge for one of the biggest festivals of folk music in England. The festival is held in the grounds of an old house, where there is plenty of room for people to put up their tents if they want to stay overnight.

Birmingham

Birmingham is the most important city in the Midlands, one of England's most productive regions, with large industrial areas such as the Black Country in the West Midlands. However, there is also a lot of farming country, for example in the counties of Shropshire, Worcestershire and Leicestershire. This region has some beautiful countryside in the Peak District National Park, the Cotswold Hills and the Malvern Hills.

There has been a town where **Oxford** now stands for many centuries — even before 912, the first written record of its existence. The University

began to establish itself in the middle of the 12th century, and by 1300 there were already 1,500 students. At this time Oxford was a wealthy town, but by the middle of the 14th century it was poorer, because of a decline in trade and because of the terrible plague, which killed many people in England. Relations between the students and the townspeople were very unfriendly, and there was often fighting in the streets. On 10th February 1355, the festival of St. Scholastica, a battle began which lasted two days. The townspeople were punished for this in two ways: they had to walk through the town to attend a special service on every St. Scholastica's day until 1825.

Main Cities of the USA

Cambridge (the USA)

Just across the Charles River from Boston is Cambridge, America's most famous student town.

Cambridge is sometimes called the birthplace of American intellectual life: it has the nation's oldest university, Harvard University, founded in 1636. Cambridge remains a centre of intellectual life, especially since it's also home of MIT, the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. Harvard has an excellent reputation in many fields; MIT is a leader in science and technology. Students attending Harvard and MIT come from around the world; Harvard alone has students from 90 countries.

Since one-fourth of the people of Cambridge are students, it's not surprising that Cambridge has many bookstores, shops, restaurants, coffee houses and clubs.

A common sight in Cambridge is Harvard oarsmen rowing on the Charles River. The Harvard rowing team spends all year preparing for races in the spring, especially for the Harvard-Yale Regatta. Yale University is Harvard's big rival.

New York

New York attracts people from all over the world. Get on a subway in New York and look at the newspapers that people around you are reading. One person is reading a newspaper in Spanish, another in Chinese, yet others in Arabic, Russian, Italian, Yiddish, and French. New York was always a city of immigrants. It still is.

There are 5 boroughs in New York — **Manhattan, Brooklyn, Queens, the Bronx, and Staten Island.** Brooklyn alone has so many

people that if it were a separate city, it would be the fourth largest in the United States.

Manhattan is an island just 13 miles long and 2 miles wide. It is the centre of American finance, advertising, art, theatre, publishing, fashion — and much more. Manhattan is divided into **the East Side and the West Side**. The dividing line is **Fifth Avenue**.

The Dutch were the first Europeans to settle Manhattan. The Dutch bought Manhattan from the Indians, for the ridiculously low price of 24 dollars worth of beads and trinkets. To protect themselves from attacks, they built a sturdy wooden wall. Although it's now long gone, this wall gave its name to a street in Lower Manhattan and the street, in turn, became synonymous with American capitalism. The street, of course, is Wall Street. The New York Stock Exchange and the American Stock Exchange are both in the Wall Street area.

The Lower East Side was originally an elegant neighbourhood. When New York was the capital of the United States, President George Washington lived on the Lower East Side. Near the Lower East Side there are two other neighborhoods that also attracted immigrants and that are famous for their food. The Italian restaurants of *Little Italy* remain popular to tourists and Italians alike. Today **Chinatown** is the only immigrant community that's still growing. Chinatown has seven newspapers of its own. It also has nearly 200 restaurants.

Greenwich Village and **the East Village** have always been at the centre of New York's excitement. Both have been places for people with different and creative ideas. Both have an active nightlife with plenty of bars, restaurants and clubs.

Many of New York's offices and jobs are in **Midtown**. So are many of its famous skyscrapers.

New York's first skyscraper was **the Flatiron Building**, built in 1902. Twenty stories high, it towered over the other buildings of its time.

The first building boom for skyscrapers came in the late 1920s. The most beautiful and famous of the art deco skyscrapers are **the Chrysler Building and the Empire State Building**. You can go to the top of the Empire State Building, the third tallest building in the world.

Rockefeller Center, built in the 1930s, is the world's largest privately owned business and entertainment centre. Its nineteen buildings include the monumental RCA Building and Radio City Music Hall. In the 1950s, there was a second building boom, featuring a new style. **The United Nations Building** was the first glass curtain wall skyscraper.

Times Square is named after the **New York Times**, which for years had its headquarters there. The New York Times is considered among the best newspapers in the country. Times Square is the beginning of the theatre district **Broadway** has long been the centre of theatre in the United States. In addition to Broadway there are Off-Broadway and Off-Off-Broadway theatres. Plays at these other theatres tend to deal with a wider range of subjects and to be more experimental — some say more interesting — than plays on Broadway. They may involve audience participation — that is, the audience becomes part of the play. And at some Off-Off Broadway plays, you feel like you are part of the play because the theatre is in someone's living room! A definite disadvantage of Broadway plays is the price of tickets.

Central Park. This huge park in the middle of the city was designed in the 1850s as a rural paradise within an urban area, a place for all — rich and poor, young and old. Attractions in the park include gardens, a zoo, a skating rink, and old-fashioned carousel, a lake, and an outdoor theatre, where events are held each summer.

The part of Fifth Avenue along Central Park's east side has so many museums with wonderful art collections that it's called "**Museum Mile**". **The Metropolitan Museum of Art**, with huge collections of art from around the world, may be the most important museum in the United States.

Philadelphia

Philadelphia is the city where the two most important decisions in American history were made. In May, 1775, representatives of the thirteen colonies met in Philadelphia to decide whether to remain with Britain or fight for independence. Fighting had already begun, but many people still hoped for peace with Britain. Finally, more than a year later, on July 4, 1776, the Declaration of Independence was unanimously approved.

When independence was won, the colonies came together, not as a nation, but as a confederation, or a group of states. To prevent tyranny, there was no president and the central government had very little power. Each state had its own army. The states taxed each other's goods. It was almost as if they were separate countries. The result was great confusion. In 1787, representatives from all the states met in Philadelphia to discuss the problems. They soon decided that the confederation could not work and that a new system of government was needed. For this purpose, they wrote the United States Constitution. The Constitution united the states

into one country. For over two hundred years, it has provided the framework for American government. One reason why the Declaration and the Constitution were written in Philadelphia is that in the late 1700s Philadelphia was America's most important city. Philadelphia's importance had much to do with one man — Benjamin Franklin.

Franklin did a lot for Philadelphia — for example, he started a library (the first in the colonies), a fire department, a city hospital, and a school that is now the University of Pennsylvania. Franklin also did a lot for his country. He helped write the Declaration of Independence. During the war, he persuaded the French to aid the colonists. Benjamin Franklin was also a writer, philosopher, scientist, and inventor.

San Francisco (California)

The city of San Francisco was itself a result of the Golden Rush. Forty-niners who went to California by ship passed through San Francisco. Many of them returned to San Francisco — with or without fortunes — to stay. In 1848 San Francisco was a settlement of 200 people. Eight years later it was a city of 50,000. Several times San Francisco was hit by earthquakes. As a result of the 1906 quake three-fourth of the city were burned down. San Francisco is surrounded on three sides by water. It is famous for its bridges, fogs and foghorns. San Francisco has 40 hills. The city has a reputation as an intellectual, liberal, and slightly crazy city — a city where new and different ideas can be explored.

In the mid-1960s, one of the districts of San Francisco gave rise to hippies. The focus was on rock music, drugs like marijuana and LSD, and love and peace. The symbol of San Francisco is the Golden Gate Bridge. This beautiful orange suspension bridge, opened in 1937, goes between San Francisco and Marin County to its north. In 1936, two young engineers, Bill Hewlett and David Packard, went to work in a garage in the valley. They developed an oscillator, an electronic device. Today Santa Clara Valley is the most important centre of America's computer and electronics industry, and Hewlett-Packard is one of its major firms. In the mid-20th century the nation's scientists found that silicon (refined from quartz) can be used in making the electronic switches (transistors) that can control and amplify electrical signals. Digital watches, calculators, and computers were the result. The hub of these industries is the so-called Silicon Valley, which rings San Francisco Bay from Palo Alto to San Jose.

Many manufacturers of chips (slivers of silicon packed with hundreds of thousands of transistors) are located in the area. The chip, computer, and software companies include such names as Apple, Intel, and Hewlett-Packard. These industries thrive, but competition is keen. The talented and creative are lured here. Like Hollywood, Silicon Valley is a piece of California.

Los Angeles

The Los Angeles area has many beaches, with surfers, volleyball players, and people getting tan. The Los Angeles area is also the centre of the movie industry and home to many movie stars. Los Angeles has money and glamour. One thing that Los Angeles seems not to have is a city. It keeps growing, spreading out into farmland and even desert. Los Angeles's growth is supported by its diverse economy. Los Angeles is a centre, not only for entertainment and tourism, but also for manufacturing, business and finance, aerospace and oil. Its ports now handle more cargo than New York.

Los Angeles faces some serious problems. With much traffic, Los Angeles has the dirtiest air in the United States; all too often the sunshine is hidden by smog. Crime and violence are also major problems. Experts emphasize that the problems must be solved if Los Angeles is to maintain the Southern Californian life style for which it's so famous.

Hollywood. By 1910, however, filmmakers began moving there. Southern California's climate was perfect for shooting movies year-round. And the area had settings for just about any movie — it had mountains, desert, and ocean. Soon "Hollywood" came to mean "the American film industry". Today, of the major studios, only Paramount is still in Hollywood.

In Hollywood you can see two great theatres, where many movies premiered: Pantages Theatre and Mann's Chinese.

Australian Main Cities

Australia's people are city dwellers. Less than one third of the population lives outside Australia's cities and towns. These cities and

towns are continuing to grow. More and more of Australia's people are moving away from rural areas into the towns and cities.

Most important among them are: Adelaide, Alice Springs, Brisbane, Darwin, Melbourne, Perth, Sydney, Hobart, Geelong, Newcastle, Townsville, Wollongong.

More than 80 per cent of Australia's population live in the capital cities of the six states (Sydney, Brisbane, Adelaide, Hobart, Melbourne, Perth). Indeed, the two largest of these capital cities, Sydney and Melbourne, contain one third of all of the people on the Australian continent.

Sydney and Melbourne

Sydney and Melbourne are the fourth and fifth largest cities in the Southern Hemisphere. Sydney and Melbourne each have more than three million residents. Both Sydney and Melbourne are modern seaports. Sydney has one of the world's finest natural harbours. Both Sydney and Melbourne have many industries producing goods for local consumption. Their principal exports are the wool, meat, hides, and wheat of the interior.

Sydney is Australia's window into the world — a bright cosmopolitan city with a quick pace of life. Melbourne is Sydney's antithesis; its green trams and wide, tree-lined avenues are symbols of an old-fashioned way of life.

Melbourne is the nation's cultural, financial, and intellectual capital. Melbourne's rivalry with Sydney was the driving force behind the creation of the federal capital compromise, Canberra, built on farmland between the two cities.

Other important Australian cities are: **Brisbane**, the capital of Queensland, famous for its Gold Coast with the coastal playground and Surfers Paradise; **Perth**, the capital of Western Australia, where the sun shines for an average of eight hours a day throughout the year. Then, there is **Adelaide**, the City of Churches which is the capital of South Australia. It is also called Festival City as art, music and enthusiasts all over the world come to its festivals. **Darwin**, the capital of Northern Territory is in "the Outback", it has been reconstructed after a devastating cyclone.

It is here in Northern Territory that one can see one of the world's largest monoliths, Ayers Rock. It is the famous sandstone monolith right in the "Centre" of Australia. A massive 348 metres high and 9 km. around its circumference, the rock has special significance to the Aborigines, and many of its caves are sacred grounds to these people.

The changing colour of the rock is worth an overnight stay. At sunset it can change from burnt red to brilliant orange, to crimson, and finally to delicate purple and blue. At sunrise, it glows with fire. Camel riding is a popular tourist attraction in the Outback.

Melbourne

Take a Ride on the City Circle Tram! You'll enjoy travelling around Melbourne on City Circle Tram. It runs every 10 minutes from 10 a.m. till 6 p.m.

Melbourne is a very multi-cultural city. A quarter of the population was born overseas. It is home to many cultural groups, speaking 170 languages and giving Melbourne a unique character. Melbourne has one of the largest Greek and Italia populations in the world. Melbourne is the acknowledged Culture Capital of Australia, with world-class music, dance, opera, comedy and theatre. So, sit back and enjoy the ride!

The National Gallery of Victoria, established in 1861, is the state art gallery. The Gallery presents exhibitions of historical and contemporary art from within Australia and overseas. This place is worth visiting. The magnificent collection, totalling over 70,000 works, range from paintings, sculpture and photography to decorative arts, prints and drawings.

Opened in 1982, **the Victorian Arts Centre** is known for its superb facilities and its 115 meter webbed steel spire. The Rialto Tower Observation Deck, situated on level 55 of Melbourne's tallest building, provides a panoramic view of Melbourne and the surrounding landmarks.

The Centre houses **the Melbourne Concert Hall, Performing Arts Museum** and three major theatres collectively seating 5,880 people with a revolving stage especially for opera.

Aboriginal Heritage Tours. Don't miss the opportunity to learn about one of the oldest living cultures in the world. Visit Aboriginal tribal lands, meet the people and gain an understanding of traditional beliefs and lifestyle.

Melbourne has one of the most fanatical sporting public in the world. Playing tennis, golf, baseball and football, surfing, water-skiing, boating, yachting, cycling and running are very popular in Melbourne.

Don't forget to visit **the Melbourne Zoo**. Established in 1857, it is one of the oldest zoos in the world. It is home to over 3,000 animals.

Sydney

Sydney is Australia's oldest city. Captain Cook stopped near here at Botany Bay in 1770. The first Europeans who came to Australia put up their tents at Sydney Cove. Soon the first houses were built, and in only 200 years the city grew from nothing into a home for millions of people. Despite the history, Sydney is the most modern place in Australia. Its buildings are the highest, its fashions are the newest and its colours are the brightest. A lot of Australia's exciting cultural life is found in Sydney. Artists, writers, opera singers and film makers all live here. So some people call the city "the Paris of the Pacific." But that doesn't seem quite right. Paris hasn't got all that sea, sand, sun and surf. Sydneysiders, as well as many visitors to Australia, come to Bondi Beach to relax and take a rest. Some of them really relax. Others are too busy —they're jogging, swimming, or riding the great waves on their surfboards.

New Zealand's Main Cities

The majority of New Zealanders (85 percent) live in cities and towns. Early in the 20th century, the "big four" cities — Auckland, Wellington, Christchurch, and Dunedin — shared leadership. 85 percent of the people now live in cities.

Auckland

Auckland is New Zealand's largest city. It is a modern cosmopolitan city with a beautiful, clear harbour where people go boating or swimming many months of the year. It has a population of over a million people. Twenty percent of the population is Maori and Polynesian. It is home to one quarter of the country's inhabitants, the chief industrial, commercial, and international transportation centre. Near Auckland are forests, farms, beaches, thermal pools and geysers, marine reserves and scuba diving locations

Auckland was established in 1840 as the capital of the British colonial government. It was named for George Eden, earl of Auckland, first lord of the admiralty, and, later, governor-general of India. Auckland remained the capital until it was replaced in that role by Wellington. Auckland was officially made a city in 1871. It is the major industrial and commercial port of New Zealand. The port serves overseas and intercostal shipping.

Wellington is the country's second-largest city and a main port. It is situated on the southern coast of North Island. Wellington is the nation's

capital, its administrative centre and the seat of the government with a population less than 200,000 people.

Christchurch is the largest city in the South Island. It is an inland city with an English atmosphere and many parks, gardens and Oxford-style buildings. The water in Christchurch is totally untreated and is supposed to be the purest domestic water supply in the world... Near Christchurch are mountains and ski fields, lakes, hot pools and beaches. It's population is 300,000 people.

Dunedin is the principal city of the Coastal-North Otago district on the southeastern shore of South Island, New Zealand. The second largest city of South Island, it has a population of 110.600. Dunedin was founded in 1848 by Scottish Presbyterians as a Scottish Free church settlement. It was called Dunedin for the Gaelic word for Edinburgh. It is also called the "Edinburgh of the South" and still conveys Scottish values. The discovery of gold in 1861 in central Otago district brought prosperity to the town. During the second half of the 19th century, it was the largest town in New Zealand. Its population today is 116,524.

Canada's Main Cities

Canada's people are city dwellers. Most of the cities are close to the southern border. About one - third of the population (over 8.6 million people) lives in the largest cities of **Toronto** (4.3 million people), **Montreal** (more than 3.3 million people), **and Vancouver**(1.6 million people), **Ottawa-Hull**, the Nations Capital Region (over a million people) and **Edmonton** (less than a million people). The largest urban centers of Canada are found mostly in the southern parts of Ontario and Quebec.

Ottawa, Ontario, the centre of the Ottawa-Hull metropolitan area is the national capital and an emerging centre of high-technology research. **Quebec** is the capital of the province of Quebec (Que.) with a population of about 700,000 people. Like Moscow and St. Petersburg in Russia Montreal and Toronto have been rivals for many years. Montreal, Quebec is a major manufacturing and commercial center, the world's largest French-speaking city outside France. It is the chief seaport of Canada; industrial and financial centre. Toronto is the capital of the province of Ontario and the second largest city in Canada. It is a Lake Ontario port.

Toronto is the country's leading financial and manufacturing centre and one of the most ethnically varied cities in the world; its local government provides services in 70 languages.

Hamilton in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of over 600,000 people is a steel and industrial centre. It is an agricultural market. It has a fine harbour. McMaster University, one of the best universities in Canada is situated here.

London in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of over 400,000 people has a manufacturing industry and agriculture. It uses electric power from Niagara Falls. The University of Western Ontario is situated here.

Windsor in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of 262,075 people is an automobile centre of Canada; it is a busy point of entry from the United States.

Oshawa in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of 240,104 people is a manufacturing centre, General Motors of Canada home site; it has woolen mills; foundries; glass manufacture; pharmaceuticals. **St. Catharines-Niagara Falls** in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of about 400,000 people is a centre of agricultural and industrial production on southern shore of Lake Ontario.

Kitchener in the province of Ontario (Ont.) with a population of about 400,000 people is a financial, transportation and manufacturing centre and a centre of Canada's technology.

Vancouver, British Columbia (over 1.8 million people), is a beautiful, rapidly growing commercial, transportation, and forest-products manufacturing centre. Vancouver is Canada's chief Pacific port; manufacturing centre. It has a considerable Chinese population and a Chinatown. Annual International Festival of the arts is held here.

Edmonton, the capital of the province of Alberta, is a petroleum and farming centre of Canada; gateway to the North. University of Alberta is situated here. Edmonton , is the site of the West Edmonton Mall, one of the world's largest indoor malls.

Calgary (over 800,000 people), in the province of Alberta (Alta.) is an important petroleum city; farm and livestock market; transportation centre.

Winnipeg is the capital of Manitoba (Man.) with a population of about 700,000 people is a major wheat and livestock market; railroad centre.

Halifax in Nova Scotia (N.S.) with a population of over 300,000 people is a seaport and commercial centre of the Atlantic region; there are oil refineries here. **Victoria**, the capital of British Columbia (B.C.) with a population of 287,897 people, is a fish and lumber centre.

From the History of English-Speaking Countries

Text 1

The UK

Britain has not always been an island. It became one only after the end of the last **Ice Age**. The temperature rose and the ice cap melted, flooding the lower lying land that is now under the North Sea and the English Channel. Around 10,000 BC, as the Ice Age drew to a close, Britain was peopled by small groups of hunters, gatherers and fishers. Few had settled homes, and they seemed to have followed herds of deer which provided them with food and clothing. By about 5000 BC Britain had finally become an island, and had also become heavily forested.

About 3000 BC Neolithic (or New Stone Age) people crossed the narrow sea from Europe in small rounded boats of bent wood covered with animal skins. These people kept animals and grew corn crops and knew how to make pottery. They probably came from either the Iberian (Spanish) peninsula or even the North-African coast. They were small, dark, and long-headed people, and may be the forefathers of dark-haired inhabitants of Wales and Cornwall today. They settled in the western parts of Britain and Ireland, from Cornwall at the southwest end of Britain all the way to the far north. These were the first of several waves of invaders before the first arrival of the Romans in 55 BC.

Bronze Age. After 2400 BC new groups of people arrived in southeast Britain from Europe. They were round-headed and strongly built, taller than Neolithic Britons. It is not known whether they invaded by armed force, or whether they were invited by Neolithic Britons because of their military or metal-working skills. Their arrival is marked by first individual graves, furnished with pottery beakers, from which these people get their name: the 'Beaker' people. The Beaker people brought with them from Europe a new cereal, barley, which could grow almost anywhere. They seemed to have brought a single culture to the whole of Britain. They also brought skills to make bronze tools and these began to replace stone ones.

The Celts

Around 700 BC, another group of people began to arrive. Many of them were tall, and had fair or red hair and blue eyes. These were the Celts, who probably came from central Europe or further east, from southern Russia, and had moved slowly westwards in earlier centuries. The Celts were technically advanced. They knew how to work with iron, and could make better weapons than the people who used bronze. It is possible that they drove many of the older inhabitants westwards into Wales, Scotland and Ireland. The Celts began to control all the lowland areas of Britain, and were joined by new arrivals from the European mainland. They continued to arrive in one wave after another over the next seven hundred years.

The Celts are important in British history because they are the ancestors of many of the people in Highland Scotland, Wales, Ireland, and Cornwall today. The Iberian people of Wales and Cornwall took on the new Celtic culture. Celtic languages, which have been continuously used in some areas since that time, are still spoken.

The Celtic tribes continued the same kind of agriculture as the Bronze Age people before them. But their use of iron technology and their introduction of more advanced ploughing methods made it possible for them to farm heavier soils.

The Celtic tribes were ruled by a warrior class, of which the priests, or Druids, were important members. The Druids could not read or write, but they memorized all the religious teachings, the tribal laws, history, medicine and other knowledge necessary in Celtic society. The Druids from different tribes all over Britain probably met once a year. They had no temples, but they met in sacred groves of trees, on certain hills, by rivers or by river sources. We know little of their kind of worship except that they worshipped different gods.

(From An Illustrated History of Britain by D. McDowall)

Caesar Invades Britain

The first day in English history is 55 BC, in which year Julius Caesar (Roman Emperor) landed, like all other successful invaders of these islands, at Thanet.

Julius Caesar advanced very energetically, throwing his cavalry several thousands of paces over the River Flumen; but the Ancient Britons, though all well over military age, painted themselves true blue, or wood, and fought as heroically under their dashing queen, Woadicea, as they did later in thin red lines under their good queen, Victoria. Julius Caesar was therefore compelled to invade Britain again the following year (54 BC, not 56, owing to the peculiar Roman method of counting), and having defeated the Ancient Britons set the memorable Latin sentence, 'Vini, Vidi, Vici', which the Romans, who were all very well educated, construed correctly .

The Britons, however, who of course still used the old pronunciation, understanding him to have called them 'Weeny, Weedy, and Weakly' ('tiny', 'frail', 'weak'), lost heart and gave up the struggle, thinking that lie had already divided them All into Three Parts. (From *1066 and All That* by C.W. Sellar, R.J. Yeatman)

Stonehenge

The word 'henge' is derived from the Gaelic meaning '*a carved stone*'. Stonehenge consists of large solitarily standing carved stones assembled approximately 4000 years ago. According to the investigations it is known today that Stonehenge was built in several stages, between 3000 and 1500 BC.

Nobody knows who built it. According to some theories, it was built by the Druids to practice human sacrifice, according to some other theories - either by the Phoenicians and Greeks or even by the Atlanteans. There are a lot of speculations on the reason why it was built. They include human sacrifice, religious worship or ancient astronomical observatory. People made up a lot of legends about this mysterious archaeological construction. One legend says that once huge giants were dancing in a circle and then suddenly froze into place to create the stone structures; it is also believed that Stonehenge served as an ancient astrological tool that allowed the druids to predict solar or lunar eclipse; that it was an ancient calendar and many others.

PART II

READER FOR PRE-INTERMEDIATE STUDENTS

Louisa May Alcott

Louisa May Alcott was born on November 29, 1832, in Germantown, Pennsylvania. Alcott was taught by her father, Amos Bronson Alcott, teacher, mystic, and writer, until 1848, and studied informally with family friends such as Henry David Thoreau, one of America's most famous writers, Ralph Waldo Emerson, Philosopher, Journalist, Poet and Theodore Parker. Residing in Boston and Concord, Massachusetts, Alcott worked as a domestic servant and teacher, among other positions, to help support her family from 1850 to 1862. During the Civil War, she went to Washington, D.C. to work as a nurse. Alcott was a best-selling novelist of the late 1800s, and many of her works, most notably *Little Women*, remain popular today. Alcott wrote under various pseudonyms and only started using her own name when she was ready to commit to writing. Her novel "Little Women" gave Louisa May Alcott financial independence and a lifetime writing career. She died in 1888.

Little Women

Text 1

Chapter 10

Lazy Days

Summer was a holiday for all the girls. Aunt March had set off for her summer tour, so Jo was free of the old lady for a while. Meg also had a few weeks off from teaching the King children. Amy was only too delighted to be on her school holidays.

"I'm going to lie in bed and do nothing all summer," announced Meg.

"Hum!" said Jo. "I shall be sitting under the apple tree reading all summer, and going on the river with Laurie."

Beth said she would be lying about a great deal too. Amy said she was going to do nothing but work on her art.

But it didn't quite work out as they had planned.

Meg lay in bed until ten o'clock in the morning and got downstairs in time for a solitary breakfast. That breakfast did not taste half as nice as the usual ones where everyone ate, laughed, and chatted together.

The room seemed lonely. Jo usually put out vases of flowers each day. Now there were no flowers, and Beth had not done her usual dusting either.

Jo spent her first day on the river bank reading a book. But she soon caught the sun and had a badly burnt nose.

Beth did mean to tidy her closet and sort through her clothes. But after emptying everything onto the floor, she decided to have a sleep. By the time she awoke it was time for bed. All her clothes remained in a pile on the floor.

Amy did manage to do one drawing of an oak tree. And so it went on for the next few days. Soon, the girls began to get bored with doing nothing. Each day seemed to be getting longer and longer. At the end of the first week, each one admitted that they were glad it was over.

Now, Mrs. March had a great sense of humor. She knew the girls would soon tire of doing very little. So she played a little trick. On the Saturday morning, the girls came down for breakfast and found a very unfamiliar state of affairs. The kitchen stove fire was out. There was no breakfast ready at all. There was no sign of Hannah, and Mother was nowhere to be seen.

"Mercy on us!" cried Jo. "What has happened?"

Meg ran upstairs to Mother's room. There she was, still in bed. "Hannah's sick," said Mother, "so she's got the day off. As for me, I've decided to follow your example. I'm not going to do anything for a while. As from today, I'm on holiday too."

When Meg came downstairs again and told the others, there was disappointment for a moment. Then they all looked at each other and started laughing.

"Thank goodness!" said Jo. "I hate doing nothing but reading. Now we can look after Mother and let her have a holiday." Meg agreed. "It's so boring doing nothing," she said. Beth and Amy heartily agreed.

"I'm going to light the stove," said Amy.

"And I'll cook Mother's breakfast," said Beth.

Meg said she would carry it upstairs on a tray, so Mother could eat it in bed for a change. Jo said she would start cleaning up the house and putting fresh flowers in the vases again. "Lounging around doing nothing is just not fun," she said.

They worked hard for the rest of that summer. They even divided up the garden into four quarters, so each girl had their own plot to look after. Meg grew roses. Jo experimented with sunflowers. Beth planted sweet peas and pansies. Amy built a bower and planted it with honeysuckle.

So that summer, the girls were busier than ever. And they were happier than ever too.

Text 2

Chapter II Secrets

"Finished!" cried Jo excitedly.

Jo had secretly been continuing with her writing during the summer and now her first story was ready. She rolled up the pages, tied them with a red ribbon and caught an omnibus into town. It was like a secret mission. She was determined that no one would see her go.

She reached her destination, pulled her hat down over her eyes, and entered a building with several nameplates on a board outside. One was for a dentist, and another was for a local newspaper. Ten minutes later she emerged, only to bump straight into Laurie.

"Oh, where have you been?" he asked.

"To the dentist," she answered, as a blush reddened her cheeks.

"Are you sure?" asked Laurie, in a knowing sort of way.

"Of course," said Jo. "I may have a tooth out next week." "Your teeth are perfect," said Laurie. "Jo, you're up to some mischief. Where have you really been?"

Jo was bursting to tell Laurie the truth in any case. "I have just shown one of my stories to the editor of the newspaper," she said, hardly able to contain her excitement. "He'll tell me next week if he can publish it. I don't suppose anything will come of it."

"Of course it will," said Laurie. "I'm sure your stories are better than William Shakespeare's. We'll all feel so proud of our little authoress."

"Don't you dare tell anyone," said Jo. "It's our secret for now."

Laurie promised and they set off home together.

A few days later, Meg was looking out of the drawing room window when she saw a very excited Jo arrive home, with Laurie chasing her. He eventually caught up with her in Amy's flower bower. What went on there Meg couldn't see, but shrieks of laughter were heard, followed by the murmur of voices and a great flapping of a newspaper.

"What shall we do with Jo?" said Meg. "She does not behave like a young lady."

"I hope she never will," said Beth. "She's so funny and lovely just as she is."

Jo and Laurie eventually came into the room. Jo settled into a large armchair and started to read the newspaper.

"What's in the newspaper?" asked Meg. "Anything interesting?"

"Just a story," replied Jo, "but not much of one."

"Read it to us," said Meg. "That will keep you out of mischief. What's it about?"

"A romance," replied Jo.

Jo settled back and read the story. The girls listened with interest. The tale was romantic and a bit sad. Most of the characters died by the end of the story, but everyone enjoyed it. When it was over, Beth asked who wrote it.

Jo sat up straight, cast aside the newspaper and announced in an excited and proud voice: "Me!"

"I knew it! I knew it!" cried Beth. "Oh Jo, I am so proud of you."

All three girls were absolutely delighted. Meg just couldn't believe it until she saw the words beneath the story: "Well I never," said Hannah, when she was told about it.

Eventually, Mrs. March heard the commotion and came in. How proud she was. "Will you be doing some more?" she asked. "The newspaper man wants me to write another one," said Jo. "He won't pay me for the first one. That was just practice, he said. But if he publishes another one, then he'll pay me. Who knows, I might earn a good living and be able to help you all."

"I hope you do," said Meg.

"Oh, how I wish," said Jo, "that I could fix things for you all, just like I do for the heroes and heroines of my stories. If I had my way, some rich relation would leave us a fortune. You'd all marry a prince and Father would become the president."

"Never mind," said Mrs. March. "Our fortunes will get better some day. And Jo, we must send a copy of the story to Father. To think, he has an author for a daughter!" By Miss Josephine March

Text 3

Five On a Treasure Island

Enid Blyton (August 11, 1897 - November 28, 1968) was a British children's author of Noddy, The Famous Five, The Five Find-Outers, The Mystery Series, The Adventure Series, The Secret Seven, Malory Towers, The St. Clare's series, The Magic Faraway Tree series, The Wishing-Chair series, and hundreds of other books for younger and older children. Her prolific output involved mainly escapist children's fantasy, often but not always involving the supernatural. Her books were immensely popular in Britain and Australia, and were translated into several languages, including Spanish and French. Blyton's books also managed to tap into

the dreams of pre-pubertal children, offering worlds where children are free to play and explore without adult interference, more clearly than most authors before or since.

Ah, the Famous Five! In this first book, we open with Julian, Dick and Anne at home with their parents, chatting around the breakfast table. Julian asks his mother if they're going to Polseath as usual for the summer holidays—but to the children's surprise their parents have decided they want to go away on their own to Scotland. The children must go to stay with their Aunt Fanny and Uncle Quentin, down by the sea at Kirrin Bay. They have a daughter by the name of Georgina, who is very lonely and could do with the company of a few cousins. And so plans are made, and they all pile into the car and set off.

Chapter I.

The Strange Cousin

"Mother, have you heard about our summer holidays yet?" said Julian, at the breakfast-table. "Can we go to Polseath as usual?"

"I'm afraid not," said his mother. "They are quite full up this year."¹

"Cheer up," said Daddy. "We'll find somewhere else just as good for you. What about Quentin's for example?" Quentin was his brother, the children's uncle. They had only seen him once, and had been rather frightened of him. He was a very tall, unsmiling man, a clever scientist who spent all his time studying. He lived by the sea — but that was about all that the children knew of him!

"I had to see Quentin's wife in town the other day, about a business matter — and I don't think things are going too well for them," said Daddy. "Fanny said that she would be quite glad to have one or two people to live with her for a while, to bring a little money in."² Their house is by the sea, you know, just the thing for the children. Fanny is very nice—she will look after them well." "Yes — and she has a child of her own too, hasn't she?" said the children's mother. "Let me see — what's her name — something funny — yes, Georgina! How old can she be? About eleven, I think." "Same age as me," said Dick.

The children began to feel rather excited. It would be fun to go to a place they had never been to before, and stay with an unknown cousin.

"Oh Daddy, do telephone to Aunt Fanny and ask her if we can go there!" cried Dick.

They had all finished their breakfast, and they got up to wait for Daddy to telephone. He went out into the hall, and they heard him putting the call-through.¹ Daddy came back in about ten minutes' time, and the children knew at once that he had fixed up everything. He smiled round at them.

"Well," he said. "Your Aunt Fanny is delighted about it. She says it will be awfully good for Georgina to have company, because she's such a lonely little girl, always going off by herself. And she will love looking after you all. Only you'll have to be careful not to disturb your Uncle Quentin. He is working very hard, and he doesn't like it when he is disturbed."

"We'll be as quiet as mice in the house," said Dick. "Honestly we will. Oh, when are we going, Daddy?"

"Next week, if Mother can manage it," said Daddy. "Well, what about Tuesday?" "That would suit me well," said Mother.

And at last Tuesday came. They started for Kirrin Bay where their uncle's family lived. It was a long journey. At 6 o'clock they arrived.

"Now, let's look out for Aunt Fanny's house. It's called Kirrin Cottage," said Mother.

They soon came to it. It stood on the low cliff overlooking the bay, and was a very old house indeed. It wasn't really a cottage, but quite a big house, built of old white stone. Roses climbed over the front of it, and the garden was gay with flowers.

"Here's Kirrin Cottage," said Daddy, and he stopped the car in front of it. I

think it is about three hundred years old! Now — where's Quentin? Hallo, there's Fanny!"

The children's aunt came running out of the old wooden door. The children liked the look of her at once.

"Welcome to Kirrin!" she cried. "Hallo, all of you! It's lovely to see you." There were kisses all round, and then the children went into the house. They liked it. It felt old and rather mysterious somehow, and the furniture was (old and very beautiful.

"Where's Georgina?" asked Anne, looking round for her unknown cousin. "Oh, the naughty girl! I told her to wait in the garden for you, but she's gone off somewhere," said her aunt. "I must tell you, children, you may find George a bit difficult. And at first she may not like you being here. But you I mustn't take any notice of that. She'll be all right in a short time."

"Do you call her 'George'?" asked Anne, in surprise. "I thought her name was Georgina."

"So it is," said her aunt. "But George hates being a girl, and we have to call her George."

The children thought that Georgina sounded rather exciting. Their Uncle Quentin was a most extraordinary looking man, very tall, very dark, and very serious.

"Quentin is working on a very difficult book," said Aunt Fanny. "But I've given him a room all to himself on the other side of the house. So I don't expect he will be disturbed."

There was no room at Kirrin Cottage for Mother and Daddy to stay the night, so after a hurried supper they left.

Georgina still hadn't appeared. "I'm sorry we haven't seen Georgina," said Mother. "Just give her our love and tell her we hope she'll enjoy playing with Dick, Julian and Anne."

The children felt a little bit lonely as they saw the big car disappear round the corner of the road, but Aunt Fanny took them upstairs to show them their bedrooms, and they soon forgot to be sad.

The two boys were to sleep together in a room with low ceilings at the top of the house. It had a wonderful view of the bay. The boys were really delighted with it. Anne was to sleep with Georgina in a smaller room, whose windows looked over the moors at the back of the house. But one side window looked over the sea, which pleased Anne very much.

"I do wish Georgina would come," Anne said to her aunt. "I want to see what she's like."

"Well, she's a funny little girl," said her aunt. "She can be very rude but she's kind at heart, very loyal and absolutely truthful. Once she makes friends with you, she will always be your friend but she finds it very difficult indeed to make friends, which is a great pity."

Then she looked at the children and said: "How tired you are! You must all go to bed straight away, and have a good long night." And indeed they were all sleepy with their long drive.

"I wonder where Georgina is," said Anne, when she said goodnight to the boys, and went to her own room. "Isn't she strange not waiting to welcome us and not coming in to supper?"

All the three children were fast asleep before Georgina came up to bed. They didn't hear her open Anne's door. They didn't hear her get undressed and clean her teeth. They didn't hear her get into bed. They were so tired that they heard nothing at all until the sun awoke them in the morning.

When Anne awoke she couldn't at first think where she was. She lay in her little bed and looked up at the ceiling, and remembered all of a sudden where she was! "I'm at Kirrin Bay," she said to herself.

Then she looked across at the other bed. In it lay the figure of another child. When the figure stirred a little, Anne spoke, "I say, are you Georgina?"

The child in the opposite bed sat up and looked across at Anne. She had very short curly hair, almost as short as a boy's. Her face was dark brown with the sun, and her very blue eyes looked as bright as forget-me-nots in her face. But her mouth was rather sulky, and she had a frown like her father's.

"No," she said, "I'm not Georgina."

"Oh!" said Anne, in surprise. "Then who are you?"

"I'm George," said the girl. "I shall only answer if you call me George. I hate being a girl: I don't like doing the things that girls do. I like doing the things that boys do. I can climb better than any boy, and swim faster too. I can sail a boat as well as any fisherboy. You must call me George. Then I'll speak to you. But I shan't if you don't."

"Oh!" said Anne, thinking that her new cousin was most extraordinary. "All right! I don't care what I call you. George is a nice name, I think. Anyway, you look like a boy."

"Do I really?" said George, the frown leaving her face for a moment.

The two girls stared at one another for a moment. "Don't you simply hate being a girl?" asked George.

"No, of course not," said Anne. "You see I do like pretty dresses — and I love my dolls."

"Fancy bothering about pretty dresses," said George, in a low voice. "And dolls! Well, you are a baby, that's all I can say."

Anne felt offended. "You're not very polite," she said.

"I didn't want any of you to come anyway. Interfering with my life here," said George, jumping out of bed. "I'm quite happy on my own. Now I've got to share my room with a silly girl who likes dresses and dolls, and see two stupid boy cousins!"

Anne felt that they had made a very bad beginning. She said no more, but got dressed too. Just as they were ready the boys knocked on their door. "Aren't you ready? Is Georgina there? Cousin Georgina, come out and see us."

George opened the door and went out. She took no notice of the two stupid surprised boys at all. She went downstairs. The three children looked at

one another. "She won't answer if you call her Georgina," explained Anne. "She's awfully strange, I think. She says she didn't want us to come because we'll be in her way. She laughed at me, and was rather rude."

Julian put his arm round Anne. "Cheer up!" he said. "You've got us to help you. Come on down to breakfast."

They were all hungry. The smell of bacon and eggs was very good. They ran down the stairs and said good morning to their aunt and uncle. George was there too, buttering a piece of toast. She looked and smiled not very pleasantly at the three children.

"Don't look like that, George," said her mother. "I hope you've made friends already. You must take your cousins to see the bay this morning and show them the best places to bathe."

"I'm going fishing," said George.

Her father looked up at once.

"You are not," he said. "You are going to show a few good manners for a change, and take your cousins to the bay. Do you hear me?"

"Yes," said George. It was clear she didn't like the idea.

So, after breakfast, the four children got ready to go down to the beach. An easy path led down to the bay, and they ran down happily. Even George smiled as she felt the warmth of the sun and saw the dancing waves on the blue sea.

"You go fishing if you want to," said Anne when they were down on the beach. "We won't tell tales of you. We've got ourselves for company, and if you don't want to be with us, you needn't."

"But we'd like you, all the same, if you'd like to be with us," said Julian, generously.

George stared at him. "I'll see," she said. "I don't make friends with people just because they're my cousins. I only make friends with people if I like them."

"So do we," said Julian. "We may not like you, of course."

"Oh!" said George, as if that thought hadn't occurred to her —
"W e l l you may not, of course. Lots of people don't like me, now come to think of it."

Anne was staring out over the blue bay. At the entrance to it lay a curious rocky island with what looked like an old ruined castle on the top of it.

"Isn't that a funny place?" she said. "I wonder what it's called."

"It's called Kirrin Island," said George. "It's a lovely place to go to."

"Who does the funny island belong to?" asked Julian.

George made a most surprising answer. "It belongs to me," she said. "At least, it will belong to me some day. It will be my very own island and my very own castle!"

Montezuma's Daughter

Henry Rider Haggard British novelist was born on June 22, 1856 in Bradenham, Norfolk, England and died on May 14, 1925, London. After holding a series of official posts in South Africa (1875-81), he began writing stories set in Africa. Of his 34 colourful adventure novels, the best-known is *King Solomon's Mines* (1885); others include *She* (1887), *Allan Quatermain* (1887), *Cleopatra* (1889), and *Ayesha* (1905). Also a farmer, he wrote *A Farmer's Year* (1899) and *Rural England* (2 vol., 1902), and he was knighted in 1912 for his work on agricultural commissions.

Chapter I

I, Thomas Wingfield, was born here at Ditchingham³ and in the very³ room where I write today. My grandfather had only one son — my father. His great wish was to make a priest of the latter, but my father did not like the idea.⁴ Still he could not disobey his father and was obliged to go to a convent and prepare for this- profession. But he behaved 'so badly that the prior at last begged my grandfather to take his son home.

When the boy grew older my grandfather decided to send him to Spain to study at a convent. My father agreed to go to Spain, for he wanted to see the world. A year after the young man had gone a priest came from Spain and told my grandfather that his son had fled from the convent and that they had not heard anything of him since.

Two years later the news came that my father had fallen into the hands of the Inquisition and had been tortured to death. My grandfather was very sad, though he did not really believe that his son was dead and always awaited his return. But it was only three years after the old man's death that my father⁹ came home with his young wife who was a Spaniard. Her name was Donna Luisa de Garcia. My father never spoke about his life in Spain, but I knew that he had been in the hands of the Inquisition. Once when I was still a small boy I saw white scars on his body. I asked him who had hurt him. "Devils," he said. "Thomas, there is a country called Spain where your mother was born. There these devils live. They torture men and women and burn them alive in the name of Christ.¹ The enemy of your mother betrayed me into their hands. They made these scars on my

body and did not burn me only because your mother saved me. Never speak of this, Thomas, for the Inquisition has a long arm."

"Our parents had three children, Geoffrey, my elder brother, myself and my sister Mary, who was one year younger than I. My mother called me "her little Spaniard" because I was more like a Spaniard than my brother and my sister. She taught me to speak and read Spanish and told me much about Spain. She still loved her native country. I asked her once it she wanted to go back to Spain. "No, my boy," she answered, "there is a man in Spain who hates me and wants to kill me." "No man can wish to kill you. You are so good and beautiful!" I exclaimed. "It is just because I have been beautiful that he hates me,"¹ she said. "He wanted to marry me, but I loved your father."

One day when I was eighteen years old Squire Bozard, our neighbour, came to see us and said that he had seen a Spanish ship in Yarmouth port. "Who is the captain of the ship?" asked my father. "I do not know his name," answered the squire. "I have only seen him in the market-place. He is a tall handsome man with a scar on his face." At this news my mother turned pale and said in Spanish: "Holy Mother!"³ What if it is he!

My father went to Yarmouth at once. My mother did not sleep that night. In the morning I came into her room. "What do you fear?" I asked. "I fear the past and the future, my son," she said in a low voice. Soon my father returned from Yarmouth. "It cannot be he. This man has another name," he said to my mother. "He may have another name now," answered my mother. "I did not think about it," my father answered. "But I am sure it is not he." A little later when I was preparing to go to my teacher my mother called me. "Kiss me before you go, Thomas," she said in a trembling voice, and I saw that she was still full of fear. "Do not be afraid, mother dear," I cried shaking my thick stick. "If this Spaniard comes here he will have to do with me!" She kissed me tenderly and I left her. At the door I turned and looked at my mother once more. I did not know that I should never see her alive again.

Chapter II

The Spaniard Appears

At the time when the Spanish ship came to Yarmouth I was studying medicine. The doctor who taught me this art lived in the neighbourhood. I liked medicine and studied very well. My father wanted to send me to London to continue my studies there. I was ready to go to London, but at

the same time I did not wish to leave my home because I was in love with Lily, the daughter of our neighbour Squire Bozard.

I knew that my elder brother Geoffrey was also in love with Lily. So I decided to speak to the girl that very day and tell her of my love, for I feared that my brother would do it before me. When I had finished my lesson I said good-bye to my teacher and hurried to the park, for I knew that Lily would be there. On my way I met a man on horseback. I saw at once that he was a stranger. His face was handsome, but there was a scar on it and his eyes had a devilish expression. The man stopped me and spoke in a very bad English. I understood only the word Yarmouth. "What do you wish?" I said in Spanish. "Perhaps I can help you?" "What! You speak Spanish and you are not a Spaniard. It is strange!" he exclaimed. "It may be strange, but I am in a hurry. Tell me what you wish." "I know why you are in a hurry," he said. "I have seen a white dress in the park. Be careful, young man. Never believe women and never marry a woman. Otherwise you may wish to kill them all one day. Now tell me the nearest way to Yarmouth." I told him what road he was to take and hurried to the park, but he stopped me and said: "Tell me your name, please." I did not like the man and answered rudely:

"I am not ashamed of my name. It is Thomas Wingfield."

"I thought so," cried the stranger springing from his horse. "My name is Juan de Garcia. I hate you, for you are *her* son and I shall kill you." He raised his sword but I was quicker and dealt him such a blow with my thick stick that he fell heavily to the ground. I did not let him get up, but struck him again and again till he cried for mercy. Then I raised the stranger to his feet and tied him to a tree. "Stay here till I return," I cried and hurried away to the park taking the Spaniard's sword with me. I was very young and foolish and did not stop to think that I had no right to leave the man I had beaten, for now I knew that he was my mother's greatest enemy. But Lily was waiting for me and I wanted to see her so much! The reader will see how severely I was punished for my foolishness.

Chapter III

Thomas Tells Lily of his Love

"What has happened, Thomas?" Lily cried when she saw me. "Why have you a sword in your hand? Oh, there is blood on your shirt! Are you wounded?" "It is nothing, Lily dear," I said and in a few words told her

about my meeting with the Spaniard. "Oh, Thomas," she cried. "If he had killed you..." Her voice trembled and there were tears in her eyes. I could wait no longer. "Listen Lily," I cried. "I have come to tell you that I love you. I love you, dear, and I will always love you." "Are you so sure of that,¹ Thomas?" she said smiling softly. "I am quite sure of it, Lily. But do *you* love *me*?" "Can you doubt it, Thomas?" she asked. Then I kissed her. At that moment Lily's father appeared. He was very cross when he saw us together. "What are you doing here, young man?" the squire cried angrily. "I love your daughter, sir," I said bravely, "and she loves me. I came here today because I wanted to say good bye to her. I am going to London to win a fortune and a name. Then I shall come back and marry Lily."

"Daughter," said the squire, "say that you will not think of him any longer." "I cannot say that, father," she answered. "While Thomas lives I shall not marry another man." Lily's father was very angry. "Go away," he cried threatening me with his stick. "The girl is not for you. I do not want to see you together." "I shall go since I must," I answered, "but still I hope a day will come when I shall call your daughter my wife. Farewell, Lily." "Farewell, Thomas," she said sadly. "Do not forget me, and I shall never forget you."

Lily and her father went away. Now my thoughts returned to the Spaniard. I had quite forgotten him. When I came to the tree to which I had tied him I saw that he was not there any longer. The village fool Billy Minns who stood near the tree, told me that he had set him free.

At first I was very angry with Billy Minns. But then I understood that the poor fool was not to blame. He did not know who the stranger was. It was *my* fault, I knew that he was my parents' enemy and still I had left him.

My thoughts were sad as I walked slowly home. My path lay through a small wood in which my mother liked to walk. I looked at the sword that was still in my hand and thought of the Spaniard.

Suddenly I saw something white on the ground. It was my mother's mantilla. As I was bending to raise it I noticed footprints on the path. They belonged to my mother, but there were also other footprints — strange footprints belonging to a man. A cold fear filled my heart, I ran along the path, for I understood that somebody had followed my mother. Soon I came to a place where the bushes were very thick. And there among them I saw my mother. She was dead.

PART III

READER FOR INTERMEDIATE STUDENTS

Text 1

Sophie Kinsella

(b.12.12.1969)

Sophie Kinsella is a pseudonym used by Madeleine (Townley) Wickham to write chick lit. Before becoming the famous Sophie Kinsella, Wickham graduated from New College, Oxford, then worked as a financial journalist. She published her first novel in 1995. Sophie Kinsella is the queen of "chick lit," so it is only natural that she takes on "chick flicks" as well. Although Wickham has published other books under her real name, her Kinsella books are much more popular, so more people know who "Sophie Kinsella" is. All of her books fall into the genre "chick lit" -- light, humorous books about modern women and their misadventures in life and love.

Can You Keep A Secret?

One

Of course I have secrets. Of course I do. Everyone has a secret. It's completely normal. I'm sure I don't have any more than anybody else. I'm not talking about big, earth-shattering secrets. Not the-president-is-planning-to-bomb-Japan-and-only-Will-Smith-can-save-the-world type secrets. Just normal, everyday little secrets. Like for example, here are a few random secrets of mine, off the top of my head:

1. My Kate Spade bag is a fake.
2. I love sweet sherry, the least cool drink in the universe.
3. I have no idea what NATO stands for. Or even what it is.
4. I weigh 9 stone 3. Not 8 stone 3, like my boyfriend Connor thinks. (Although in my defence, I was planning to go on a diet when I told him that. And to be fair, it is only one number different.)
5. I've always thought Connor looks a bit like Ken. As in Barbie and Ken.
6. Sometimes, when we're right in the middle of passionate sex, I suddenly want to laugh.
7. I lost my virginity in the spare bedroom with Danny Nussbaum, while Mum and Dad were downstairs watching *Ben Hur*.
8. I've already drunk the wine that Dad told me to lay down for twenty years.

9. Sammy the goldfish at home isn't the same goldfish that Mum and Dad gave me to look after when they went to Egypt.
10. When my colleague Artemis really annoys me, I feed her plant orange juice. (Which is pretty much every day.)
11. I once had this weird lesbian dream about my flatmate Lissy.
12. My G-string is hurting me.
13. I've always had this deep down conviction that I'm not like everybody else, and there's an amazingly exciting new life waiting for me just around the corner.
14. I have no idea what this guy in the grey suit is going on about.
15. Plus I've already forgotten his name.

And I only met him ten minutes ago. 'We believe in logistical formative alliances,' he's saying in a nasal, droning voice, 'both above and below the line. "Absolutely!" I reply brightly, as though to say: Doesn't everybody? Logistical. What does that mean, again? Oh God. What if they ask me? Don't be stupid, Emma. They won't suddenly demand, 'What does logistical mean?' I'm a fellow marketing professional, aren't I? Obviously I know these things. And anyway, if they mention it again I'll change the subject. Or I'll say I'm post-logistical or something. The important thing is to keep confident and businesslike. I can do this. This is my big chance and I'm not going to screw it up.

I'm sitting in the offices of Glen Oil's headquarters in Glasgow, and as I glance at my reflection in the window, I look just like a top businesswoman. My hair is straightened, I'm wearing discreet earrings like they tell you to in How-to-win-that-job articles, and I've got on my smart new Jigsaw suit. (At least, it's practically new. I got it from the Cancer Research shop and sewed on a button to replace the missing one, and you can hardly tell.) I'm here representing the Panther Corporation, which is where I work. The meeting is to finalize a promotional arrangement between the new cranberry-flavoured Panther Prime sports drink and Glen Oil, and I flew up this morning from London, especially. (The company paid, and everything!)

When I arrived, the Glen Oil marketing guys started on this long, show-offy 'who's-travelled -the-most?' conversation about airmiles and the red-eye to Washington — and I think I bluffed pretty convincingly. (Except when I said I'd flown Concorde to Ottawa, and it turns out Concorde doesn't go to Ottawa.) But the truth is, this is the first time I've

ever had to travel for a deal. OK. The *real* truth is, this is the first deal I've ever done, full stop. I've been at the Panther Corporation for eleven months as a marketing assistant, and until now all I've been allowed to do is type out copy, arrange meetings for other people, get the sandwiches and pick up my boss's dry-cleaning.

So this is kind of my big break. And I've got this secret little hope that if I do this well, maybe I'll get promoted. The ad for my job said 'possibility of promotion after a year', and on Monday I'm having my yearly appraisal meeting with my boss, Paul. I looked up 'Appraisals' in the staff induction book, and it said they are 'an ideal opportunity to discuss possibilities for career advancement'. Career advancement! At the thought, I feel a familiar stab of longing in my chest. It would just show Dad I'm not a complete loser. And Mum. And Kerry. If I could go home and casually say, 'By the way, I've been promoted to Marketing Executive.' *Emma Corrigan, Marketing Executive. Emma Corrigan, Senior Vice-President (Marketing.)*

As long as everything goes well today. Paul said the deal was done and dusted and all I had to do was nod and shake their hands, and even I should be able to manage that. And so far, I reckon it's going really well. OK, so I don't understand about 90 per cent of what they're saying. But then I didn't understand much of my GCSE French Oral either, and I still got a B. 'Rebranding... analysis... cost-effective... The man in the grey suit is still droning on about something or other. As casually as possible, I extend my hand and inch his business card towards me so I can read it. Doug Hamilton. That's right. OK, I can remember this. Doug. Dug. Easy. I'll picture a shovel. Together with a *ham*. Which... which looks *ill* ... and... OK, forget this. I'll just write it down. I write down 'rebranding' and 'Doug Hamilton' on my notepad and give an awkward little wriggle. God, my knickers really are uncomfortable. I mean, G-strings are never that comfortable at the best of times, in my opinion, but these are particularly bad. Which could be because they're two sizes too small. Which could possibly be because Connor bought them for me, and told the lingerie assistant I weighed eight stone three. Where upon she told him I must be size eight. Size eight! (Frankly, I think she was just being mean. She *must* have known I was fibbing.) So it's Christmas Eve, and we're exchanging presents, and I unwrap this pair of gorgeous pale pink silk knickers. Size eight. And I basically have two options.

A: Confess the truth: 'Actually these are too small, I'm more of a 12, and by the way, I don't really weigh eight stone three.' Or...

B: Shoe-horn myself into them.

Actually, it was fine. You could hardly see the red lines on my skin afterwards. And all it meant was that I had to quickly cut all the labels out of my clothes so Connor would never realize.

Since then, I've hardly ever worn this particular set of underwear, needless to say. But every so often I see them looking all nice and expensive in the drawer and think, Oh come on, they can't be *that* tight, and somehow squeeze into them. Which is what I did this morning. I even decided I must have lost weight, because they didn't feel too bad. I am such a deluded moron. '... unfortunately since rebranding... major rethink... feel we need to be considering alternative synergies...'

Up to now I've just been sitting and nodding, thinking this business meeting lark is really easy. But now Doug Hamilton's voice starts to impinge on my consciousness. What's he saying? '... two products diverging... becoming incompatible...' What was that about incompatible? What was that about a major rethink? I feel a jolt of alarm. Maybe this isn't just waffle. Maybe he's actually *saying* something. Quick, listen.

'We appreciate the functional and synergetic partnership that Panther and Glen Oil have enjoyed in the past,' Doug Hamilton is saying. 'But you'll agree that clearly we're going in different directions.'

Different directions?

Is *that* what he's been talking about all this time? My stomach gives an anxious lurch. He can't be-

Is he trying to pull out of the deal?

'Excuse me, Doug,' I say, in my most relaxed voice. 'Obviously I was closely following what you were saying earlier.' I give a friendly, we're-all-professionals-together smile. 'But if you could just... um, recap the situation for all our benefits...'

In plain English, I beg silently.

Doug Hamilton and the other guy exchange glances.

'We're a little unhappy about your brand values,' says Doug Hamilton.

'My brand values?' I echo in panic.

'The brand values of the *product* ,' he says, giving me an odd look. 'As I've been explaining, we here at Glen Oil are going through a rebranding process at the moment, and we see our new image very much as a *caring*

petrol, as our new daffodil logo demonstrates. And we feel Panther Prime, with its emphasis on sport and competition, is simply too aggressive.'

'Aggressive?' I stare at him, bewildered. 'But... it's a fruit drink.'

This makes no sense. Glen Oil is fume-making, world-ruining petrol. Panther Prime is an innocent cranberry-flavoured drink. How can it be too aggressive?

'The values it espouses.' He gestures to the marketing brochures on the table. 'Drive. Elitism.

Masculinity. The very slogan, "Don't Pause". Frankly, it seems a little dated.' He shrugs. 'We just don't think a joint initiative will be possible.'

No. No. This can't be happening. He can't be pulling out.

Everyone at the office will think it was my fault. They'll think I cocked it up and I'm completely crap.

My heart is thumping. My face is hot. I can't let this happen. But what do I say? I haven't prepared anything. Paul said it was all set up and all I had to do was shake their hands.

'We'll certainly discuss it again before we make a decision,' Doug's saying. He gives me a brief smile. 'And as I say, we would like to continue links with the Panther Corporation, so this has been a useful meeting in any case.'

He's pushing back his chair.

I can't let this slip away! I have to try to win them round. I have to try and shut the deal.

Close the deal. That's what I meant.

'Wait!' I hear myself say. 'Just... wait a moment! I have a few points to make.'

What am I talking about? I have no points to make.

There's a can of Panther Prime sitting on the desk, and I grab it for inspiration. Playing for time, I stand up, walk to the centre of the room and raise the can high into the air where we can all see it.

'Panther Prime is... a sports drink.'

I stop, and there's a polite silence. My face is prickling.

'It... um... it is very...'

Oh God. What am I doing?

Come *on*, Emma. *Think*. Think Panther Prime... think Panther Cola... think... think...

Yes! Of course!

OK, start again.

'Since the launch of Panther Cola in the late 1980s, Panther drinks have been a byword for energy, excitement and excellence,' I say fluently.

Thank God. This is the standard marketing blurb for Panther Cola. I've typed it out so many zillions of times, I could recite it in my sleep.

'Panther drinks are a marketing phenomenon,' I continue. 'The Panther character is one of the most widely recognized in the world, while the classic slogan "Don't Pause" has made it into dictionaries. We are now offering Glen Oil an exclusive opportunity to join with this premium, world-famous brand.'

My confidence growing, I start to stride around the room, gesturing with the can.

'By buying a Panther health drink, the consumer is signalling that he will settle for nothing but the best.' I hit the can sharply with my other hand.

'He expects the best from his energy drink, he expects the best from his petrol, he expects the best from himself.'

I'm flying! I'm fantastic! If Paul could see me now, he'd give me a promotion on the spot!

I come over to the desk and look Doug Hamilton right in the eye. 'When the Panther consumer opens that can, he is making a choice which tells the world who he is. I'm asking Glen Oil to make the same choice.'

As I finish speaking I plant the can firmly in the middle of the desk, reach for the ring pull and, with a cool smile, snap it back.

It's like a volcano erupting.

Fizzy cranberry-flavoured drink explodes in a whoosh out of the can, landing on the desk, drenching the papers and blotters in lurid red liquid... and oh no, please no... splattering all over Doug Hamilton's shirt.

'Fuck!' I gasp. 'I mean, I'm really sorry...'

'Jesus Christ,' says Doug Hamilton irritably, standing up and getting a handkerchief out of his pocket. 'Does this stuff stain?'

'Er...' I grab the can helplessly. 'I don't know.'

'I'll get a cloth,' says the other guy, and leaps to his feet.

The door closes behind him and there's silence, apart from the sound of cranberry drink dripping slowly onto the floor.

I stare at Doug Hamilton, my face hot and blood throbbing through my ears.

'Please...' I say, and clear my husky throat. 'Don't tell my boss.'

After all that. I screwed it up.

As I drag my heels across the concourse at Glasgow Airport, I feel completely dejected. Doug Hamilton was quite sweet in the end. He said he was sure the stain would come out, and promised he wouldn't tell Paul what happened. But he didn't change his mind about the deal.

My first big meeting. My first big chance — and this is what happens. I feel like giving up on the whole thing. I feel like phoning the office and saying 'That's it, I'm never coming back again, and by the way, it was me who jammed the photocopier that time.'

But I can't. This is my third career in four years. It *has* to work. For my own self-worth. For my own self-esteem. And also because I owe my dad four thousand quid.

'So what can I get you?' says an Australian guy, and I look up dazedly. I've arrived at the airport with an hour to go, and have headed straight for the bar.

'Erm...' My mind is blank. 'Er... white wine. No, actually, a vodka and tonic. Thanks.'

As he moves away, I slump down again in my stool. An air hostess with a French plait comes and sits down, two bar stools away. She smiles at me, and I smile weakly in return.

I don't know how other people manage their careers, I really don't. Like my oldest friend Lissy. She's always known she wanted to be a lawyer — and now, ta-daah! She's a fraud barrister. But I left college with absolutely no clue. My first job was in estate agency, and I only went into it because I've always quite liked looking round houses, plus I met this woman with amazing red lacquered nails at a career fair who told me she made so much money, she'd be able to retire when she was forty.

But the minute I started, I hated it. I hated all the other trainee estate agents. I hated saying things like 'a lovely aspect'. And I hated the way if someone said they could afford ?300,000 we were supposed to give them details of houses costing at least ?400,000, and then kind of look down our noses, like, 'You only have ?300,000? God, you complete loser.'

So after six months I announced I was changing career and was going to be a photographer instead. It was *such* a fantastic moment, like in a film or something. My dad lent me the money for a photography course and camera, and I was going to launch this amazing new creative career, and it was going to be the start of my new life...

Except it didn't quite happen like that.

I mean, for a start, do you have any idea how much a photographer's assistant gets paid?

Nothing. It's nothing.

Which, you know, I wouldn't have minded if anyone had actually *offered* me a photographer's assistant's job.

I heave a heavy sigh, and gaze at my doleful expression in the mirror behind the bar. As well as everything else, my hair, which I carefully straightened with serum this morning, has gone all frizzy. Typical.

At least I wasn't the only one who didn't get anywhere. Out of the eight people on my course, one became instantly successful and now takes photos for *Vogue* and stuff, one became a wedding photographer, one had an affair with the tutor, one went travelling, one had a baby, one works at Snappy Snaps and one is now at Morgan Stanley.

Meanwhile I got more and more into debt, and started temping and applying for jobs which actually paid money. And eventually, eleven months ago, I started as a marketing assistant at the Panther Corporation.

The barman places a vodka and tonic in front of me, and gives me a quizzical look. 'Cheer up!' he says. 'It can't be that bad!'

'Thanks,' I say gratefully, and take a sip. That feels a bit better. I'm just taking a second sip when my mobile starts to ring.

My stomach gives a nervous flip. If it's the office, I'll just pretend I didn't hear.

But it's not, it's our home number flashing on the little screen.

'Hi,' I say, pressing green.

'Hiya!' comes Lissy's voice. 'Only me! So how did it go?'

Lissy is my flatmate and my oldest friend in the world. She has tufty dark hair and an IQ of about 600 and is the sweetest person I know.

'It was a disaster,' I say miserably.

'What happened? Didn't you get the deal?'

'Not only did I not get the deal, I drenched the marketing director of Glen Oil in cranberry drink.'

Along the bar, I can see the air hostess hiding a smile, and I feel myself flush. Great. Now the whole world knows.

'Oh dear.' I can almost *feel* Lissy trying to think of something positive to say. 'Well, at least you got their attention,' she says at last. 'At least they won't forget you in a hurry.'

'I suppose,' I say morosely. 'So, did I have any messages?'

'Oh! Erm... no. I mean, your dad did phone, but... um... you know... it wasn't...' She tails off evasively.

'Lissy. What did he want?'

There's a pause.

'Apparently your cousin's won some industry award,' she says apologetically. 'They're going to be celebrating it on Saturday as well as your mum's birthday.'

'Oh. Great.'

I slump deeper in my chair. That's all I need. My cousin Kerry triumphantly clutching some silver Best-travel-agent-in-the-world-no-make-that-universe trophy.

'And Connor rang, too, to see how you got on,' adds Lissy quickly. 'He was really sweet, he said he didn't want to ring your mobile during your meeting in case it disturbed you.'

'Really?'

For the first time today, I feel a lift in spirits.

Connor. My boyfriend. My lovely, thoughtful boyfriend.

'He's such a sweetheart!' Lissy is saying. 'He said he's tied up in a big meeting all afternoon but he's cancelled his squash game especially, so do you want to go out to supper tonight?'

'Oh,' I say, with a flicker of pleasure. 'Oh well, that'll be nice. Thanks, Lissy.'

I click off and take another sip of vodka, feeling much more cheerful.

My boyfriend.

It's just like Julie Andrews said. When the dog bites, when the bee stings...

I simply remember I have a boyfriend — and suddenly things don't seem quite so completely shit.

Or however she put it.

And not just any boyfriend. A tall, handsome, clever boyfriend, whom *Marketing Week* called 'one of the brightest sparks in marketing research today.'

I sit nursing my vodka, allowing thoughts of Connor to roll round my brain and comfort me.

The way his blond hair shines in the sunshine, and the way he's always smiling. And the way he upgraded all the software on my computer the other day without me even asking, and the way he... he...

My mind's gone blank. This is ridiculous. I mean, there's so much that is wonderful about Connor. From his... his long legs. Yes. And his broad shoulders. To the time he looked after me when I had the flu. I mean, how many boyfriends do that? Exactly.

I'm so lucky, I really am.

I put the phone away, run my fingers through my hair, and glance at the clock behind the bar.

Forty minutes to go before the flight. Not long now. Nerves are starting to creep over me like little insects, and I take a deep gulp of vodka, draining my glass.

It'll be fine, I tell myself for the zillionth time. It'll be absolutely fine.

I'm not frightened. I'm just... I'm just...

OK. I am frightened.

16. I'm scared of flying.

I've never told anyone I'm scared of flying. It just sounds so lame. And I mean, it's not like I'm phobic or anything. It's not like I can't *get* on a plane. It's just... all things being equal, I would prefer to be on the ground. I never used to be scared. But over the last few years, I've gradually got more and more nervous. I know it's completely irrational. I know thousands of people fly every day and it's practically safer than lying in bed. You have less chance of being in a plane crash than... than finding a man in London, or something.

But still. I just don't like it.

Maybe I'll have another quick vodka.

By the time my flight is called, I've drunk two more vodkas and am feeling a lot more positive.

I mean, Lissy's right. At least I made an impression, didn't I? At least they'll remember who I am. As I stride towards the gate, clutching my briefcase, I almost start to feel like a confident businesswoman again. A couple of people smile at me as they pass, and I smile broadly back, feeling a warm glow of friendliness. You see. The world's not so bad after all. It's all just a question of being positive. Anything can happen in life, can't it? You never know what's round the next corner.

I reach the entrance to the plane, and there at the door, taking boarding passes, is the air hostess with the French plait who was sitting at the bar earlier.

'Hi again,' I say smiling. 'This is a coincidence!'

The air hostess stares at me.

'Hi. Erm...'

'What?'

Why does she look embarrassed?

'Sorry. It's just... did you know that...' She gestures awkwardly to my front.

'What is it?' I say, pleasantly. I look down, and freeze, aghast.

Somehow my silky shirt has been unbuttoning itself while I've been walking along. Three buttons have come undone and it's gaping at the front.

My bra shows. My pink lacy bra. The one that went a bit blobby in the wash.

That's why those people were smiling at me. Not because the world is a nice place, but because I'm Pink-Blobby-Bra-Woman.

'Thanks,' I mutter, and do up the buttons with rumbling fingers, my face hot with humiliation.

'It hasn't been your day, has it?' says the air hostess sympathetically, holding out a hand for my boarding pass. 'Sorry, I couldn't help overhearing, earlier.'

'That's all right.' I raise a half-smile. 'No, it hasn't been the best day of my life.' There's a short silence as she studies my boarding pass.

'Tell you what,' she says in a low voice. 'Would you like an on-board upgrade?'

'A what?' I stare at her blankly.

'Come on. You deserve a break.'

'Really? But... can you just upgrade people like that?'

'If there are spare seats, we can. We use our discretion. And this flight is so short.' She gives me a conspiratorial smile. 'Just don't tell everyone, OK?'

She leads me into the front section of the plane and gestures to a big, wide, comfortable seat.

I've never been upgraded before in my life! I can't quite believe she's really letting me do this.

'Is this first class?' I whisper, taking in the hushed, luxury atmosphere. A man in a smart suit is tapping at a laptop to my right, and two elderly women in the corner are plugging themselves into headsets.

'Business class. There's no first class on this flight.' She lifts her voice to a normal volume. 'Is everything OK for you?'

'It's perfect! Thanks very much.'

'No problem.' She smiles again and walks away, and I push my briefcase under the seat in front.

Wow. This really is lovely. Big wide seats, and footrests, and everything. This is going to be a completely pleasurable experience from start to finish, I tell myself firmly. I reach for my seatbelt and buckle it up nonchalantly, trying to ignore the flutters of apprehension in my stomach.

'Would you like some champagne?'

It's my friend the air hostess, beaming down at me.

'That would be great,' I say. 'Thanks!'

Champagne!

'And for you, sir? Some champagne?'

The man in the seat next to mine hasn't even looked up yet. He's wearing jeans and an old sweatshirt and is staring out of the window. As he turns to answer I catch a glimpse of dark eyes, stubble; a deep frown etched on his forehead.

'No thanks. Just a brandy. Thanks.'

His voice is dry and has an American accent. I'm about to ask him politely where he's from, but he immediately turns back and stares out of the window again. Which is fine, because to be honest, I'm not much in the mood for talking either.

AFTER TWENTY YEARS

O. Henry (1862-1910)

O. Henry is one of the most famous American short story writers. O. Henry's real name was William Sydney Porter and he was born in Greensboro, North Carolina on September 11, 1862. At the age of 20 (1882) he moved to Texas, where he had various jobs. He married Athol Estes in 1887; they had a son and a daughter. His wife died from tuberculosis in 1897. In 1894 while working for First National Bank in Austin, Porter was accused of stealing \$4000. He went to prison in Columbus, Ohio for 3 years eventually. While in prison Porter first started to write short stories and it's believed that he has found his writer's pseudonym there. After Porter was released from the prison in 1901, he changed his name to O. Henry and moved to New York in 1902. From December 1903 to January 1906

O. Henry wrote a story for the New York World magazine, and published several short stories in other magazines. O. Henry's short stories are famous for their surprise endings and humor. O. Henry's wrote such classic short stories as *The Ransom of Red Chief*, *"The Gift of the Magi"* and *"The Furnished Room"* etc..

O. Henry died on June 5, 1910 in New York City.

The following story is reprinted from *The Four Million*. O. Henry. New York: Doubleday, Page and Co., 1912.

The policeman on the beat moved up the avenue impressively. The impressiveness was habitual and not for show, for spectators were few. The time was barely 10 o'clock at night, but chilly gusts of wind with a taste of rain in them had well nigh de-peopled the streets. Trying doors as he went, twirling his club with many intricate and artful movements, turning now and then to cast his watchful eye adown the pacific thoroughfare, the officer, with his stalwart form and slight swagger, made a fine picture of a guardian of the peace. The vicinity was one that kept early hours. Now and then you might see the lights of a cigar store or of an all-night lunch counter; but the majority of the doors belonged to business places that had long since been closed.

When about midway of a certain block the policeman suddenly slowed his walk. In the doorway of a darkened hardware store a man leaned, with an unlighted cigar in his mouth. As the policeman walked up to him the man spoke up quickly. "It's all right, officer," he said, reassuringly. "I'm just waiting for a friend. It's an appointment made twenty years ago. Sounds a little funny to you, doesn't it? Well, I'll explain if you'd like to make certain it's all straight. About that long ago there used to be a restaurant where this store stands—'Big Joe' Brady's restaurant."

"Until five years ago," said the policeman. "It was torn down then." The man in the doorway struck a match and lit his cigar. The light showed a pale, square-jawed face with keen eyes, and a little white scar near his right eyebrow. His scarfpin was a large diamond, oddly set.

"Twenty years ago to-night," said the man, "I dined here at 'Big Joe' Brady's with Jimmy Wells, my best chum, and the finest chap in the world. He and I were raised here in New York, just like two brothers, together. I was eighteen and Jimmy was twenty. The next morning I was to start for the West to make my fortune. You couldn't have dragged Jimmy out of New York; he thought it was the only place on earth. Well, we agreed that night that we would meet here again exactly twenty years from that date and time, no matter what our conditions might be or from what distance we might have to come. We figured that in twenty years each of us ought to have our destiny worked out and our fortunes made, whatever they were going to be."

"It sounds pretty interesting," said the policeman. "Rather a long time between meets, though, it seems to me. Haven't you heard from your friend since you left?"

"Well, yes, for a time we corresponded," said the other. "But after a year or two we lost track of each other. You see, the West is a pretty big proposition, and I kept hustling around over it pretty lively. But I know Jimmy will meet me here if he's alive, for he always was the truest, staunchest old chap in the world. He'll never forget. I came a thousand miles to stand in this door to-night, and it's worth it if my old partner turns up."

The waiting man pulled out a handsome watch, the lids of it set with small diamonds.

"Three minutes to ten," he announced. "It was exactly ten o'clock when we parted here at the restaurant door."

"Did pretty well out West, didn't you?" asked the policeman.

"You bet! I hope Jimmy has done half as well. He was a kind of plodder, though, good fellow as he was. I've had to compete with some of the sharpest wits going to get my pile. A man gets in a groove in New York. It takes the West to put a razor-edge on him."

The policeman twirled his club and took a step or two.

"I'll be on my way. Hope your friend comes around all right. Going to call time on him sharp?"

"I should say not!" said the other. "I'll give him half an hour at least. If Jimmy is alive on earth he'll be here by that time. So long, officer."

"Good-night, sir," said the policeman, passing on along his beat, trying doors as he went.

There was now a fine, cold drizzle falling, and the wind had risen from its uncertain puffs into a steady blow. The few foot passengers astir in that quarter hurried dismally and silently along with coat collars turned high and pocketed hands. And in the door of the hardware store the man who had come a thousand miles to fill an appointment, uncertain almost to absurdity, with the friend of his youth, smoked his cigar and waited.

About twenty minutes he waited, and then a tall man in a long overcoat, with collar turned up to his ears, hurried across from the opposite side of the street. He went directly to the waiting man.

"Is that you, Bob?" he asked, doubtfully.

"Is that you, Jimmy Wells?" cried the man in the door.

"Bless my heart!" exclaimed the new arrival, grasping both the other's hands with his own. "It's Bob, sure as fate. I was certain I'd find you here if you were still in existence. Well, well, well!—twenty years is a long time. The old restaurant's gone, Bob; I wish it had lasted, so we could have had another dinner there. How has the West treated you, old man?"

"Bully; it has given me everything I asked it for. You've changed lots, Jimmy. I never thought you were so tall by two or three inches."

"Oh, I grew a bit after I was twenty."

"Doing well in New York, Jimmy?"

"Moderately. I have a position in one of the city departments. Come on, Bob; we'll go around to a place I know of, and have a good long talk about old times."

The two men started up the street, arm in arm. The man from the West, his egotism enlarged by success, was beginning to outline the history of his career. The other, submerged in his overcoat, listened with interest.

At the corner stood a drug store, brilliant with electric lights. When they came into this glare each of them turned simultaneously to gaze upon the other's face.

The man from the West stopped suddenly and released his arm.

"You're not Jimmy Wells," he snapped. "Twenty years is a long time, but not long enough to change a man's nose from a Roman to a pug."

"It sometimes changes a good man into a bad one," said the tall man.

"You've been under arrest for ten minutes, 'Silky' Bob. Chicago thinks you may have dropped over our way and wires us she wants to have a chat with you. Going quietly, are you? That's sensible. Now, before we go on to the station here's a note I was asked to hand you. You may read it here at the window. It's from Patrolman Wells."

The man from the West unfolded the little piece of paper handed him. His hand was steady when he began to read, but it trembled a little by the time he had finished. The note was rather short.

Bob: I was at the appointed place on time. When you struck the match to light your cigar I saw it was the face of the man wanted in Chicago. Somehow I couldn't do it myself, so I went around and got a plain clothes man to do the job.

BABES IN THE JUNGLE

by: O. Henry (1862-1910)

The following story is reprinted from *Strictly Business; More Stories of the Four Million*. O. Henry. New York: Doubleday, 1919.

Montague Silver, the finest street man and art grafter in the West, says to me once in Little Rock: "If you ever lose your mind, Billy, and get too old to do honest swindling among grown men, go to New York. In the West a sucker is born every minute; but in New York they appear in chunks of roe -- you can't count 'em!"

Two years afterward I found that I couldn't remember the names of the Russian admirals, and I noticed some gray hairs over my left ear; so I knew the time had arrived for me to take Silver's advice.

I struck New York about noon one day, and took a walk up Broadway. And I run against Silver himself, all encompassed up in a spacious kind of haberdashery, leaning against a hotel and rubbing the half-moons on his nails with a silk handkerchief.

"Paresis or superannuated?" I asks him.

"Hello, Billy," says Silver; "I'm glad to see you. Yes, it seemed to me that the West was accumulating a little too much wiseness. I've been saving New York for dessert. I know it's a low-down trick to take things from these people. They only know this and that and pass to and fro and think ever and anon. I'd hate for my mother to know I was skinning these weak-minded ones. She raised me better."

"Is there a crush already in the waiting rooms of the old doctor that does skin grafting?" I asks.

"Well, no," says Silver; "you needn't back Epidermis to win to-day. I've only been here a month. But I'm ready to begin; and the members of Willie Manhattan's Sunday School class, each of whom has volunteered to contribute a portion of cuticle toward this rehabilitation, may as well send their photos to the Evening Daily.

"I've been studying the town," says Silver, "and reading the papers every day, and I know it as well as the cat in the City Hall knows an O'Sullivan. People here lie down on the floor and scream and kick when you are the least bit slow about taking money from them. Come up in my

room and I'll tell you. We'll work the town together, Billy, for the sake of old times."

Silver takes me up in a hotel. He has a quantity of irrelevant objects lying about.

"There's more ways of getting money from these metropolitan hayseeds," says Silver, "than there is of cooking rice in Charleston, S. C. They'll bite at anything. The brains of most of 'em commute. The wiser they are in intelligence the less perception of cognizance they have. Why, didn't a man the other day sell J. P. Morgan an oil portrait of Rockefeller, Jr., for Andrea del Sarto's celebrated painting of the young Saint John!

"You see that bundle of printed stuff in the corner, Billy? That's gold mining stock. I started out one day to sell that, but I quit it in two hours. Why? Got arrested for blocking the street. People fought to buy it. I sold the policeman a block of it on the way to the station-house, and then I took it off the market. I don't want people to give me their money. I want some little consideration connected with the transaction to keep my pride from being hurt. I want 'em to guess the missing letter in Chicago, or draw to a pair of nines before they pay me a cent of money.

"Now there's another little scheme that worked so easy I had to quit it. You see that bottle of blue ink on the table? I tattooed an anchor on the back of my hand and went to a bank and told 'em I was Admiral Dewey's nephew. They offered to cash my draft on him for a thousand, but I didn't know my uncle's first name. It shows, though, what an easy town it is. As for burglars, they won't go in a house now unless there's a hot supper ready and a few college students to wait on 'em. They're slugging citizens all over the upper part of the city and I guess, taking the town from end to end, it's a plain case of assault and Battery."

"Monty," says I, when Silver had slacked, up, "you may have Manhattan correctly discriminated in your perorative, but I doubt it. I've only been in town two hours, but it don't dawn upon me that it's ours with a cherry in it. There ain't enough rus in urbe about it to suit me. I'd be a good deal much better satisfied if the citizens had a straw or more in their hair, and run more to velveten vests and buckeye watch charms. They don't look easy to me."

"You've got it, Billy," says Silver. "All emigrants have it. New York's bigger than Little Rock or Europe, and it frightens a foreigner. You'll be all right. I tell you I feel like slapping the people here because they don't send

me all their money in laundry baskets, with germicide sprinkled over it. I hate to go down on the street to get it. Who wears the diamonds in this town? Why, Winnie, the Wiretapper's wife, and Bella, the Buncosteerer's bride. New Yorkers can be worked easier than a blue rose on a tidy. The only thing that bothers me is I know I'll break the cigars in my vest pocket when I get my clothes all full of twenties."

"I hope you are right, Monty," says I; "but I wish all the same I had been satisfied with a small business in Little Rock. The crop of farmers is never so short out there but what you can get a few of 'em to sign a petition for a new post office that you can discount for \$200 at the county bank. The people here appear to possess instincts of self-preservation and illiberality. I fear me that we are not cultured enough to tackle this game."

"Don't worry," says Silver. "I've got this Jayville-near-Tarrytown correctly estimated as sure as North River is the Hudson and East River ain't a river. Why, there are people living in four blocks of Broadway who never saw any kind of a building except a skyscraper in their lives! A good, live hustling Western man ought to get conspicuous enough here inside of three months to incur either Jerome's clemency or Lawson's displeasure."

"Hyperbole aside," says I, "do you know of any immediate system of buncoing the community out of a dollar or two except by applying to the Salvation Army or having a fit on Miss Helen Gould's doorsteps?"

"Dozens of 'em," says Silver. "How much capital have you got, Billy?"

"A thousand," I told him.

"I've got \$1,200," says he. "We'll pool and do a big piece of business. There's so many ways we can make a million that I don't know how to begin."

The next morning Silver meets me at the hotel and he is all sonorous and stirred with a kind of silent joy.

"We're to meet J. P. Morgan this afternoon," says he. "A man I know in the hotel wants to introduce us. He's a friend of his. He says he likes to meet people from the West."

"That sounds nice and plausible," says I. "I'd like to know Mr. Morgan."

"It won't hurt us a bit," says Silver, "to get acquainted with a few finance kings. I kind of like the social way New York has with strangers."

The man Silver knew was named Klein. At three o'clock Klein brought his Wall Street friend to see us in Silver's room. "Mr. Morgan" looked

some like his pictures, and he had a Turkish towel wrapped around his left foot, and he walked with a cane.

"Mr. Silver and Mr. Pescud," says Klein. "It sounds superfluous," says he, "to mention the name of the greatest financial--"

"Cut it out, Klein," says Mr. Morgan. "I'm glad to know you gents; I take great interest in the West. Klein tells me you're from Little Rock. I think I've a railroad or two out there somewhere. If either of you guys would like to deal a hand or two of stud poker I--"

"Now, Pierpont," cuts in Klein, "you forget!"

"Excuse me, gents!" says Morgan; "since I've had the gout so bad I sometimes play a social game of cards at my house. Neither of you never knew One-eyed Peters, did you, while you was around Little Rock? He lived in Seattle, New Mexico."

Before we could answer, Mr. Morgan hammers on the floor with his cane and begins to walk up and down, swearing in a loud tone of voice.

"They have been pounding your stocks to-day on the Street, Pierpont?" asks Klein, smiling.

"Stocks! No!" roars Mr. Morgan. "It's that picture I sent an agent to Europe to buy. I just thought about it. He cabled me to-day that it ain't to be found in all Italy. I'd pay \$50,000 to-morrow for that picture, yes, \$75,000. I give the agent a la carte in purchasing it. I cannot understand why the art galleries will allow a De Vinchy too."

"Why, Mr. Morgan," says Klein; "I thought you owned all of the De Vinchy paintings."

"What is the picture like, Mr. Morgan?" asks Silver. "It must be as big as the side of the Flatiron Building."

"I'm afraid your art education is on the bum, Mr. Silver," says Morgan. "The picture is 27 inches by 42; and it is called 'Love's Idle Hour.' It represents a number of cloak models doing the two-step on the bank of a purple river. The cablegram said it might have been brought to this country. My collection will never be complete without that picture. Well, so long, gents; us financiers must keep early hours."

Mr. Morgan and Klein went away together in a cab. Me and Silver talked about how simple and unsuspecting great people was; and Silver said what a shame it would be to try to rob a man like Mr. Morgan; and I said I thought it would be rather imprudent, myself. Klein proposes a stroll after dinner; and me and him and Silver walks down toward Seventh

Avenue to see the sights. Klein sees a pair of cuff links that instigate his admiration in a pawnshop window, and we all go in while he buys 'em. After we got back to the hotel and Klein had gone, Silver jumps at me and waves his hands.

"Did you see it?" says he. "Did you see it, Billy?" "What?" I asks.

"Why, that picture that Morgan wants. It's hanging in that pawnshop, behind the desk. I didn't say anything because Klein was there. It's the article sure as you live. The girls are as natural as paint can make them, all measuring 36 and 25 and 42 skirts, if they had any skirts, and they're doing a buck-and-wing on the bank of a river with the blues. What did Mr. Morgan say he'd give for it? Oh, don't make me tell you. They can't know what it is in that pawnshop."

When the pawnshop opened the next morning me and Silver was standing there as anxious as if we wanted to soak our Sunday suit to buy a drink. We sauntered inside, and began to look at watch-chains.

"That's a violent specimen of a chromo you've got up there," remarked Silver, casual, to the pawnbroker. "But I kind of enthuse over the girl with the shoulder-blades and red bunting. Would an offer of \$2.25 for it cause you to knock over any fragile articles of your stock in hurrying it off the nail?"

The pawnbroker smiles and goes on showing us plate watch-chains.

"That picture," says he, "was pledged a year ago by an Italian gentleman. I loaned him \$500 on it. It is called 'Love's Idle Hour,' and it is by Leonardo de Vinchy. Two days ago the legal time expired, and it became an unredeemed pledge. Here is a style of chain that is worn a great deal now." At the end of half an hour me and Silver paid the pawnbroker \$2,000 and walked out with the picture. Silver got into a cab with it and started for Morgan's office. I goes to the hotel and waits for him. In two hours Silver comes back.

"Did you see Mr. Morgan?" I asks. "How much did he pay you for it?" Silver sits down and fools with a tassel on the table cover.

"I never exactly saw Mr. Morgan," he says, "because Mr. Morgan's been in Europe for a month. But what's worrying me, Billy, is this: The department stores have all got that same picture on sale, framed, for \$3.48. And they charge \$3.50 for the frame alone -- that's what I can't understand."

WHILE THE AUTO WAITS

by: O. Henry (1862-1910)

The following story is reprinted from *The Voice of the City*. O. Henry.
New York: Doubleday, 1919.

Promptly at the beginning of twilight, came again to that quiet corner of that quiet, small park the girl in gray. She sat upon a bench and read a book, for there was yet to come a half hour in which print could be accomplished.

To repeat: Her dress was gray, and plain enough to mask its impeccancy of style and fit. A large-meshed veil imprisoned her turban hat and a face that shone through it with a calm and unconscious beauty. She had come there at the same hour on the day previous, and on the day before that; and there was one who knew it.

The young man who knew it hovered near, relying upon burnt sacrifices to the great joss, Luck. His piety was rewarded, for, in turning a page, her book slipped from her fingers and bounded from the bench a full yard away.

The young man pounced upon it with instant avidity, returning it to its owner with that air that seems to flourish in parks and public places -- a compound of gallantry and hope, tempered with respect for the policeman on the beat. In a pleasant voice, he risked an inconsequent remark upon the weather -- that introductory topic responsible for so much of the world's unhappiness -- and stood poised for a moment, awaiting his fate.

The girl looked him over leisurely; at his ordinary, neat dress and his features distinguished by nothing particular in the way of expression.

"You may sit down, if you like," she said, in a full, deliberate contralto. "Really, I would like to have you do so. The light is too bad for reading. I would prefer to talk."

The vassal of Luck slid upon the seat by her side with complaisance.

"Do you know," he said, speaking the formula with which park chairmen open their meetings, "that you are quite the stunningest girl I have seen in a long time? I had my eye on you yesterday. Didn't know somebody was bowled over by those pretty lamps of yours, did you, honeysuckle?"

"Whoever you are," said the girl, in icy tones, "you must remember that I am a lady. I will excuse the remark you have just made because the

mistake was, doubtless, not an unnatural one -- in your circle. I asked you to sit down; if the invitation must constitute me your honeysuckle, consider it withdrawn."

"I earnestly beg your pardon," pleaded the young man. His expression of satisfaction had changed to one of penitence and humility. "It was my fault, you know -- I mean, there are girls in parks, you know -- that is, of course, you don't know, but--"

"Abandon the subject, if you please. Of course I know. Now, tell me about these people passing and crowding, each way, along these paths. Where are they going? Why do they hurry so? Are they happy?"

The young man had promptly abandoned his air of coquetry. His cue was now for a waiting part; he could not guess the rôle he would be expected to play.

"It is interesting to watch them," he replied, postulating her mood. "It is the wonderful drama of life. Some are going to supper and some to -- er -- other places. One wonders what their histories are."

"I do not," said the girl; "I am not so inquisitive. I come here to sit because here, only, can I be near the great, common, throbbing heart of humanity. My part in life is cast where its beats are never felt. Can you surmise why I spoke to you, Mr.—?"

"Parkenstacker," supplied the young man. Then he looked eager and hopeful.

"No," said the girl, holding up a slender finger, and smiling slightly. "You would recognize it immediately. It is impossible to keep one's name out of print. Or even one's portrait. This veil and this hat of my maid furnish me with an incog. You should have seen the chauffeur stare at it when he thought I did not see. Candidly, there are five or six names that belong in the holy of holies, and mine, by the accident of birth, is one of them. I spoke to you, Mr. Stackenpot..."

"Parkenstacker," corrected the young man, modestly.

"...Mr. Parkenstacker, because I wanted to talk, for once, with a natural man -- one unspoiled by the despicable gloss of wealth and supposed social superiority. Oh! you do not know how weary I am of it -- money, money, money! And of the men who surround me, dancing like little marionettes all cut by the same pattern. I am sick of pleasure, of jewels, of travel, of society, of luxuries of all kinds."

"I always had an idea," ventured the young man, hesitatingly, "that money must be a pretty good thing."

"A competence is to be desired. But when you have so many millions that-!" She concluded the sentence with a gesture of despair. "It is the monotony of it," she continued, "that palls. Drives, dinners, theatres, balls, suppers, with the gilding of superfluous wealth over it all. Sometimes the very tinkle of the ice in my champagne glass nearly drives me mad."

Mr. Parkenstacker looked ingenuously interested.

"I have always liked," he said, "to read and hear about the ways of wealthy and fashionable folks. I suppose I am a bit of a snob. But I like to have my information accurate. Now, I had formed the opinion that champagne is cooled in the bottle and not by placing ice in the glass."

The girl gave a musical laugh of genuine amusement.

"You should know," she explained, in an indulgent tone, "that we of the non-useful class depend for our amusement upon departure from precedent. Just now it is a fad to put ice in champagne. The idea was originated by a visiting Prince of Tartary while dining at the Waldorf. It will soon give way to some other whim. Just as at a dinner party this week on Madison Avenue a green kid glove was laid by the plate of each guest to be put on and used while eating olives."

"I see," admitted the young man, humbly.

"These special diversions of the inner circle do not become familiar to the common public."

"Sometimes," continued the girl, acknowledging his confession of error by a slight bow, "I have thought that if I ever should love a man it would be one of lowly station. One who is a worker and not a drone. But, doubtless, the claims of caste and wealth will prove stronger than my inclination. Just now I am besieged by two. One is a Grand Duke of a German principality. I think he has, or has had, a wife, somewhere, driven mad by his intemperance and cruelty. The other is an English Marquis, so cold and mercenary that I even prefer the diabolism of the Duke. What is it that impels me to tell you these things, Mr. Packenstacker?"

"Parkenstacker," breathed the young man. "Indeed, you cannot know how much I appreciate your confidences."

The girl contemplated him with the calm, impersonal regard that befitted the difference in their stations.

"What is your line of business, Mr. Parkenstacker?" she asked.

"A very humble one. But I hope to rise in the world. Were you really in earnest when you said that you could love a man of lowly position?"

"Indeed I was. But I said 'might.' There is the Grand Duke and the Marquis, you know. Yes; no calling could be too humble were the man what I would wish him to be."

"I work," declared Mr. Parkenstacker, "in a restaurant."

The girl shrank slightly.

"Not as a waiter?" she said, a little imploringly. "Labor is noble, but personal attendance, you know -- valets and--"

"I am not a waiter. I am cashier in" -- on the street they faced that bounded the opposite side of the park was the brilliant electric sign "RESTAURANT" -- "I am cashier in that restaurant you see there."

The girl consulted a tiny watch set in a bracelet of rich design upon her left wrist, and rose, hurriedly. She thrust her book into a glittering reticule suspended from her waist, for which, however, the book was too large.

"Why are you not at work?" she asked.

"I am on the night turn," said the young man; "it is yet an hour before my period begins. May I not hope to see you again?"

"I do not know. Perhaps -- but the whim may not seize me again. I must go quickly now. There is a dinner, and a box at the play and, oh! the same old round. Perhaps you noticed an automobile at the upper corner of the park as you came. One with a white body."

"And red running gear?" asked the young man, knitting his brows reflectively.

"Yes. I always come in that. Pierre waits for me there. He supposes me to be shopping in the department store across the square. Conceive of the bondage of the life wherein we must deceive even our chauffeurs. Good-night."

"But it is dark now," said Mr. Parkenstacker, "and the park is full of rude men. May I not walk"

"If you have the slightest regard for my wishes," said the girl, firmly, "you will remain at this bench for ten minutes after I have left. I do not mean to accuse you, but you are probably aware that autos generally bear the monogram of their owner. Again, good-night."

Swift and stately she moved away through the dusk. The young man watched her graceful form as she reached the pavement at the park's edge, and turned up along it toward the corner where stood the automobile. Then

he treacherously and unhesitatingly began to dodge and skim among the park trees and shrubbery in a course parallel to her route, keeping her well in sight.

When she reached the corner she turned her head to glance at the motor car, and then passed it, continuing on across the street. Sheltered behind a convenient standing cab, the young man followed her movements closely with his eyes. Passing down the sidewalk of the street opposite the park, she entered the restaurant with the blazing sign. The place was one of those frankly glaring establishments, all white paint and glass, where one may dine cheaply and conspicuously. The girl penetrated the restaurant to some retreat at its rear, whence she quickly emerged without her hat and veil.

The cashier's desk was well to the front. A red-haired girl on the stool climbed down, glancing pointedly at the clock as she did so. The girl in gray mounted in her place.

The young man thrust his hands into his pockets and walked slowly back along the sidewalk. At the corner his foot struck a small, paper-covered volume lying there, sending it sliding to the edge of the turf. By its picturesque cover he recognized it as the book the girl had been reading. He picked it up carelessly, and saw that its title was "New Arabian Nights," the author being of the name of Stevenson. He dropped it again upon the grass, and lounged, irresolute, for a minute. Then he stepped into the automobile, reclined upon the cushions, and said two words to the chauffeur: "Club, Henri."

In 1919 I happened to be in Chicago on my way to the Far East, and for reasons that have nothing to do with this narrative I was staying there for two or three weeks. I had recently brought out a successful novel and being for the moment news, I had no sooner arrived than I was interviewed. Next morning my telephone rang. I answered.

'Elliott Templeton speaking.'

'Elliott? I thought you were in Paris.'

'No, I'm visiting with my sister. We want you to come along and lunch with us today.'

'I should love to.'

He named the hour and gave me the address. I had known Elliott Templeton for fifteen years. He was at this time in his late fifties, a tall, elegant man with good features and thick waving dark hair only

sufficiently greying to add to the distinction of his appearance. He was always beautifully dressed. He got his haberdashery at Charvet's, but his suits, his shoes, and his hats in London. He had an apartment in Paris on the Rive Gauche in the fashionable Rue St Guillaume. People who did not like him said he was a dealer, but this was a charge that he resented with indignation. He had taste and knowledge, and he did not mind admitting that in bygone years, when he first settled in Paris, he had given rich collectors who wanted to buy pictures the benefit of his advice; and when through his social **connexions** he heard that some impoverished nobleman, English or French, was disposed to sell a picture of first-rate quality he was glad to put him in touch with the directors of American museums who, he happened to know, were on the lookout for a fine example of such and such a master.

There were many old families in France and some in England whose circumstances compelled them to part with a signed piece of Buhl or a writing-table made by Chippendale himself if it could be done quietly, and they were glad to know a man of great culture and perfect manners who could arrange the matter with discretion.

One would naturally suppose that Elliott profited by the transactions, but one was too well bred to mention it. Unkind people asserted that everything in his apartment was for sale and that after he had invited wealthy Americans for an excellent lunch, with vintage wines, one or two of his valuable drawings would disappear, or a marquetry commode would be replaced by one in lacquer. When he was asked why a particular piece had vanished he very plausibly explained that he hadn't thought it quite up to his mark and had exchanged it for one of much finer quality, he added that it was tiresome always to look at the same things.

'**Nous autres Américains**, we Americans,' he said, 'like change. It is at once our weakness and our strength.' Some of the American ladies in Paris, who claimed to know all about him, said that his family was quite poor and if he was able to live in the way he did it was only because he had been very clever. I do not know how much money he had, but his ducal landlord certainly made him pay a lot for his apartment and it was furnished with objects of value. On the walls were drawings by the great French masters, Watteau, Fragonard, Claude Lorraine and so on; **Savonnerie and Aubusson rugs** displayed their beauty on the parquet floors; and in the drawing-room there was a Louis Quinze suite in **petit**

point of such elegance that it might well have belonged, as he claimed, to Madame de Pompadour.

Anyhow he had enough to live in what he considered was the proper style for a gentleman without trying to earn money, and the method by which he had done so in the past was a matter which, unless you wished to lose his acquaintance, you were wise not to refer to. Thus relieved of material cares he gave himself over to the ruling passion of his life, which was social relationships. His business connexions with the impecunious great both in France and in England had secured the foothold he had obtained on his arrival in Europe as a young man with letters of introduction to persons of consequence.

His origins recommended him to the American ladies of title to whom he brought letters, for he was of an old Virginian family and through his mother traced his descent from one of the signatories of the Declaration of Independence. He was well-favoured, bright, a good dancer, a fair shot, and a fine tennis player. He was an asset at any party. He was lavish with flowers and expensive boxes of chocolates, and though he entertained little, when he did it was with an originality that pleased. It amused these rich ladies to be taken to bohemian restaurants in Soho or bistros in the Latin Quarter.

He was always prepared to make himself useful, and there was nothing, however tiresome, that you asked him to do for you that he would not do with pleasure. He took an immense amount of trouble to make himself agreeable to ageing women, and it was not long before he was the *ami de la maison*, the household pet, in many an imposing mansion. His amiability was extreme; he never minded being asked at the last moment because someone had thrown you over and you could put him next to a very boring old lady and count on him to be as charming and amusing with her as he knew how.

In two or more years, both in London to which he went for the last part of the season and to pay a round of country house visits in the early autumn, and in Paris, where he had settled down, he knew everyone whom a young American could know. The ladies who had first introduced him into society were surprised to discover how wide the circle of his acquaintance had grown. Their feelings were mixed. On the one hand they were pleased that their young protege had made so great a success, and on the other a trifle nettled that he should be on intimate terms with persons

with whom their own relations had remained strictly formal. Though he continued to be obliging and useful to them, they were uneasily conscious that he had used them as stepping-stones to his social advancement. They were afraid he was a snob. And of course he was. He was a colossal snob. He was a snob without shame. He would put up with any affront, he would ignore any rebuff, he would swallow any rudeness to get asked to a party he wanted to go to or to make a connexion with some crusty old dowager of great name. He was indefatigable. When he had fixed his eye on his prey he hunted it with the persistence of a botanist who will expose himself to dangers of flood, earthquake, fever, and hostile natives to find an orchid of peculiar rarity. The war of 1914 gave him his final chance. When it broke out he joined an ambulance corps and served first in Flanders and then in the Argonne; he came back after a year with a red ribbon in his buttonhole and secured a position in the Red Cross in Paris. By then he was in affluent circumstances and he contributed generously to the good works patronized by persons of consequence. He was always ready with his exquisite taste and his gift for organization to help in any charitable function that was widely publicized. He became a member of the two most exclusive clubs in Paris. He was **ce cher Elliott** to the greatest ladies in France. He had finally arrived.

[<http://book.ilkkaddimlar.com/>]

Texts for Discussion

Text 1

Fashion : It's History and Social Importance

The word fashion means manner, way, style, shape, custom, habit. Nowadays, the word is used in the meaning of "taste", in connection with clothing and the outward appearance of men and women (from hairstyle **to** make-up). The word "fashion" is also used when we speak about our way of living or acting (e. g. people's behaviour may be old-fashioned or modern; a house may be furnished in an old-fashioned way or in a modern way).

In antiquity the style of clothing didn't change very much over the years. In foreign cultures too, these changes were almost unnoticeable. In medieval times a process started in Europe which caused rapid changes in

clothing in combination with changes in the appearance of people. From then on the idea "fashion" was used in a wider sense.

The fashion was initially determined by political powers, e. g. the Burgundians and the Italian cities during the Renaissance (about 1500). Later the Spanish and French courts were most influential. With the rise of the middle classes a second trend in fashion developed, partly following the fashion at the courts, partly taking its own course. Large groups of the population, e. g. the rural population, were not affected by fashion for a long time.

At the courts you could see to which class somebody belonged by just looking at their appearance. The important people in particular used very expensive materials and spent gigantic sums of money to buy fashionable clothing. The social changes and changes in moral ideas were always of importance to fashion.

The French Revolution announced a new civil fashion, a fashion which had found its origin in England. The Industrial Revolution and the mass-production in the 19th century are of essential importance. The common people determined the fashion from then on. Due to urbanization and the mass-media in the 20th century almost everyone knows what's "fashionable".

The main periods in the development of the fashion are: Romanticism (± 1100), Renaissance (± 1500), Baroque (± 1670), Rococo (± 1750), the Pigtail period (± 1780). During the last decades we have New Look (± 1949), the period of the mini-skirts (± 1970) and the Nostalgic period (± 1977).

Not everybody can afford the most recent designs, appearing every season, thought up by designers such as Coco Chanel, Pierre Balmain and Christian Dior. Some people just refuse to wear the latest in fashion. Others wear worn clothes as a protest against the fashion which is forced on to the people. Thanks to these "rebels" we can wear blue jeans.

1. When is the word "fashion" used?
2. Speak about the beginning of the development of fashion.
3. Who determined fashion initially?
4. Mention some important events which have influenced fashion.
5. Mention a few periods in the development of fashion.
6. Why isn't everyone dressed after the latest fashion?
7. Talk about the importance of fashion parades, of national costumes.

8. What, besides clothing, is part of fashion?

Text 2

Is Smoking Really Harmful?

Smoking cigarettes is the most common way of smoking at present in Europe, but people started doing this not so terribly long ago. During and shortly after the Crimean War (1853-1856) the English and French soldiers introduced this way of smoking into their countries. Wrapping tobacco in paper was something they saw the Russians and Turks do. Through the-mechanical production of the cigarette this way of smoking became very popular in all countries and in all classes of the population. The cigarette succeeded in pushing back other ways of enjoying tobacco such as taking snuff and chewing tobacco. Expensive advertising caused an increasingly higher turnover. Advertising cigarettes on TV is forbidden at the moment and some magazines have stopped advertising too.

People say that the cigarette is a means of making contact with fellow men easier. Offering each other a cigarette creates common interests, they say. The individual smoker is thought to be able to relax better when smoking a cigarette. A cigarette gives rest and stimulates at the same time. It is said that smoking a cigarette keeps the level of performance high because nicotine stimulates the activity of the brains.

When inhaling people get nicotine in their bloodstream. Nicotine is a much used means against plant-diseases and a way of destroying insects and is therefore one of the most powerful poisons to man. The fatal quantity is 50 milligram. This dose is never reached because the process of smoking many cigarettes is usually spread over a longer period of time. The body finds time to break down the poison and to get rid of it. Although smoking hasn't got an immediate deadly effect, it still is a process of poisoning e.g. Smoking influences the blood pressure and the working of the heart. The quantity of tar in the smoke is harmful to the respiratory organs.

Tar and nicotine may cause tumours in the kidneys and the bladder. Cancer of the kidneys is found 5 times as often with smokers than with non-smokers.

A super-filter which takes all harmful parts out of the smoke doesn't exist. The much spoken of non-nicotine cigarette can't eliminate the risk to

health. It's known that people who started smoking filter-cigarettes or non-nicotine cigarettes, smoke more and more, because their bodies are in need of nicotine.

Yes, smokers cause damage to non-smokers. An example: when you smoke in a car with the windows closed, the percentage of carbon monoxide rises rapidly. This higher percentage of gas influences the powers of concentration of the passengers and is harmful to cardiac patients. Smoking in closed rooms is a kind of pollution and is not only dangerous to smokers but also to non-smokers.

1. When did people start smoking?
2. Why do people smoke?
3. How may smoking be harmful?
4. Does something like a super-filter exist?
5. Do smokers cause damage to their fellow men?
6. Give some hints how to give up smoking (think of using chewing-gum instead of cigarettes; going for a walk and doing some sport; not taking any matches; not providing any ashtrays).
7. Say what moment changed the narrator's whole life.

Text 3

How I Became a Writer (After Roald Dahl)

A fiction writer is a person who invents stories. But how does one start on a job like this and become a full-time professional writer? Nowadays just about every single successful writer has started out in some other job - a schoolteacher, perhaps, or a doctor or a journalist or a lawyer. Let me tell you how I myself got in through the back door and found myself in the world of fiction.

At the age of eight, in 1924, I was sent away to boarding school in a town called Weston-Super-Mare, on the southwest coast of England. Those were days of horror, of fierce discipline, of no talking in the dormitories, no running in the corridors, no this or that or the other, just rules, rules and more rules that had to be obeyed. My memories of school are mostly nightmarish.

My end-of-term reports contained only uncomplimentary words about my abilities in the subject called English Composition. Only some of the

examples are "incapable of putting his words on paper", "vocabulary limited", "idle and illiterate", "no interesting ideas".

Little wonder that it never entered my head to become a writer in those days. When I left school at the age of eighteen, in 1934, I turned down my mother's offer (my father died when I was three) to go to university. Unless one was going to become a doctor, a lawyer, a scientist, an engineer or some other kind of professional person, I saw little point in wasting three or four years at Oxford or Cambridge, and I still hold this view. Instead, I had a passionate wish to go abroad, to travel, to see distant lands.

So I got a job at the Shell Oil Company, where they promised me that after two or three years' training in England, I would be sent off to a foreign country. "Which one?" I asked. "Who knows?" the man answered. "It depends where there is a vacancy. It could be Egypt or China or India or almost anywhere in the world." That sounded like fun. It was fun. When my turn came to be sent abroad three years later, I was told it would be East Africa. That journey took two and a half weeks. We went through the Bay of Biscay and called in at Gibraltar. We headed down the Mediterranean by way of Malta, Naples and Port Said. We went through the Suez Canal and down the Red Sea. It was all tremendously exciting. For the first time, I saw great sandy deserts, and Arab soldiers on camels, and palm trees with dates growing on them, and flying fish and thousands of other marvellous things.

By the summer of 1939, it became obvious that there was going to be a war with Hitler's Germany. On the next day after Britain entered the war I got into my car and drove north to Nairobi, in Kenya, to join the RAF. For six months they trained us in small airplanes called Tiger Moths, and those days were also glorious. There were twenty of us training to be pilots out there in Nairobi. Seventeen of those twenty were killed during the war. I myself was shot down. My plane crashed in the Libyan desert and burst into flames, but I managed to get out and was finally rescued by our soldiers. In 1942 my injuries began to give me too much trouble and had to stop flying. They gave me a month's leave and then sent me to Washington, D. C. as assistant air attache, at this point the United States was already in the war as well.

I was twenty-six years old when I arrived in Washington, and I still had no thoughts of becoming a writer. During the morning of my third

day, I was sitting in my new office at the British Embassy when there was a knock on my door. "Come in."

A very small man with thick spectacles entered the room. "Forgive me for bothering you," he said. "My name is Forester. C. S. Forester."²

I nearly fell out of my chair. "Are you joking?" I said. "No," he said, smiling. "That's me." And it was. It was the great writer himself.

"Look," he said. "A magazine called the *Saturday Evening Post* will publish any story I write. I have a contract with them. And I have come to you because I think you might have a good story to tell. I mean about flying. Come and have lunch with me," he said. "And while we're eating, you can tell me all about it. Tell me your most exciting adventure. I'll write it up for the *Saturday Evening Post*. The Americans should know more about this war and help us."

I was thrilled. I had never met a famous writer before. In the small French restaurant we took roast duck with vegetables and potatoes. The dish required so much attention that I found it difficult to talk. And apart from that, I have never been good at telling stories aloud. "Look," I said. "If you like I'll try to write down on paper what happened and send it to you. Then you can rewrite it properly yourself in your own good time. Wouldn't that be easier? I could do it tonight."

That, though I didn't know it at the time, was the moment that changed my life. That night I sat down and wrote my story. For the first time in my life, I became totally absorbed in what I was doing. I floated back in time and once again I was in the hot desert of Libya. Everything came back to me. Writing it down on paper was not difficult. The story seemed to be telling itself. When it was finished, I gave it a title. I called it "A Piece of Cake." The next day I sent it off to Mr Forester. Then I forgot all about it.

Exactly two weeks later, I received a reply from the great man. It said:

Dear RD,

You were meant to give me notes, not a finished story. Your piece is marvellous. It is the work of a gifted writer. I didn't touch a word of it. You will be happy to hear that the "Post" accepted it immediately and have paid one thousand dollars. I enclose the check. It's all yours. The "Post" is asking if you will write more stories for them. I do hope you will. Did you know you were a writer? With my best wishes and congratulations,
C.S.Forester

1. What kind of school was the narrator sent to: day or boarding? 2. What are some of the things that were forbidden in his school? 3. What did teachers think about his ability to write? 4. Why didn't the narrator want to go either to Oxford or to Cambridge? 5. Where did he want to go? 6. To what place did he go after three years of training? 7. What were some of the "marvellous things" he saw during his journey? 8. What did Roald become when the war began? 9. How long did he fly? Why did he have to stop flying? 10. What made him go to the USA? 11. Who came to see him one morning? What did that person want? 12. Why didn't Roald tell the writer about his adventures in the restaurant? 13. What did Roald call his first story? 14. What newspaper published his story? 15. What complimentary things did the great man write to Roald about his talent?

MODULE II

ENGLISH-SPEAKING COUNTRIES

THE UNITED KINGDOM OF GREAT BRITAIN AND NORTHERN IRELAND





Location

The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, commonly known as the United Kingdom, the UK, or Great Britain is situated on the British Isles. It is a sovereign island country located off the northwestern coast of continental Europe. The UK includes the island of Great Britain, the northeast part of the island of Ireland and many small islands. The island of Great Britain contains three "nations" which were separate at earlier stages of their history: England, Scotland and Wales.

The UK is washed by the Atlantic Ocean, the North Sea, the English Channel, the Strait of Dover and the Irish Sea. The largest island, Great Britain, is linked to France by the Channel Tunnel. The capital of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland is London. The capital of England is London, the capital of Scotland is Edinburgh, the capital of Wales is Cardiff, the capital of Northern Ireland is Belfast. There are many rivers in the country but they are not long: the longest river is the Severn (388km), the most important is the Thames (354 km). The highest mountains are Ben Nevis in Wales and Snowdon in Scotland.

The counties of Britain are territorial divisions of Britain for the purposes of administrative, political and geographical demarcation. For example, Essex, Kent, Norfolk, Devon, Cornwall and others. The names of many counties were historically created with the suffix *-shire*, for example Yorkshire, Hertfordshire, Cheshire and others. England, as well as being divided into counties, is also broken up into regions. In England, for instance, we distinguish: the **Midlands** (or the Heart of England - Birmingham, Oxford, Liverpool, Manchester), the **Southeast** (London, Windsor, Brighton, Reading), the **Southwest** (Southampton, Plymouth,

Portsmouth, Bristol), **East Anglia** (Cambridge), and **Northern England** (or Northumbria - Newcastle, York, Sunderland, Blackpool).

People may say, 'I'm from the Midlands' (rather than 'I'm from Oxford'), or 'I'm from the Northeast' (Newcastle), 'I'm from the Southeast' (Brighton). Alternatively, it is also possible to refer to an area in terms of its geographical features, for example, 'The Lake District' (Cumbria), 'The Cheviots', 'The Pennines', 'The Welsh Valleys' (Wales), the Highlands and the Lowlands (Scotland). The Association of British Counties (A.B.C.) is a society dedicated to promoting awareness of the continuing existence of the 86 traditional Counties of Britain. (England – 45 counties, Wales - 22 counties, Scotland – 30 counties (From the Association of British Counties Website)).

Government

Wales had become part of the English administrative system by the sixteenth century. Scotland was not completely united with England until 1707. The United Kingdom is a name which was introduced in 1801 when Great Britain became united with Ireland. When the Republic of Ireland became independent of London in 1922, the title was changed to its present form.

The United Kingdom is governed by a parliamentary system with its seat of the government in London, the capital, and is a constitutional monarchy with Queen Elizabeth II as the head of state. The Monarch of the UK also serves as head of state of fifteen other Commonwealth countries. The Crown Dependencies of the Channel Islands and the Isle of Man, formally possessions of the Crown, are not part of the UK but form a federacy with it. The Parliament of the United Kingdom has the authority to legislate for the dependencies, and the British government manages their foreign affairs and defence. The UK has no written constitution. The Monarch has very little power and can only reign with the support of the Parliament. The Parliament consists of two chambers known as the House of Lords and the House of Commons. In reality only the House of Commons is the only one of the three which has true power. It is here that new bills are introduced and debated. If the majority of the members are in favour of a bill it goes to the House of Lords to be debated and finally to

the Monarch to be signed. Only then does it become law. The Parliament of the United Kingdom meets in the Palace of Westminster.

The UK is a developed country, with the fifth (nominal GDP) or sixth (PPP) largest economy in the world. It is a member state of the European Union, holds a permanent seat on the United Nations Security Council, and is a member of the G8, NATO, WTO and the Commonwealth of Nations.

The population of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland is over 57 million people. The distribution of the population is rather uneven. Over 46 million people live in England, a little over 5 million live in Scotland, over 3 million in Wales and about 1,5 million in Northern Ireland. London's population is 7 million. There are only five cities with population over 500,000, although Manchester, Liverpool and Newcastle also exceed this figure if neighbouring towns are included.

The UK is inhabited by the English, the Scottish, the Welsh, and the Northern Irish, who constitute the British nation. The British are the descendants of different peoples who settled in the British Isles at different times.

About 2,000 years ago the British Isles were inhabited by the Celts who originally came from continental Europe. During the next 1,000 years there were many invasions. The Romans came from Italy in 43 A.D. and, in calling the country "Britania", gave Britain its name. The Angles and Saxons came from Germany, Denmark, and the Netherlands in the 5th century, and England gets its name from this invasion (Angle-land). The Vikings arrived from Denmark and Norway throughout the 9th century, and in 1066 the Normans invaded from France. These invasions drove the Celts into what is now Wales and Scotland, and they remained, of course, in Ireland. The English, on the other hand, are the descendants of all the invaders, but are more Anglo-Saxons than anything else. These various origins explain many of the differences to be found between England, Wales, Scotland and Ireland — differences in education, religion and the legal systems, but most obviously, in language.

London

London began life as a Roman fortification at a place where it was possible to cross the River Thames. A wall was built around the town for

defence, but during the long period of peace which followed the Norman Conquest, people built outside the walls.

These days not many people live in the city centre either, but London has spread further outwards into the country, including surrounding villages. Today the metropolis of Greater London covers some 1,580 sq. km and the suburbs of London continue even beyond this area.

London is by far the largest urban area in England. Some large cities which have become highly populated and have expanded into the surrounding countryside are known as conurbations. For example, Greater London, Birmingham, Greater Manchester, Leeds and Liverpool are conurbations.

Greater London is a huge multi-cultural city. It is divided into 32 administrative areas, called 'boroughs' or 'burghs' (*Scot E*) - districts, that have some powers of local government (such as Camden, Kensington and Chelsea, Hackney, Croydon, Westminster, Lambeth, Southwark, Greenwich, Barnet, and others) and the City of London.

London has a number of centres, each with a distinct character: the financial and business centre called the City, the government centre is Westminster, the shopping and entertainment centre in the West End, the industrial centre is the East End.

The City

The City refers to a small area of the centre, which includes the site of the original Roman town. It is an area of 2,650 sq. km with a long and exciting history, and it is proud of its independence and traditional role as a centre of trade and commerce. This tradition is focussed on the City's Lord Mayor, whose official residence is the Mansion House. Once a year, in November, the Lord Mayor's Show takes place. This is a colourful street parade in which the newly elected Lord Mayor travels in a golden coach, which is over 200 years old.

The City of London is one of the major banking centres of the world and you can find the banks of many nations in the famous Threadneedle Street and the surrounding area. Here, too, you will find **the Bank of England** and **the Stock Exchange**. A little further along in Leadenhall Street is **Lloyds**, the most famous insurance company in the world. The centre of the country's judicial system is to be found in the western part of the City. **The Old Bailey** houses many courts. Many solicitors and barristers have their offices (called "chambers") nearby, particularly in the

area known as the "Temple". **Fleet Street** is famous as the home of the nation's newspapers but, in fact, only two of them — The Daily Express and The Daily Telegraph — are still in Fleet Street. However, people still say "Fleet Street" to mean "the press".

Although hundreds of thousands of people (over 800,000) work in its offices by day, the City is almost deserted at night. Only about eight thousand actually live within the square mile. The City has its own governance and boundaries, giving it a distinctive status as the only completely autonomous borough in London.

There are some historic buildings in the City. **St. Paul's Cathedral** and **the Tower of London** are the most famous of them.

St. Paul's Cathedral is the work of the famous architect Sir Christopher Wren. It is said to be one of the finest pieces of architecture in Europe. Work on Wren's masterpiece began in 1675 after the Norman church, old St. Paul's was destroyed in the Great Fire in 1666. The building of St. Paul's Cathedral went on for 35 years, and Wren was an old man before it was finished. From far away you can see the huge dome with a golden ball and cross on the top. The interior of the Cathedral is very beautiful. It is full of monuments. The most important, perhaps, is the one dedicated to the Duke of Wellington. After looking around you can climb 263 steps to the Whispering Gallery, which runs round the dome. It is called so, because if someone whispers close to the wall on one side, a person with his ear close to the wall on the other side can hear what is said. But if you want to reach the foot of the ball, you have to climb 637 steps.

As for Christopher Wren, who is now known as "the architect of London", he found his fame only after his death. He was buried in the Cathedral. Buried here are Nelson, Wellington, and Sir Joshua Reynolds. The Tower on the north bank of the Thames is one of the most ancient buildings of London. It was founded in the 11th century by William the Conqueror. But each monarch left some kind of personal mark on it. For many centuries the Tower was a fortress, a palace, a prison and royal treasury. It is now a museum of arms and armour, and, as one of the strongest fortresses in Britain, it has the Crown Jewels. The ravens, whose forefathers used to find food in the Tower, still live here as part of its history. There is a legend that if the ravens disappear the Tower will fall. That is why the birds are carefully guarded.

The Tower is guarded by the Yeomen Warders popularly called "Beefeaters". Their everyday uniform is black and red, but on state occasions they wear a ceremonial dress which was in fashion in the 16th century.

Westminster

Every day when people in the UK and overseas switch on their radio to listen to BBC radio news, they can hear one of the most famous sounds in London. On the hour, the bells of Big Ben ring loud and clear.

Parliament itself is in **Westminster**, a part of London that has long been connected with royalty and government. King Edward the Confessor first decided to build a palace beside the River Thames in the 11th century. Gradually, Westminster became the centre of government and justice. At first, Parliament was organized by the monarch as a way of governing the country. He or she called different groups together: the Lords represented the Church and aristocracy whilst the Commons were used by the rich land-owners to put forward the views and interests of their own town or village. Over the centuries power gradually passed from the monarch to Parliament but not without a few problems!

The Queen still opens the new session of Parliament each autumn by reading "the Queen's Speech", which describes the main policies of the Government. However, this takes place in **the House of Lords** and she is not allowed to enter **the House of Commons**. This tradition goes back to the time of Charles I, more than three hundred years ago, and reminds everybody that the monarch must not try to govern the country.



The Houses of Parliament

The Houses of Parliament were rebuilt in 1835 after being completely destroyed by fire. In addition, the House of Commons needed more repairs after being bombed during the Second World War. Parliament is in session

every afternoon and evening except Friday and the weekend, and if you are lucky you might be able to watch a debate from the public gallery.

Opposite the Houses of Parliament stands **Westminster Abbey**. A church has stood here since Saxon times when, in the year 750 AD, a Benedictine Abbey was founded. It was known as West Monastery (Westminster), from its position five kilometres west of London's centre. From Norman times British monarchs have been crowned there and since the 13th century they have been buried there. Many other famous people are also buried in Westminster Abbey including statesmen, musicians and writers. In **Poet's Corner** can be found statues and the tombs of poets such as T. S. Eliot.

The street called **Whitehall** stretches from Parliament Square to Trafalgar Square. Whitehall is often used as a name for the Civil Service.

Downing Street, which is a small side street off Whitehall, is the home of the Prime Minister, who lives at number ten. Next door at number eleven lives the Chancellor of the Exchequer, who is responsible for financial planning and the British economy. Just around the corner in Whitehall itself are all the important ministries: the Foreign Office, the Ministry of Defence, the Home Office and the Treasury.

In the middle of Whitehall is **the Cenotaph** where the queen lays the first wreath of poppies on Remembrance Day. On that day each year the people of Britain remember their dead from the two world wars of this century by wearing a red paper poppy.

You cannot go far in London without being aware of the city's close connection with the Crown. There are royal palaces, royal parks and colourful ceremonies; if you look at the souvenirs you can see how important royalty is to the capital's tourist industry. The most important building, but not the most beautiful, is **Buckingham Palace**, which is the official residence of the Queen.

It overlooks St. James's Park where the previous royal residence, St. James's Palace, can be found. Running through the park, from Trafalgar Square to the front of Buckingham Palace is **the Mall**, a wide tree-lined avenue designed for royal processions on ceremonial occasions.

St. James's Park is one of ten royal parks in and around London which are owned by the Crown but are open to the public free of charge.

Each park has its own character. **Hyde Park**, for example, was originally a hunting forest and is still popular with horseriders. People

who enjoy a good argument can go to **Speakers' Corner** (near Marble Arch tube station), where they can listen to people giving their views on a variety of topics to anyone who will listen.

Regent's Park, which was also originally a hunting park, is now the home of London Zoo, and an open air theatre which delights summer audiences with performances of Shakespeare's plays.

Not all the parks are in the centre of London. **Greenwich**, where the Maritime Museum is, and **Richmond**, famous for its beautiful trees and wild deer, are both in the suburbs.

The area of Kensington and Knightsbridge is an exclusive part of London where you can find many foreign embassies, large, glamorous hotels, and the department store that is the symbol of expensive and high-class living — **Harrods**. People say you can buy anything in Harrods, including wild animals — they even have a zoo which will sell you lion cubs as well as more common pets such as dogs, cats or parrots. Harrods succeeded in supplying one customer with a baby elephant, although it had to be ordered specially!

Harrods is not the only attraction here; there is **the Albert Hall**, where there is a festival of popular classical music concerts every summer known as "the Proms". Sporting events such as tennis tournaments and boxing matches are also held there.

Three London's most interesting museums — **the Victoria and Albert**, **the Science Museum** and **the Natural History Museum** — are also in this area. The last, as its name suggests, has exhibits of birds, animals and reptiles as well as life-size reconstructions of prehistoric animals. The Victoria and Albert was founded with the aim of improving design in British manufacturing, but over the years it has expanded to include things from almost every place and period, including costumes from the theatre, and paintings. Finally there is the Science Museum, which is always crowded and is certainly the noisiest museum in London. It covers every aspect of science and technology, and the collections are constantly being moved round to make room for new acquisitions. They have inventions that did not become popular, such as the steam bicycle of 1912, and technological landmarks like the Cody biplane — the first aircraft to fly in England in 1912. In many of the rooms there are machines and computers that visitors can work themselves.

The West End

The West End is the name given to the area of central London north from the Mall to Oxford Street. It includes **Trafalgar Square**, the main shopping areas of **Oxford Street**, **Regent Street** and **Bond Street**, and the entertainment centres of Soho, **Picadilly Circus**, **Leicester Square** and **Shaftesbury Avenue**. Its name is associated with glamour and bright lights.

Trafalgar Square was built early in the last century to commemorate the Battle of Trafalgar. Admiral Lord Nelson's statue stands on top of a column in the middle of Trafalgar Square. Behind Nelson's Column is **the National Gallery**, an art gallery in which you can find many old masters.

Most of London's big department stores are in Oxford Street and Regent Street.

Piccadilly Circus is the centre of night life in the West End. It is usually top of everyone's list of things to see in London, because it is so well known. It is actually quite small, and most people are rather disappointed when they see it for the first time because they had imagined it would be much bigger! To the north of Piccadilly Circus is **Soho**, which has been the foreign quarter of London since the 17th century. Now it has restaurants offering food from a variety of different countries, especially Chinese and Italian ones, as well as "adult" entertainment.

The East End

The East End grew with the spread of industries to the east of the City, and the growth of the port of London. It covers a wide area. There are kilometres and kilometres of docks, and the great industrial areas that depend on shipping. Down by the river, there are many wharfs and warehouses. The East End is unattractive in appearance, but very important to the country's commerce.

Education



King's College, part of the University of Cambridge, England.

Nursery Education (under 5 years)

Children do not have to go to school until they reach the age of five, but there is some free nursery-school education before that age. Nursery schools are staffed with teachers and students in training. There are all kinds of toys to keep the children busy from 9 o'clock in the morning till 4 o'clock in the afternoon—while their parents are at work. Here the babies play, lunch and sleep. They can run about and play in safety with someone keeping an eye on them. However, Local Education Authority (LEA) do not have nursery school places for all who would like them and these places are usually given to families in special circumstances, for example families with one parent only. Because of the small number of nursery schools, parents in many areas have formed play groups where children under 5 years can go for a morning or afternoon a couple of times a week.

Primary Education (5 to 11 years)

Primary education takes place in infant schools (pupils aged from 5 to 7 years) and junior schools (from 8 to 11 years). Some LEAs have a different system in which middle schools replace junior schools and take pupils aged from 9 to 12 years.

At infant schools reading, writing and arithmetic are taught for about 20 minutes a day during the first year, gradually increasing to about 2 hours in their last year. There is usually no written timetable. Much time is spent in modelling from clay or drawing, reading and signing.

By the time children are ready for the junior school they will be able to read and write, do simple addition and subtraction of numbers.

At 8 children go on from the infant school to the junior school. This marks the transition from play to "real work". The children have set periods of arithmetic, reading and composition. History, Geography, Nature Study, Art and Music, Physical Education, Swimming are also on

the timetable. Pupils are streamed according to their abilities to learn into A, B, C, and D streams. The least gifted are in the D stream.

Secondary Education (11 to 16/18 years)

Since the 1944 Education Act of Parliament, free secondary education has been available to all children in Britain. Secondary schools are usually much larger than primary schools and most children — over 80 per cent — go to a comprehensive school at the age of 11. These schools are not selective — you don't have to pass an exam to go there.

In 1965 the Labour Government introduced the policy of comprehensive education. Before that time, all children took an exam at the age of 11 called the "11+". Approximately the top 20 per cent were chosen to go to the academic grammar schools. Those who failed the "11+" (80 per cent) went to secondary modern schools.

A lot of people thought that this system of selection at the age of 11 was unfair. So comprehensive schools were introduced to offer suitable courses for pupils of all abilities.

Comprehensive schools want to develop the talents of each individual child. So they offer a wide choice of subjects, from art and craft, woodwork and domestic science to the sciences, modern languages, computer studies, etc. Pupils at comprehensive schools are quite often put into "sets" for the more academic subjects such as mathematics or languages. Sets are formed according to ability in each subject, so that for example the children in the highest set for maths will not necessarily be in the highest set for French. All pupils move to the next class automatically at the end of the year.

Some parents choose to pay for private education in spite of the existence of free state education. Private schools are called by different names to state schools: the preparatory (often called "prep") schools are for pupils aged up to 13, and the public schools are for 13 to 18 year-olds. There are about 500 public schools in England and Wales, most of them single-sex. About half of them are for girls. The schools, such as Eton, Harrow, Rugby and Winchester, are famous for their ability to lay foundation of a successful future by giving their pupils self-confidence, the right accent, a good academic background and, perhaps, most important of all, the right friends and contacts. The children who went to one of the public schools never call themselves school-leavers. They talk about "the

old school tie" and "the old boy network". They are just old boys and old girls. Public schools educate the ruling class of England. **Harrow School** is famous as the place where Winston Churchill was educated, as well as six other Prime Ministers of Great Britain, the poet Lord Byron and many other prominent people.

Public schools are free from state control. They are independent. Most of them are boarding schools. The education is of a high quality; the discipline is very strict. The system of education is the same: the most able go ahead. These schools accept pupils from the preparatory schools at about 11 or 13 years of age usually on the basis of an examination, known as Common Entrance. Scholarships are rarely awarded on the results of Common Entrance. The fundamental requirements are very high.

Exams

At the age of 14 or 15, in the third or fourth form of secondary school, pupils begin to choose their exam subjects. In 1988 a new public examination — the General Certificate of Secondary Education (GCSE) — was introduced for 16 year-olds. This examination assesses pupils on the work they do in the 4th and 5th year at secondary school, and is often internally assessed, although there may also be an exam at the end of the course.

Pupils who stay on into the sixth form or who go on to a Sixth Form College (17 year-olds in the Lower Sixth and 18 year-olds in the Upper Sixth) usually fall into two categories. Some pupils will be retaking GCSEs in order to get better grades. Others will study two or three subjects for an "A" Level (Advanced Level) GCE exam (General Certificate of Education). This is a highly specialized exam and is necessary for University entrance. Since 1988 there has been a new level of exam: the "AS" Level (Advanced Supplementary), which is worth half an "A" Level. This means that if pupils wish to study more than two or three subjects in the sixth form they can take a combination of "A" and 'AS' Level. In Scotland the exam system is slightly different.

Higher Education

There are 46 universities in Britain. The oldest and best-known universities are located in Oxford, Cambridge, London, Leeds,

Manchester, Liverpool, Edinburgh, Southampton, Cardiff, Bristol and Birmingham.

The academic year in Britain's universities, Polytechnics, Colleges of education is divided into 3 terms, which usually run from the beginning of October to the middle of December, the middle of January to the end of March, from the middle of April to the end of June or the beginning of July.

Good A-level results in at least 2 subjects are necessary to get a place at a university. However, good exam passes alone are not enough. Universities choose their students after interviews. For all British citizens a place at a university brings with it a grant from their local education authority.

English universities greatly differ from each other. They differ in date of foundation, size, history, tradition, general organization, methods of instruction and way of student life.

After three years of study a university graduate will leave with the Degree of Bachelor of Arts, Science, Engineering, Medicine, etc. Some courses, such as languages and medicine, may be one or two years longer. The degrees are awarded at public degree ceremonies. Later he/she may continue to take Master's Degree and then a Doctor's Degree.

The Scottish universities of St. Andrews, Glasgow, Aberdeen & Edinburgh date from the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries.

In the nineteenth and the early part of the twentieth century the so-called Redbrick universities were founded. These include London, Manchester, Leeds, Liverpool, Sheffield, and Birmingham. During the late sixties and early seventies some 20 'new' universities were set up. Sometimes they are called 'concrete and glass' universities. Among them are the universities of Sussex, York, East Anglia and some others. During these years the government set up 30 Polytechnics. The Polytechnics, like the universities, offer first and higher degrees. Some of them offer full-time and sandwich courses (курс обучения, чередующий теорию с практикой - сочетание общеобразовательного и профессионального обучения с работой на производстве (for working students)). Colleges of Education provide two-year courses in teacher education or sometimes three years if the graduate specializes in some particular subjects. Some of them who decide to leave school at the age of 16 may go to a further education college where they can follow a course in typing, engineering,

town planning, cooking, or hairdressing, full-time or part-time. Further education colleges have strong ties with commerce and industry.

There's an interesting form of studies which is called the Open University. It's intended for people who study in their own free time and who 'attend' lectures by watching TV and listening to the radio. They keep in touch by phone and letter with their tutors and attend summer schools. The Open University students have no formal qualifications and would be unable to enter ordinary universities.

Источник: http://schools.keldysh.ru/school1413/eng/egorova_ks/str5.html

Education in Scotland is the responsibility of the Cabinet Secretary for Education and Lifelong Learning, with day to day administration and funding of state schools being the responsibility of Local Authorities. Qualifications at the secondary school and post-secondary (further education) level are provided by the Scottish Qualifications Authority and delivered through various schools, colleges and other centres. Scotland first legislated for universal provision of education in 1696. Scottish students who attend Scottish universities pay neither tuition fees nor graduate endowment charges as the fees were abolished in 2001 and the graduate endowment scheme was abolished in 2008.

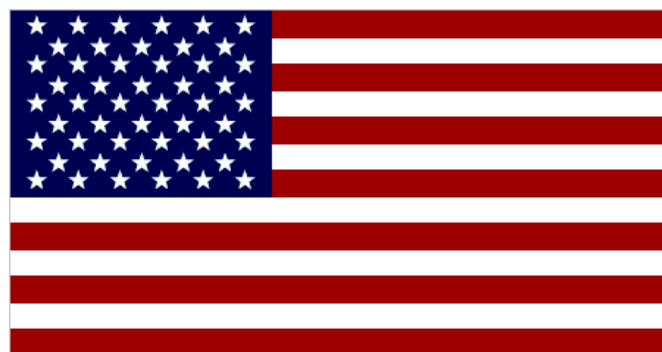
Education in England is the responsibility of the Secretary of State for Children, Schools and Families and the Secretary of State for Innovation, Universities and Skills, though the day to day administration and funding of state schools is the responsibility of Local Education Authorities. Universal state education in England and Wales was introduced for primary level in 1870 and secondary level in 1900. Education is mandatory from ages five to sixteen (15 if born in late July or August).

Just over half of students at the leading universities of Cambridge and Oxford had attended state schools. State schools which are allowed to select pupils according to intelligence and academic ability can achieve comparable results to the most selective private schools: out of the top ten performing schools in terms of GCSE results in 2006 two were state-run grammar schools. England has some of the top universities in the world with Cambridge, Oxford, and London .

The Northern Ireland Assembly is responsible for education in Northern Ireland though responsibility at a local level is administered by 5 Education and Library Boards covering different geographical areas.

The National Assembly for **Wales** has responsibility for education in Wales. There are plans to increase the provision of Welsh Medium schools as part of the policy of having a fully bilingual Wales.

THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA



Location

The mainland United States is located between Mexico on the south and Canada on the north and between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans. Two of its 50 states, however, are far removed from the continental core: Hawaii lies in the Pacific Ocean; Alaska, in the northwestern corner of North America.

If the outlying states are included, the total area is 3,675,267 square miles (9,518,898 square kilometers), making the United States the fourth largest country in the world. The United States also ranks fourth in population. At the 2000 census its population was 281,421,906. The United States is dominated by a range of old mountains and plateaus—the Appalachians—that runs north and south on the east side of the North American continent and young ranges of lofty mountains—the Rockies, Cascades, and Sierra Nevada—that run north and south in the western quarter of the continent. The great interior lowland extends from the Canadian Shield to the Gulf of Mexico. These dominant mountain and lowland areas have helped to define what are called the physiographic provinces of the United States.

The Appalachian Mountains are very old. The valleys between them are rich in coal. The Rocky Mountains are considered to be young, high, rough, and irregular in shape. Between the Rocky Mountains and the Appalachian Mountains there are the central lowlands, called the prairie, and the eastern lowlands, called the Mississippi valley. The five Great Lakes, between the USA and Canada, include Lake Superior, Lake Michigan, Lake Huron, Lake Erie, and Lake Ontario. They are all joined together by short rivers or canals, and the St. Lawrence River joins them to the Atlantic Ocean. In the west of the USA there is another lake called the Great Salt Lake.

The main rivers of the USA are the Mississippi, flowing south to the Gulf of Mexico (it is the second largest river in the world after the Nile); the Missouri, flowing into the Mississippi; the Rio Grande, flowing along the boundary between Texas and Mexico into the Gulf of Mexico; the Yukon, flowing north-west and then south-west from Canada through Alaska to the Bering Sea; the Colorado, flowing into the Gulf of California; the Columbia, flowing into the Pacific Ocean, and the St. Lawrence River and the Hudson River, flowing into the Atlantic Ocean.

The Political System.

The United States is an indirect democracy—that is, the people rule through representatives they elected. Today any citizen who is at least 18 years old can vote. The United States Constitution, written in 1787, established the country's political system and is the basis for its laws. The Constitution can be amended, or changed. (For example, the Fifteenth Amendment gave black Americans the right to vote and the Nineteenth Amendment gave women the right to vote.)

The United States has a federalist system. This means that there are individual states, each with its own government, and there is a federal, or national, government. The Constitution gives certain powers to the federal government, other powers to the state governments, and yet other powers to both. For example, only the national government can print money; the states establish their own school systems, and both the national and the state governments can collect taxes. Within the national government, power is divided among three branches: the legislative, executive, and judicial branches.

The legislative branch consists of Congress, which has two parts — the House of Representatives and the Senate. Congress's main function is to make laws. There are 100 senators (two from each state) and 435 representatives (the number from each state depends on the size of the state's population). The President is the head of the executive branch and the country. The executive branch administers the laws (decides how the laws should be carried out). In addition to the President, the Vice-President, and their staffs, the executive branch consists of departments and agencies.

There are now 14 departments, including Treasury, State, Defense, and Health and Human Services. Each department has different responsibilities. For example, the Treasury Department manages the nation's money, while the State Department helps make foreign policy. The President appoints the department heads, who together make up the President's Cabinet, or advisers. The agencies regulate specific areas. For example, the Environmental Protection Agency tries to control pollution, while the Securities and Exchange Commission regulates the stock markets. The judicial branch interprets the laws and makes sure that new laws are in keeping with the Constitution. There are several levels of federal courts. The Supreme Court is the most important. It has nine

members who are appointed for life. The system of checks and balances, established by the Constitution, is meant to prevent any branch from having too much power. Each branch has certain controls over the other branches. For example, Congress makes the laws but the president can veto, or reject, a law and the Supreme Court can decide a law is unconstitutional.

Two-Party System. The United States has two main political parties — the Democratic and Republican parties. Voters elect the president, as well as senators, representatives, governors, etc. A voter can choose candidates from different parties (e.g., vote for Republicans for President and vice-president and a Democrat for senator), so the President does not have to be from the party that has a majority in Congress. In recent years, in fact, voters have tended to choose Republican presidents and Democratic congresspeople. There are not clear differences between the Republican and Democratic parties. The Republicans tend to be more conservative and to have more support among the upper classes, while the Democrats tend to be more liberal and to have more support among the working classes and the poor.

The Nation's Capital

With its grand neoclassical buildings and its tree-lined avenues, Washington, D.C. strikes the visitors as a lovely and formal city. Washington wasn't always this way.

When it was decided that the new country needed a new city for its capital, President George Washington himself helped pick the spot — a marshy area where the Potomac and Anacostia rivers come together. French engineer Pierre Charles L'Enfant created a design based on Versailles. The capital city would be crisscrossed by broad avenues, which would meet in spacious squares and circles.

Creating Versailles from a marsh was no easy task. Building went slowly. Though Washington was first settled in 1790 and in 1800 it became the Federal capital, people were reluctant to move to it. For years, pigs roamed through unpaved streets. There was said to be good hunting right near the White House!

Matters were not helped when, during the War of 1812, the British burned parts of Washington. This episode did, however, give the White House its name. The president's house was one of the buildings burned, and after the war it was painted white to cover up the marks.

The Smithsonian began in the 1850s, with a gift from Englishman James Smithson. Although Smithson had never set foot in the United States, he left his entire fortune to this country, asking that it be used to found "an establishment for the increase and diffusion of knowledge". Today, the Smithsonian Institution, with its thirteen museums, has at least a little of everything!

Of all the Smithsonian museums, the most visited — indeed, one of the most visited museums in the world — is the National Air and Space Museum. The museum has aircraft and space craft that were important in aviation history.

The Smithsonian buildings are built on or near the Mall, a large open space. The Mall also has monuments honoring George Washington and Abraham Lincoln. Washington was the first president. Lincoln was president during the Civil war and ended slavery. Many important civil rights events have taken place at the Lincoln Memorial. A third important president, Thomas Jefferson, who was also the main author of the Declaration of Independence, is honored by a monument overlooking the nearby Tidal Basin. The Tidal Basin area is especially beautiful in spring, when its many cherry trees, a gift from Japan, are in bloom.

Washington, one of the most beautiful and unusual cities in the United States with the area of 68 square miles, the population of about 607,000, the motto *Justicia Omnibus* (Justice for All), has one major business, and that business is government. The executive departments (Treasury, Agriculture, Education, etc.) are located in Washington. Many of the people who live in Washington work for the federal government.

In the very centre of the city there rises the huge dome of the Capitol — a big white dome standing on a circle of pillars. The 535 members of the Congress meet here to discuss the nation's affairs. It's easy to get lost in this huge building, full of paintings and statues.

Not far from the Capitol there is the Library of Congress, the largest library in the United States. It contains more than 13 million books, more than 19 million manuscripts, including the personal papers of the US presidents.

When you are in Washington you can tour the White House, at 1600 Pennsylvania Avenue, the official residence of the US President. You won't be able to see the President at work in the Oval Office; White House offices, as well as living quarters, are closed to the public. However, if you visit Capitol Hill, you might be able to see some important members of the other two branches of government: The Supreme Court has a public gallery, as do the Senate and the House of Representatives. There are 5 universities in Washington.

You will see no skyscrapers in Washington, because they would hide the city's many monuments from view. In fact, no building may be more than 40 meters tall.

Education

There are three basic levels in the US educational system—elementary school, which usually goes from kindergarten to sixth grade; junior high school, from seventh through eighth or ninth grade; and high school, from ninth or tenth through twelfth grade. Children are required to be in school from the ages of 7 through 16.

About 90 percent of all children attend public school which is free. The remaining 10 percent go to private schools, which often are associated with a religion. About half of all private schools are Catholic.

In the United States, education is mainly the responsibility of state and local governments, rather than the national government. The amount of money spent on education varies considerably from state to state. The subjects studied also vary somewhat. School year usually runs from September to June.

At the high school level there are some specialized schools, including schools that emphasize vocational subjects like business or auto mechanics. Most high schools, however, are general schools. High school students are often involved in non-academic activities that their school offers—for example, in drama clubs, sports teams, or the school newspaper.

Advanced Schooling.

Many students, upon finishing high school, choose to continue their education. Community colleges, also known as junior colleges, offer two-year programs. They are public schools and the tuition costs are usually low. Colleges and universities have four-year programs leading to a bachelor's degree as well as, in many cases, further programs leading to higher degrees. These schools may be public or private; private schools

cost a lot more. Colleges and Universities have many students from around the world, especially from Asia.

National Academy of Education was founded in 1965 to stimulate research in education; members are university scholars in fields divided into five categories: history and philosophy of education; politics, economics, sociology, and anthropology of education; psychology of education; study of educational practice; and members-at-large hold semiannual meetings; awards fellowships for educational research to students, doctoral candidates, and recent doctoral degree recipients.

Trends in Education

Many more Americans than ever before are finishing high school and college. More than 20 percent of all adults have finished college, and more than 75 percent have finished high school.

Although the number of years of schooling is going up, there are signs that the quality of education may be going down. This is of great concern, especially since education is considered crucial to the American ideal that each person should achieve all that he or she can.

There are many theories about where the problems lie. Some think that students have too many "electives", or courses they choose, and too few courses in basic subjects. Others think students watch too much TV and do too little homework. Everyone agrees the problems must be addressed.

Higher Education

There are literally hundreds of universities in the United States. The best known among them gained fame for a variety of reasons: size, prestige and the ambition of the university's expectations for their students.

Princeton University is a private Ivy League research **university** in **Princeton**, New Jersey. Founded in 1746 in Elizabeth as the College of New Jersey, **Princeton** is one of the nine Colonial Colleges established before the American Revolution.

At 350 years old, **Harvard University** is the oldest institution of higher education in the United States. The college aims to accomplish three key missions: the creation of knowledge, the opening of students' minds to that knowledge and the enabling of students to take full advantage of opportunities in education. There are 12 different colleges, or "academic units," at Harvard: Medical School, School of Dental Medicine, School of Public Health, Law School,

the John F. Kennedy School of Government, Business School, Design School, Graduate School of Arts & Sciences, Graduate School of Education, Harvard College, the Division of Continuing Education and the Radcliffe Institute for Advanced Study.

Northwestern University is rooted in liberal arts education. Each of the 100-plus academic programs pair core curriculum with specific studies in arts & sciences, music, communication, journalism, education & social policy, law, management, engineering & applied science and medicine. There are a dozen schools at Northwestern. Nine of the schools have degree programs for undergrads, while 10 offer graduate and professional programs.

Yale University is comprised of three schools: the undergraduate Yale College, the Graduate School of Arts & Sciences and the professional schools. Among them are about 150 areas of academic concentration, including such diverse programs as gay & lesbian studies, near Eastern languages & civilizations, epidemiology & public health and a paired concentration in computer science & psychology. In addition to its academic buildings, the campus houses a public museum, the Peabody Museum of Natural History, and two art galleries, the University Art Gallery and the Center for British Art.

The Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), founded in 1861, is located in Cambridge, Massachusetts, and is one of the foremost U.S. institutions in science and technology. It is comprised of five schools and one college, including the renowned School of Engineering and Sloan School of Management, offering Bachelor's, Master's, and Doctorate degrees. Notable alumni include Ben Bernanke, Chairman of the Federal Reserve, Benjamin Netanyahu, prime minister of Israel, and American astronaut "Buzz" Aldrin.

In America, higher education starts at the age of 18 after the completion of twelve years of primary and secondary schooling. A candidate who has successfully completed class XII is eligible for the Bachelors Program or Undergraduate Study in the USA.

The Bachelor's degree or undergraduate study usually lasts for 4 years. In some cases an accelerated program can be completed in three years, while some professional fields require five years. The 4 year's undergraduate study is considered as 120 credit hours. One course

averages 3 credits. Subjects involving lab facilities will get 4 credits. You receive a Bachelor's degree or undergraduate degree when you finish around 40 courses in different subjects within the span of four years. 1st year students are called Freshmen, 2nd years Sophomores, third years Juniors and the 4th or last year students are referred to as Seniors. Many colleges give an Associate degree after the sophomore year or second year of a Bachelor's degree. It is the degree awarded after either a college transfer or a 'terminal', one to three year program providing training for a specific occupation.

Graduate Study:

In the USA, higher studies after taking a degree or Bachelor's is termed Graduate study. A candidate who has successfully completed four years of Bachelors Program or Undergraduate study is eligible to apply for the Master's Degree in the USA.

Masters degree is the first Graduate degree in the liberal arts and Sciences and certain professional fields requiring 30 credit hours of full-time study within a year or 2 years. You can get your Master's degree by taking 8 courses of subjects with 3 credits each plus a thesis of 6 hours credit or 10 courses of subjects with 3 credits each without the thesis. Some Universities have a final exam. Usually masters degree include M.S and M.A degrees.

Research (Doctoral Degree) is the highest degree awarded in research-oriented academic disciplines, usually requiring 3 to 6 years of full time study besides the Bachelor's degree as preparation for University level teaching and research. The main criteria for admission is the applicants' interest in the particular subject of research.

First Professional Degree - The degree required to be academically qualified to practice in certain professions, such as law, medicine etc. usually requires a total of at least six years of study including prior college level work.

Different Educational Institutions. College: It is an independent institution that offers a four-year program of undergraduate study in the liberal arts (BA, BFA) and sciences (B.S). Bachelor's degree is the basic requirement for graduate work.

Universities

Universities are larger institutions that include several undergraduate colleges, graduate schools, and professional schools.

Graduate school involves 1 or 2 years of study and offers advanced programs in arts and sciences which gives master's degrees like M.A or M.S, Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D) etc. Professional schools are institutions which specialize in a single field of study such as medicine, pharmacy, business administration , law etc.

Junior College or Community Colleges:

These colleges award only Associate Degree of Arts (A.A) and Sciences (A.S) which involves 2 year of study. After receiving Associate Degree, students must join a 4 years college or University to complete the Bachelor's Degree.

Vocational and Technical Institution:

These institutes specialize in training for the skilled trades and technical fields of employment. Duration of the courses depends on the particular subject. After completion, they will be awarded a certificate of completion and they can straight away join for a job.

Classes in the USA

Usually, for most Universities and colleges the year begins in late August or early September and ends in May or June. The academic year is divided into semesters, trimesters or quarter depending on the institution. The semester system divides the year into 2 equal terms of 16 weeks. Each semester is 4 months. Trimester system has three equal terms of 16 weeks each, including a summer term. Quarter system divides the year into 3 equal terms of 11 weeks each. Classes are lecture-based with practical (lab or practicum in U.S). Overhead projector, computer projections, multimedia are used along with the lectures. Printed notes and additional information on topics (Handouts in the U.S) are given. Professors or advisors are always available to clear doubts. Interaction in class is encouraged. Each student will be assigned an 'advisor' who is a member of the faculty. This advisor will help the students to select the courses to be taken in each semester, plan the whole program and monitor the students progress. The students register for the particular courses with the permission of the advisors.

Class Size

The average class size at the undergraduate level, in most universities is 100-150 for introductory courses. Advanced level classes will be smaller in size. Master's degree classes have an average of 20 students and Doctoral classes have an average of only 10 students.

Tests

Each semester has an average of 4 tests. Test range in style from multiple choice (objective type) format designed to gauge your knowledge of the subject and reasoning ability to essay or problem-solving type tests. There are 3 kinds of tests - open book tests, closed book tests and take home tests. In the 1st type, you can refer notes, text book, reference material etc. during the test. 2nd one is usual test. In the 3rd one you take the question paper home and answer at your convenience before the dead line set by the professor. Take home tests often have essay-based questions.

Grading

In American Universities, they give grades instead of ranks or classes for courses. The grades are A, B, C, D, E, F, I. A is the highest grade. Grades from A to D are considered as pass. Grade I - incomplete. Grade I is granted when students stop the course in between with the teachers permission. If it is without permission this can become F grade.

- Marks between 100-90- A Grade (Excellent)
- Marks between 89-79- B Grade (good)
- Marks between 78-68- C Grade (Average)
- Marks between 67-57- D Grade (Below)
- Below 57- F or fail.

Each grade has points. 4 points for A grade, 3 for B and 2 for C. The average points taken for all the courses taken together is the GPA (Grade Point Average). It is the general score on a scale of 1.0(lowest) to 4.0 (highest). It is difficult to get admission for graduate study if you don't have at least a G.P.A of 3.0. G.P.A is computed using a unique formula by the university's administration. The grades are fixed by the professors who teach the subjects based on the performance of the students. The success rate is high.

Bachelor's Degree

Bachelor's degree requirements vary for each university. Many will compare the SAT (scholastic aptitude test) scores of applicants before offering them a place but it is normal for a university to request entrance examinations, additional qualifications or additional study (i.e.,

volunteering, work experience or associate degrees). Each university will request a different 'average' SAT score from applicants.

Read more: http://www.ehow.com/info_7933316_bachelors-degree-requirements-usa.html#ixzz32LkAF7vg

SAT Scores. The SAT exam is an aptitude test which affects all university/college applications. All universities compare applicants on SAT scores but some have strict requirements. SAT exams consist of three main areas; critical reading, maths and writing. Subject SAT exams can also be taken to add weight to a degree application and may be required for certain bachelor degrees. The average SAT score required for each degree varies, but esteemed universities or difficult courses require higher scores (for example, Harvard University requires a score in all areas of 680 - 800, which is 20 percent above the average student score of 500).

Read more: http://www.ehow.com/info_7933316_bachelors-degree-requirements-usa.html#ixzz32LkQkCOK

ACT Exam/GPA Scores. Not all institutions will accept applicants solely on SAT scores. ACT (American College Test) exams are an alternative to SAT scores or they can be taken in addition to the SAT. They are knowledge-based exams which test the achievements of a student and what students have learnt throughout their education. ACT requirements vary again for each institution and can be submitted in conjunction with SAT scores or without. Some institutions will require GPA (grade point average) scores along with SAT and ACT scores. GPA scores reflect the average grade throughout education (for example, a score of 4.0 is an "A", 3.0 is a "B" and so on until 0.0 which is a fail.) Again, institutions have various requirements for GPA scores and some may not even require GPA scores at all.

Read more: http://www.ehow.com/info_7933316_bachelors-degree-requirements-usa.html#ixzz32LkXhQve

University Entrance Exams. Prestigious institutions will not base their decisions solely on exam scores and may request additional tests to be

taken by applicants. Exams are normally written and test the applicant's analytical ability as well as their essay writing/prose skills. For specialized courses, some institutions may offer a knowledge based exam on the subject, or simply request additional learning before applying for a bachelors degree (such as a two year associate degree).

Read more: http://www.ehow.com/info_7933316_bachelors-degree-requirements-usa.html#ixzz32Lkg3kIl

Although **extracurricular activities and AP (Advanced Placement) classes** are not a specific requirement for all universities, they normally give extra weight to an application. Activities that are centered around the subject which the student will study at degree level are appealing to institutions --- AP classes, in turn, are challenging courses that can be taken before university and are recorded on a student's record. Students studying advanced placement courses gain a distinct advantage in academic writing, research and financial planning and they gain a distinct advantage over other potential students.

Read more: http://www.ehow.com/info_7933316_bachelors-degree-requirements-usa.html#ixzz32LkmNzT5

AUSTRALIA



Australia's Unique History

Captain James Cook discovered Australia in 1770. He was sent to discover the huge land that many people believed was south of the equator. He landed south of present day Sydney in New South Wales. He claimed this part of the land for the King of England.

At this time England was having many social problems. Unemployment was high. Crime was one of the greatest problems. The government punished people by sending them to prison. England's solution to crowded prisons was to send prisoners to the far colonies. They could work off their prison sentences as labourers in the new colonies and eventually earn their freedom. Therefore, in 1788 Captain Arthur Phillip commanded eleven ships to Australia. About 750 of the 1000 people on the ships were convicts. These first settlers were greeted by the Aborigines, the first inhabitants of Australia. There were an estimated 300,000 Aborigines



James Cook

living in Australia at that time. Great Britain claimed all of Australia in 1827. In 1851 gold was discovered about 300 km west of Sydney. People rushed to the gold fields to find their fortunes. This attracted robbers called bushrangers. Ned Kelly was a famous bushranger. He was a very clever outlaw.

In 1901 Australia became a nation within the British Empire under Queen Victoria's rule. It was called the Commonwealth of Australia. Australia had a very limited constitution. Great Britain continued to make decisions regarding all of Australia's foreign affairs.

In 1931 Australia gained independence from Great Britain.

Australia Today

Australia is a very urban country. About 70 per cent of the population live in the 10 largest cities. Most of the population is in the south-eastern corner of the country and only 15 per cent of the population live in rural areas. Canberra is the capital of Australia. It is not the biggest city. Sydney and Melbourne are much larger. The state of Tasmania is separated from the continent of Australia. It is an island-state.

Australians love their wildlife. The Australian government pays a lot of attention to the preservation of the environment. In the past many trees had

been cut down. The government plans that one billion new trees will have been planted. They have already planted 550 million trees. Now trees are being planted all over Australia.

Australians also love sports. Australia is one of the few countries in the world that has participated in all of the Olympic games since they were organized. The Olympic games were held in Melbourne in 1956 and in Sydney in the 2000.

Australia is a multicultural society with about a quarter of the population foreign born. Settlers from about 200 countries have made Australia their home. Aborigines now comprise only 1.5 per cent of the population.

Great distances and isolation of people of the outback gave birth to some special forms of medical care in Australia: flying doctors could help children from far away sheep farms through Flying Doctor Service. It provides medical care for people living in isolated regions. The service was started in 1927 by the Reverend Dr. John Flynn. Doctors travel by aircraft from centralized bases and keep in touch with their patients by radio.

Location

Australia is a continent, a country and an island all at the same time. Australia is the oldest continent on earth — some of the rocks are more than 3,000 million years old.

It is the sixth largest country and the smallest continent in the world. Australia is located in the southern hemisphere. That is why it has summer when we have winter and it has winter when we have summer. It is interesting to know that January is the hottest month in Australia.

Australia is the world's driest continent. Huge areas of land are so dry that they are uninhabited. There are rainforests in the north, snowfields in the south-east, desert in the centre and fertile croplands in the south and south-west. Australia is also the flattest continent after Antarctica.

Australia is located south of Asia, between the Pacific and Indian ocean. It is a vast continent, made up of mainland Australia and of island of Tasmania to the south. It covers a very large area which, in the Northern Hemisphere, would extend roughly from Britain to Russia. Australia, Tasmania and a number of smaller islands, Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Kangaroo Island among them, form the Commonwealth of Australia.

Australia's area of 7,682,300 sq. km is nearly as large as the United States excluding Alaska and Hawaii. It is twice the size of Western Europe. It is about 25 times larger than Britain and Ireland. It is the sixth largest country in the world.

The Australian continent is washed on the north by the Timor and Arafura Seas and Torres Strait, on the East by the Tasman and Coral Seas, of the South Pacific Ocean, on the south by Bass Strait and the Indian Ocean.

Australia is the flattest of all continents. Its most significant mountain chain is the Great Dividing Range (the eastern projection of which is known as the Australian Alps) running down most of the east coast. Other mountains include the Kimberley and Hamersley Ranges in Western Australia, the Flinders Range in South Australia. Australia's highest point, Mount Kosciusko in the Australian Alps is only 2,230m high.

Australia is the driest (after Antarctica) of all continents (40 per cent of it lies in the tropics, one-third is desert, vast areas are arid or semi-desert, unsuitable for settlement). The centre of the continent is taken by the deserts: Great Sandy Desert; Great Victoria Desert, Simpson Desert, There are few rivers and lakes in Australia. Its best-known river is the Murray (2,600 km). The longest is the Darling (2,740 km). These with the Murrumbidgee, the Lachlan and a number of smaller rivers form the continent's river system.

Australian Symbols

Australia's coat of arms—the official emblem of the Australian Government — was granted by King George V in 1912. The arms consist of a shield containing the badges of the six states. The supporters are native Australian fauna — a kangaroo and an emu.

Australia's national Day, Australia Day, 26 January marks the date in 1788 when Captain Arthur Phillip, of the British Royal Navy, commanded a fleet of 11 ships and sailed into port Jackson (Sydney Cove). The flag of Australia is the only one to fly over a whole continent. The small Union Jack represents the historical link with Britain, the large seven-pointed star represents the six States and the Territories, and the small stars form the Southern Cross — a prominent feature of the southern hemisphere night sky.

Territories and States

There are six states and two territories in Australia. **Northern Territory** is one of the two Australia territories. Its territory is 1,346,200 sq. km. Its capital and chief port is **Darwin**. Another important city is **Alice Spring**.

The other Australian territory is **Australian Capital Territory (ACT)**. The capital of Australia **Canberra** is situated in ACT.

New South Wales is the first state in Australia. It has the biggest population, is most industrialized and is a leader in agricultural production. Its population is about 6 million people, 60 per cent of it lives in its capital, **Sydney**. Its other important cities are **Newcastle, Wollongong, Broken Hill**. The floral emblem of the state is waratah.

Western Australia is the largest state of Australia. Its area is 2, 525, 500 sq. km. The largest state of Australia is very sparsely populated: its population is about 1.7 million people. The capital of the state is **Perth**; other cities include its main port **Fremantle, Bunbury, Geraldton, Kalgoorlie-Boulder, Albany**. Its inhabitants are sometimes called Sand-groupers.

Tasmania is the only island state of Australia (including small islands in the Bass Strait and Macquarie Island). Its area is 67, 800 sq. km, its population is about 500,000 people. The capital of the state is **Hobart**. Tasmania was first called Van Dieman's land by the Dutch explorer Abel Tasman in 1642.

The state of **Victoria** is the smallest of Australia's inland states with the area of 227,600 sq. km. The population of the state is over 4.4 million people and most of it lives in its capital, **Melbourne**. Its other important cities are **Geelong, Ballarat, Bendigo**.

South Australia is the driest state of the driest continent on earth. Four fifths of it is virtually desert; the remainder is a fertile coastal area in the south east corner. Its area is 984, 000 sq. km. The population of the driest state is less than 1.5 million people, one per cent of which are Aborigines. The capital of the state and the chief port is **Adelaide**; its other cities are **Whyalla, Mount Gambier**. The floral emblem of the state is Sturt's Desert Pea.

Queensland is the second largest state of Australia after Western Australia. Its area is 1,727,200 sq. km. The population of Queensland is over 3.2 million people. Its capital is **Brisbane**; other important cities are

Gold Coast-Tweed; Townsville, Sunshine coast, Toowoomba, Cairns. Queensland is a state rich in minerals, primary production, magnificent natural beauty and tourist potential.

Canberra — the Capital of Australia

Canberra is the home of Australia's government and embassies from around the world. The centrepiece of the city is the new Parliament House, which was opened in 1988. This is where Australia's government meets. Canberra is also the "natural capital" and is within easy reach of some of Australia's most spectacular countryside. The air here is fresh and crisp. No wonder the people of Canberra love to spend their time outdoors! There are many fine museums in Canberra. Canberra was designed by an American. Canberra is a "cyclist's paradise". Australia's national landmarks are located in Canberra. The National Gallery, the National Science and Technology Centre, the High Court and the Old Parliament House are all here. Canberra is a totally planned city, with none of the vivacity and character of other Australian cities. It is the seat of government, and many of its monuments and buildings reflect its central role in Australian life. Canberra is not one of Australia's largest cities, but it is certainly one of the most important. The government of Australia moved from Melbourne, the old capital, to Canberra in 1927. Canberra is a twentieth-century city, the product of a brilliantly planned and executed design.

The principal architect of Canberra was Walter Burley Griffin who in 1912 won a worldwide competition for the design of the federal capital. Canberra is the political and administrative capital of Australia. It is also the centre of the nation's history, learning and research. Although Canberra is a highly urban complex, the Australian "bush" is still only minutes from the city centre.

It took eight years to decide where to establish the national capital and another eighteen years passed before the Australian Parliament moved to Canberra. The name Canberra comes from the Aboriginal word "Kamberra" meaning "meeting place".

EDUCATION

Preschool education

Most Australian children begin school before the compulsory school age and many attend preschool centres within the school system. Preschool centres generally enrol four-year-old children and provide 2—3 hour sessions for two groups of children each day. Most children attend 3—5 sessions a week, but some children in country areas attend only one. In all states except Victoria, departments of education have some responsibility for preschool education and there is a trend towards government involvement throughout Australia.

Day-care centres, which care for babies as well as for children of preschool age, are available in capital cities and larger towns. They are operated on a commercial basis or run by parents, local government bodies and community groups, usually as non-profit-making organizations. Day-care centres must be licensed by appropriate government authorities.

The Federal Government provides financial grants for a comprehensive range of services throughout Australia. Grants have been paid to expand and subsidize preschool education, primarily for four-year-old children, daycare, playgrounds and tertiary institutions training teachers and other staff required by the expanded services.

Kindergarten of the Air provides classroom experience by two-way radio for children in the outback, even though they remain physically in their own homes.

Government-run preschools provide a year of preschool education for all four-year-old children for the period of 12 months immediately before their entry into primary schools. Depending on parents' income a small service charge may be made in addition to voluntary contribution. Children's names can go on a waiting list at their local preschool when they turn three. Pre-schools are conducted in specially designed buildings, run by qualified staff and benefit from active involvement of parents.

Primary and secondary education

Education in Australia is compulsory beginning at the age of six and continuing to fifteen or sixteen (varies between states). It is chiefly the responsibility of the individual states. In each state administration the

training and recruiting of teachers are centralized under an education department. More than seventy percent of children are educated in government schools— where tuition at primary and secondary levels is free. State schools provide free and secular education but students may attend religious classes provided by the clergy of various denominations .

There are also private or independent schools (which are sometimes called "public" as in Britain). These private or non-government schools are usually denominational (about 75 per cent are Catholic schools). Non-government schools usually charge tuition fees which vary from school to school. The private schools, which in some states are called "public schools" as in England, normally accept day scholars and boarders.

Schooling is not compulsory in Australia until the age of six (Year I) but most children start earlier. Primary schooling usually lasts six or seven years. During these years, children are involved in a curriculum which is, in large part similar in all Australian primary schools. The lower primary course consists of basic language and literacy skills, simple arithmetic, social and health education and creative activities. In upper years, a course of English, mathematics, social studies, physical education and health are taught.

Secondary schooling begins in Years 7 or 8 and can continue to Year 12. More subjects, such as technical, commercial or foreign language subjects, are introduced.

The most common type of secondary school is the coeducational comprehensive or multipurpose high school which offers a wide range of subjects. Each state and territory in Australia makes its own laws about education.

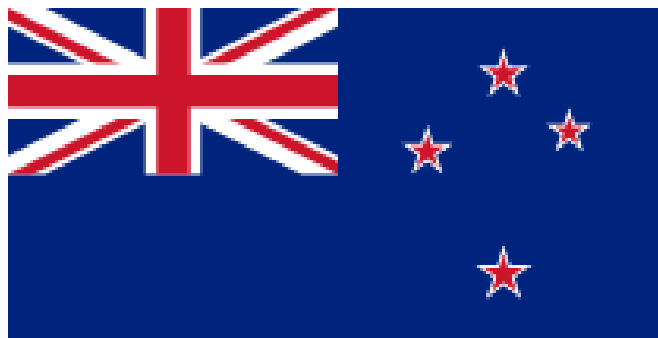
In Australia children between the ages of six and fifteen are required to attend school **with the exception** of Tasmania. In Tasmania children attend school until the age of sixteen.

Australia's four-**term** school year begins in February with a two- week holiday between terms. The fourth and final term ends around December 20. The Christmas holiday **coincides** with the end of school and the beginning of the summer vacation. The students return to school in February.

Australia's primary or elementary school consists of grades one through six. Secondary school consists of grade seven through twelve. All secondary students wear uniforms to school.

In Australia large schools are found in cities along the coast. One-teacher schools are located farther out in the countryside. A teacher in the country may teach all grades, with only one or two students in a grade. Students living far from the city attend "Schools of the Air". They listen to the teacher on the radio each day when it's time for school. Students have their own books. They answer questions over the microphone. The teacher assigns homework to do. The completed homework is mailed to the teacher. It is discussed over the microphone, corrected and mailed back. In the United States some children attend school at home.

NEW ZEALAND



Location

The name "New Zealand" comes from "Zeeland" in Dutch. Zeeland is a province of the Netherlands. New Zealand is called "Aotearoa" in the Maori language. It means "Land of the Long White Cloud".

New Zealand (Aotearoa) is an Island Nation, situated midway between the Equator and the South Pole in the southern Pacific Ocean. Australia is

New Zealand's nearest western neighbour. The distance between the two countries is more than 1,600 kilometers. The countries are separated by the Tasman sea. Its nearest neighbours to the North are New Caledonia, Fiji and Tonga, all about the same distance away as Australia. It is remote from many other lands.

The area of New Zealand is 270.534 sq. kilometers. It is a small, quiet and green country, with only 3.5 million people. It is a little larger than the United Kingdom.

New Zealand has two large islands, one smaller island, and numerous much smaller islands. The main islands are the North Island (114.500 sq. km) and the South Island (150.700 sq. km). They are separated by Cook Strait .

New Zealand is dominated by Nature, with magnificent beaches, lakes and mountains. The mountainous nature of New Zealand is one of its most striking physical characteristics. About one-third of the Islands is mountainous.

The two main islands are long and narrow. New Zealand is 1600 kilometers from northern tip to the southern extremity, and their greatest width is 450 kilometers.

The North Island often resembles a calm golf course while the South Island is wild and majestic.

New Zealand rivers are mainly short and swift, seldom navigable, but a valuable source of hydroelectric power. The longest is Waikato river (425 km) in the North Island. Numerous lakes exist in both islands (natural and man-made). The larger North Island lakes are situated on the volcanic central plateau and the major South Island lakes are set in beautiful mountain scenery. The largest is Taupo lake (606 sq. km) in the North Island.

There is a great number of small islands, some of them far away from the main group. Stewart Island (1750 sq. km), much smaller than the two main islands, lies to the south.

The centre of New Zealand's North Island contains a cold desert. Through that desert goes State Highway 1, the main north-south road. This section of the road in the desert - the Desert Road - can often be closed in winter. The NZ Army mostly does peacekeeping. When George W. Bush was invading Iraq and asked New Zealand to send troops to fight, NZ's former Prime Minister Helen Clark sent engineers instead.

Many farmers in New Zealand breed sheep. There are many more sheep than people in New Zealand. Many New Zealanders are interested in sports.

Climate

New Zealand has an oceanic climate, without extremes of heat or cold. New Zealand enjoys long hours of sunshine throughout the year. In winter the South Island mountains and central North Island have heavy snowfalls.. Summer in New Zealand is from December to February, Winter from June to August.

Most parts of the country enjoy ample sunshine and rainfall, although the weather is changeable. Temperatures are higher in the north of the country with subtropical warmth in summer. Winter brings much snow in the Southern Alps. Snow is common only in the mountains.

Population

Although the country is about the same size as Japan, Italy or Great Britain, it is not as densely populated. In 1997 the total population numbered over 3,5 million people, including about 0,5 million Maori with an overall population density of about 13 persons per square kilometre.

The population is very unevenly distributed. Three fourths of New Zealanders, (including more than 95 percent of the Maori) live on the warmer North Island.

The largest centre of population is Auckland. About 73 percent of the population of New Zealand is of European (mainly British) descent. About 12 percent are Maori, a Polynesian group, whose ancestors migrated to New Zealand about the 14th century. Other ethnic groups make up the rest of the population.

Although the Maori have legal equality with those of European descent (called pakeha by the Maori), many feel unable to take their full place in a European-type society without compromising their traditional values.

New Zealand was one of the last land areas to be populated by human beings. It was first settled by Polynesians. They remained isolated in New Zealand until the arrival of European explorers (in 1642). During that time they grew in numbers to between 100,000 and 200,000, most of them lived on the North Island. They had no name for themselves and adopted the

name Maori (meaning "normal") to distinguish themselves from the Europeans, who, after the voyages of the Englishman Captain James Cook (1769—77), began to come with greater frequency.

Most immigrants were from the British Isles, but other Europeans came as well (from Scandinavia, Germany, Greece, Italy, and the Balkans). Groups of central Europeans came between World Wars I and II, and a large body of Dutch immigrants arrived after World War II. Asians coming to New Zealand have included Chinese and Indians and more recently a growing community of Pacific Islanders from Western Samoa, the Cook Islands, Niue, and Tokelau.

The people of New Zealand call themselves Kiwis, representing their national native although flightless bird.

Wellington

Wellington, the capital of New Zealand, is situated on a beautiful harbour at the southern tip of the North Island. Wellington's regional population is 400,000 and 150,000 in the city itself. It's a lively city with plenty to see and do — it's a centre for culture and arts and it's home to the country's government and national treasures. It's also a major travel crossroads between the North and South islands. The city's nickname is 'Windy Wellington', as it really can get windy, particularly as winter starts to arrive. Three buildings form New Zealand's parliamentary complex. By far the most distinctive and well known is the modernist building known as the **Beehive**. Designed by British architect Sir Basil Spence, it was begun in 1969 and completed in 1980. This building houses the executive offices. Next door, the **Old Parliament Building**, completed in 1922, closed in 1990, was reopened in 1996. Beside this, the neo-Gothic **Parliamentary Library** building is the oldest building in the parliamentary complex. The public is also welcome to attend meetings of the House of Representatives. It usually meets three out of four weeks every month with sessions Tuesday to during which you are free to come and go as you please from the public gallery. Opposite the Beehive stands **Old Government Building**, one of the largest all-wooden buildings in the world. The building was closed in 1992 due to a fire and is now being restored. **The National Library** houses by far the most comprehensive book collection in NZ. Also at the National Library is the Alexander Turnbull Library, an early colonial collection complete with many historical photographs, often

used for genealogical and other research on NZ. The library hosts lectures and cultural events which are free and open to the public and there are interesting art exhibits in the National Library Gallery.

A block away the **National Archives** display several interesting national treasures including the original Treaty of Waitangi and other historical treaties and documents. Also here are the New Zealand Portrait Gallery and other galleries with changing art exhibits. **Old St Paul's Cathedral** was built from 1863 to 1864 and looks giant from the outside, but the interior is a good example of Early English Gothic design in timber. The **National Museum** is a museum of art, history, Maori culture and the natural environment. It has an excellent Maori and Pacific Islands collection plus many other interesting exhibits. The **National Art Gallery** and New Zealand **Academy of Fine Arts** are also housed here. The **Maritime Museum** has many maritime relics associated with the city and a fine three-dimensional model of the harbour. The **Botanic Gardens** occupy 26 hectares of native bush and a wide variety of gardens including the Lady Norwood Rose Garden which has over 100 kinds of roses blooming from November to the end of April. Other gardens include secculents, ferns, threatened species, Australian plants, rhododendrons, fuchsias, camellias, begonias and herbs. The **NZ Astronomy Centre** is in the Botanic Gardens. It has displays, videos and computers relating to astronomy. The **Wellington Zoo** has a wide variety of native and other wildlife, including outdoor lion and chimpanzee park plus a nocturnal kiwi house also housing tuataras and giant wetas.

Religion

The most common religion in New Zealand is Christianity. The 'big three' denominations are Anglican (Church of England) with 25% of the population, Presbyterian with 18% and Roman Catholic with 16%. The Ratana and Ringatu faiths, also with significant followings, are Maori adaptations of Christianity. There is also a significant number of people (16.7%) who have no religion.

Education

New Zealanders place a high value on education, and virtually their entire population is literate. By law, education is mandatory and free for all children between the ages of six and 15; in fact most children enter school

by the age of five, and many also have attended preschools before that, all subsidised by the state. Correspondence school is available for children who live in remote places.

New Zealand has seven universities, a number of teachers' colleges and polytechnics and one agricultural college. A new and growing facet of education in New Zealand is that it is gaining a reputation.

Language

New Zealand has two official languages: English and Maori. The Maori language, long on the decline, is now making a comeback. You can use English to speak to anyone in New Zealand, as Maori people speak English.

As everywhere in the world where English is spoken, in New Zealand it is spoken in a unique way and is called Kivi English.

Government and Politics

New Zealand is a constitutional monarchy and parliamentary democracy. The head of state is Queen Elizabeth II. The Prime Minister is Mr. John Key. New Zealand has made itself a *Nuclear Free Zone*: They do not use nuclear power and do not allow nuclear weapons or nuclear powered vessels in their territory.

Natural History

New Zealand was isolated from the rest of the world for a long time. It split from Australia 83 million years ago. Because of this there are many plants and animals that only live in New Zealand. Before humans came to New Zealand, there were no mammals, except three species of bat and marine mammals such as seals, dolphins, and whales. Instead New Zealand has many different kinds of bird. New Zealand has several species of flightless bird, for example the kiwi. Especially important is the Tuatara, the only living member of a whole order of reptiles.

Culture and Sport

New Zealand has become more popular since Peter Jackson's *The Lord of the Rings* movies were all made there. Their national game is usually held to be rugby (in winter). They have impressive athletes in rowing, cycling, shotput, discus, iron man, triathlon, yachting, climbing, surfing, cricket, netball, softball, wind surfing, gliding, and more. New Zealanders enjoy outdoor pursuits. They have a "clean, green" image as a country. Air and water pollution is still fairly rare, though occasional outbreaks in the past 20 years have caused problems for livestock and the

surrounding waters. New Zealand, like many other small nations, has a strong local media. New Zealand has a wide variety of musicians, television (and even radio) celebrities, and stand-up comedians. Although most are simply "world-famous in New Zealand", many others have successfully made it on to the international scene. Such people include Russell Crowe (actor), Kiri Te Kanawa (singer), the Flight of the Conchords, Crowded House (band), Lee Tamahori (movie director), Peter Jackson (movie director).

CANADA



Location

The area of Canada is about 10 million square kilometres. Canada is the second largest country in the world after Russia and the largest country in the Western Hemisphere.

Canada is bounded by three oceans, the Atlantic in the east, the Pacific in the west and the Arctic in the north. Our country is Canada's neighbour across the Arctic Ocean.

Canada is about 7730 km from east to west. Its only neighbour is the USA, which includes Alaska in the north-west. Canada is bounded in the south by 12 states of the United States. Canada and the USA have the longest open border in the world. It is about 8,900 km long, it has no wire fence, no soldiers, no guns on either sides. It is called "The Border".

Canada's territory is diverse: mountains in the West, plains in the interior and hills in the East. Its territory also contains: prairies, badlands, sand dunes, boreal forests, rain forests, tundra, parkland, aspen forest, the Canadian Shield, the world's largest freshwater island (Manitoulin), and land access to the North Pole. There are 38 national parks in Canada.

Canada's highest mountain, **Mt Logan** at 5951 metres, is found in the south-west Yukon.

Canada can be divided into seven geographic regions each with its own characteristic scenery and landforms.

The far eastern area, **the Appalachian Region**, includes Newfoundland, Prince Edward Island, New Brunswick, Nova Scotia and the part of Quebec south of the St Lawrence River. The land is mainly hilly and wooded.

The St Lawrence-Great Lakes Lowland is roughly the area between Quebec City and Windsor, Ontario, and includes most of the country's large towns, cities and industry. In all, about half of Canada's people live here. The land, originally forested, later nearly all used for farming, is generally flat.

Centrally, south of vast Hudson Bay, the most dominant characteristics of the Canadian map, are **the Hudson Bay and Arctic Lowlands**. This region is little-inhabited or visited with the notable exception of Churchill, Manitoba.

Most of the north is taken up by **the Canadian Shield**, also known as the Precambrian Shield, formed 2.5 billion years ago. This geographic area covers all of northern Manitoba, Ontario and Quebec and stretches further east across Labrador and west to the northern edge of Alberta. It's an enormous ancient, rocky, glacially sanded region of typical Canadian river and lake-filled timberland. It is also very rugged, cool and little-developed, with mining and logging the two primary ingredients in human settlement. The fifth region, **the Great Plains**, runs through Manitoba, Saskatchewan and parts of Alberta. The plains, formerly grasslands, make up a huge, flat region now responsible for Canada's abundant wheat crop.

The sixth geographic area is **the Mountain or Western Cordillera Region** covering British Columbia, the Yukon and parts of Alberta. Mountains dominate this region. The Rocky Mountains form the eastern edge of the area rising from 2000 to 4000 metres. Between them and the coastal peaks lie a series of lesser mountain ranges and valleys. Among the latter is the long, narrow valley called the Rocky Mountain Trench.

The interior of British Columbia consists of countless troughs, plateaus, hills, gorges, basins and river deltas. The province is by far the most scenically varied and spectacular in the country. Further north, the twenty highest mountains in the country are found in the Yukon.

Lastly, there is the far north, **the Arctic region**. The northernmost section of the north is made up of islands frozen together for much of the year.

Freshwater lakes and rivers comprise almost 8 per cent of the area of Canada. One can see water everywhere in Canada: lakes, pools, rivers... They all freeze and stay frozen throughout winter. So there are natural skating rinks everywhere and most Canadians can skate and they like to skate. They also like ice-hockey - Canada's national game.

In the north of the country there are 330,000 Indians and 25,000 Eskimos who are the original peoples of the North, Central and South America.

The Great Lakes which include lakes Superior, Huron, Erie and Ontario Canada shares with the United States. Besides the Great Lakes there are also Great Bear Lake, Great Slave Lake, Lake Winnipeg and many smaller ones.

The most admirable sight which attracts tourists from all over the world is the Niagara Falls. They are on the Niagara River between lake Erie and Lake Ontario.

Climate

Canada has four distinct seasons all of which occur right across the country although their arrival times vary. The warmest area of Canada is along the US border. It's no accident that nearly everybody lives in this southernmost region. The overall warmest areas of the country are British Columbia's south and central coast and southern Ontario particularly around the Niagara Peninsula. These districts have the longest summers

and the shortest winters. July and August are the warmest months across the country and generally they are reasonably dry.

In Canada winter lasts from four to five months with heavy snowfalls. There is much rainfall in the east and west, but not so much in central Canada. Canadian winters are long. In more than two-thirds of the country the average January temperature is -18C. With its vast Arctic and subarctic territories, Canada is often considered a country only of the far north. That is why it is sometimes poetically called "Our Lady of the Snows" or the "Land of Ice and Snow".

Government

The form of the government of Canada is a constitutional monarchy. Though an independent nation, Canada like Australia, has close institutional links with Britain. Formally the head of the state is the King or Queen of England. The Queen is represented in Canada by the Governor-General (now always a Canadian), whom she appoints, on the advice of the Canadian Cabinet, for a period of five to seven years.

Canada has a Parliament. The Canadian Parliament is made up of the House of Commons and the Senate. The leader of the party that wins the largest number of seats in a newly elected House of Commons is asked to form the government.

The upper house, or Senate, is made up of appointees. Mostly it acts as a rubber stamp for the wishes of the elected lower house, or House of Commons. The head of the political party with the most elected representatives in the House of Commons becomes the prime minister, the leader of the country. From the members of parliament within the governing party, the prime minister selects a cabinet which, in effect, runs the country and initiates legislation. Unlike in the USA, leaders can run for as long as they maintain popular support within their party. Governments are elected for five years, but elections can be called earlier.

Canada includes 10 provinces: Alberta (the capital – Edmonton), British Columbia - BC (the capital – Victoria), Manitoba - MB (the capital – Winnipeg), New Brunswick-NB (the capital – Fredericton), Newfoundland – NF (the capital – St.John's), Nova Scotia – NS (the capital – Halifax), Ontario - ON (the capital – Toronto), Prince Edward Island - PE (the capital – Charlottetown), Quebec- QC (the capital –Quebec City), Saskatchewan – SK (the capital – Regina). There are also 3 territories in

Canada: Northwest Territory – NT (the capital – Yellowknife), Yukon Territory –YT (the capital –Whitehorse), Nunavut (the capital – Iqaluit).

The 10 provinces are largely self-governing and are presided over by premiers, elected provincially. Each province has a lieutenant governor appointed by the federal government. The two northern territories are for the most part the domain of the federal government, although more independence is being sought and some has been granted to the eastern part of the Northwest Territories.

The constitution consists of both written proclamations under the Constitution Acts (1867 and 1932) and unwritten conventions. Updating, changing and clarifying constitutional matters and the balance of powers between the provinces and between them and the federal government are on-going contentious issues.

The National Flag of Canada

The Canadian red and white maple leaf flag is officially called The National Flag of Canada. The Canadian flag shows a stylized red maple leaf with 11 points on a white background, with red borders down each side. The red and white used in the National Flag of Canada were proclaimed the official colours of Canada in 1921 by King George V. Although the maple leaf did not have official status as an emblem of Canada until the proclamation of the national flag in 1965, it had historically been used as a Canadian symbol, and was used in 1860 in decorations for the visit of the Prince of Wales to Canada. The 11 points on the maple leaf have no special significance.

Each province also has its own flag. The national anthem, "O Canada", was composed by Calixa Lavalee in 1880.

Ottawa — Canada's Capital City

Ottawa is the capital city of Canada. It is located on the southern bank of the Ottawa River. Many interesting historical and cultural buildings are found in Ottawa, such as the Museum of Natural History, Museum of Man, National Gallery and the National Arts Centre. However, the most important buildings in Ottawa are the Parliament Buildings. Here the Canadian federal government discusses and makes laws for Canada. Ottawa has been called the Tulip City, because every spring the city comes

alive with thousands of tulips from the Netherlands. Queen Juliana started sending 15,000 tulips a year to Ottawa in 1946 as a way of thanking the Canadian people for the time she spent in Canada with her daughters during World War II. Juliana stayed in Ottawa with her family from 1940 to 1945 after the Netherlands was invaded by Germany. Red and white with single maple leaf flag was adopted.

Population & People

Canada is a nation in North America composed of two linguistic and cultural groups: French and English. To these two major groups, and to the small native population of Indians and Eskimos, have been added many thousands of immigrants representing the major European cultures. The two official languages of Canada are English and French. The capital of the country is Ottawa.

Canada's population is now over 27 million. About 40% of Canadians are of British stock. French descendants of the original pioneers long made up about 30% of the population but this has dropped to about 25% and continues to fall. By far the majority of people of French descent live in Quebec but there are large numbers in New Brunswick, Ontario and Manitoba.

The English-speaking population has grown mainly by immigration from Britain and the USA. Over 3.5 million Canadians are of Scottish or Irish ancestry.

Generally speaking, the French are Catholic, the British Protestant, but religion does not play a large part in Canadian life.

Canada receives refugees from around the world. Toronto, the centre for international immigration, is one of the most cosmopolitan cities in the world.

Aboriginal Peoples

These now number about 330,000 Native Indians and 27,000 Inuit, roughly a third more than when Europeans first arrived. There are "also approximately 400,000 *metis*, the name used to denote those of mixed aboriginal and European blood. All together the three groups make up about, 4% of Canada's total population. The majority are found in the Yukon, Northwest Territories and Ontario but every province has some aboriginal communities.

Inuit is the general name for the Eskimo peoples in Canada. Collectively the Indians, Inuit and Metis are also called Native Canadians.

There are about 2250 reserves scattered across Canada and 600 government registered Native Indian 'bands' which has become a political and organisational term. Every Native Indian is officially affiliated with a band. Some bands can own more than one reserve.

About 72% of Native Indians now live on these government reserves. A range of national organisations such as the Assembly of First Nations keep Native Indian interests from being pushed aside.

Education

Under the jurisdiction of the provinces, Canada provides free education from elementary through to secondary school. Beyond that tuition must be paid in what are known as community colleges (CEGEPS in Quebec) and universities, although the true cost is subsidised through taxes.

At the early levels, there are two basic school systems, known as the public and the separate. Both are free and essentially the same but the latter is designed for Catholics and offers more religious education along with the three 'R's. Anyone can attend either one but the two systems do split pretty much along religious denomination.

French-immersion programmes, in which English children are taught all their courses in French, are quite popular across Canada.

There are also a number of private schools but no real private system. Schools in this category include alternative educational methods such as Waldorf and Montessori.

The education system has been under constant scrutiny in recent years. Students leaving high school have fared poorly in international testing, have been called essentially illiterate by universities and, according to business leaders, are poorly prepared for jobs in industry.

A national survey in 1989 found that 62% of Canadians had enough reading skills to get through an average Canadian day reasonably competently. Numeracy came out to about the same percentages. Since then there has been an effort to tighten up on the teaching and testing of the fundamentals.

Not quite half of all Canadians finish high school. About 10% have a university degree. Students from around the world attend Canadian universities.

Community colleges present one to three-year programmes in a range of fields from graphic design to jewellery-making to nursing. These are taught under the broad categories of Arts, Business, Science & Technology and Health Services. Universities provide higher academic and professional training.

Elementary and Secondary Education

There is no federal ministry of education in Canada. By the Constitution education is the responsibility of the provinces. Each province and territory in Canada has its own school system. So, education in Canada comprises 10 provincial and 2 territorial systems. Every system is supervised by the provincial or territorial department of education. Each provincial system, is similar to the others, but it also reflects its specific regional concerns and historical and cultural heritage. A provincial department of education is headed by an elected minister. It sets standards, draws up curriculums and gives grants to educational institutions of a province.

The federal government directs education of the families of Canada's armed forces, indigenous peoples on reserves, and inmates of federal penitentiaries. It provides financial support for post-secondary education, adult occupational training and the teaching of the two official languages - especially second-language training.

There are public, separate and private schools within each of the 12 systems. Separate schools are schools run by religious groups, mostly Roman Catholic. Separate schools are publicly maintained by the provinces of Ontario, Saskatchewan, and Alberta. They offer a complete parochial curriculum from kindergarten through the secondary level in some provinces. Private or independent schools offer a great variety of curriculums. Dual public-school boards for both Protestants and Roman Catholics are maintained by the provinces of Quebec and Newfoundland. Schools are operated by local education authorities and generally offer 6 to 8 years of elementary and 3 to 5 years of secondary schooling.

The vast, sparsely settled areas of Canada present special problems in delivering education. Correspondence programs and educational television and teleconferencing have been introduced. Educational systems in

Canada derive from British, American, and particularly in the province of Quebec French traditions.

Students in Quebec are mostly taught in French. In some cases they may be taught in English, for example, if their parents were taught in an English-language school in Quebec. Most of the Quebec's Catholic schools teach in French, most Protestant schools use English.

MODULE III

МЕТОДИЧЕСКИЕ РЕКОМЕНДАЦИИ ПО ОРГАНИЗАЦИИ САМОСТОЯТЕЛЬНОЙ РАБОТЫ

Методические рекомендации для преподавателей по организации самостоятельной работы студентов

Рекомендации по организации работы с лексическим материалом

1. Следует учитывать, что опора на словообразовательный признак и знание словообразовательных элементов служит:

- для расширения словарного запаса;
- для определения части речи по морфологическому признаку;
- для определения рода имени существительного;
- для определения значения слова;
- для умения самим образовывать новые слова;
- для развития языковой догадки.

2. Важную роль в овладении иностранным языком имеет развитие языковой догадки, которая помогает понять значение слова, пользуясь следующими приемами:

- определение значения слова из контекста;
- сходство слов со словами родного языка;
- знание значения корня или однокоренных слов;
- знание значения словообразовательных элементов;
- разложение сложных существительных на составные компоненты;
- привлечение своих знаний из различных областей.

3. Особое внимание следует обращать на интернациональную лексику. Знание этой лексики не только способствует развитию языковой догадки, увеличивает словарный запас, но и расширяет кругозор, повышает общую культуру.

4. Полезно запоминать не отдельные слова, а словосочетания, выражения или целые фразы. Это позволит Вам быстрее подбирать нужные слова, строить предложения, использовать их в новом контексте.

5. Расширению словарного запаса может помочь запоминание новых слов по карточкам, что позволит учить слова в свободное время. На одной стороне карточки пишется слово или словосочетание на иностранном языке, на обратной стороне – перевод. С карточками следует работать до тех пор, пока Вы не сможете быстро

воспроизводить изучаемую лексику как с одной стороны карточки (английский вариант), так и с другой (русский вариант). Целесообразно составить тематическую или поурочную картотеку изучаемой лексики. Время от времени желательно проверять знание слов, выученных по карточкам.

Методические рекомендации по обучению дискуссии

Дискуссия (от лат. discussio — рассмотрение, исследование) — обсуждение какого-либо спорного вопроса, проблемы. Важной характеристикой дискуссии, отличающей её от других видов спора, является аргументированность. Обсуждая спорную (дискуссионную) проблему, каждая сторона, оппонируя мнению собеседника, аргументирует свою позицию.

Дискуссия на уроке

1. Знакомство с темой дискуссии. Для проведения беседы необходим текст с противоречивым содержанием. Преподаватель предъявляет уже известный текст.

1. Студенты читают текст вслух.
2. Преподаватель выясняет тему.
3. Преподаватель записывает вопросы на доске.

2. Разработка и систематизация аргументов

На этом этапе

1. Студенты должны подобрать аргументы «за» или «против» по каждому вопросу.
2. Затем проводится короткая дискуссия в группе.
3. После этого группа делится на две группы (можно и больше) — «за» и «против».
4. Работа в группе. Студентам предлагается подобрать соответствующие аргументы и записать их с помощью ключевых слов на доске.
5. Обсуждение аргументов.
6. Студентам предлагается сгруппировать аргументы.

3. Преддискуссионная работа

Чтобы отработать языковые средства, часто предъявляются минитексты, которые содержат различные аргументы.

Так как такие тексты ориентируются на реальный разговор, при обсуждении используются не аргументы «за» и «против», а «утверждения», «оценки», «предположения».

Учитель задаёт вопросы для выяснения общего понимания содержания.

4. Разработка речевых средств

1. Студенты читают материал для дискуссии вслух, помечают в тексте аргументы, приводимые с помощью речевых средств: «Это верно, но...», «У меня другое мнение...».
2. Студенты читают текст ещё раз вслух, заменяя подчёркнутые выражения альтернативными речевыми средствами (размещёнными на слайде или рабочих листах).
3. Преподаватель останавливает чтение после каждого отрывка, чтобы студенты использовали нужные выражения.

5. Проведение дискуссии

На этом этапе студент может взять на себя роль руководителя проведения дискуссии. Он обращает внимание на очерёдность выступлений и напоминает участникам дискуссии по возможности обращаться к собеседникам. Не следует прерывать дискуссию, исправляя ошибки. Студенты ведут свободную дискуссию. Они используют при этом отработанный материал.

2. Преподаватель или студент, ведущий дискуссию, может при случае по возникшим вопросам придать дискуссии новые импульсы.

- Дискуссия записывается на магнитофон и позже вместе с учащимися анализируется применение аргументов.

Рекомендации по организации работы со словарями. Типы словарей

Из всех типов словарей наиболее необходимым для изучающих иностранный язык является **д в у я з ы ч н ы й** переводной словарь – англо-русский и русско-английский. Наиболее полные, точные и полезные словари – те, которые выдержали уже не один десяток изданий: Англо-русский словарь под ред. В. К. Мюллера и Русско-

английский словарь под ред. А. И. Смирницкого. Именно на их базе создан электронный словарь LINGVO (основной). Еще в 70-е годы прошлого века вышло первое издание двухтомного Большого англо-русского словаря под ред. И. Р. Гальперина. Затем вышел большой словарь под ред. Ю. Д. Апресяна (они имеются в продаже на компакт-дисках). Эти большие словари могут пригодиться, если нет под рукой одного или нескольких специализированных словарей, и большой словарь как бы заключает несколько в одном. Современные словари часто имеют «коммерческие» названия: «большой», «новый», «полный», «современный» и т. д. На самом деле эти словари, как правило, уступают названным выше и по объему, и по полноте, и по точности перевода. Большой словарь должен включать не менее 80 000 слов. Студентам неязыковых специальностей может быть достаточно словаря меньшего объёма, но не менее 40 000 слов. Мы рекомендуем пользоваться последними переизданиями старых словарей.

Второй тип словарей – это о т р а с л е в ы е словари, например, медицинский, экономический, юридический и т. п. Их электронные аналоги имеются в пакете программ LINGVO и в электронном переводчике PROMT. Существуют специализированные издания, например, словари сокращений, слэнга, новых слов и т. п. словари синонимов по-другому называются тезаурусами. Существуют как бумажные, так и электронные тезаурусы, например, Collins. Самый доступный электронный тезаурус (русский и английский) встроен в текстовый редактор WORD. Выделив слово и нажав кнопку, можно выбрать синоним и вставить его в текст.

Третий тип – т о л к о в ы е « а н г л о - а н г л и й с к и е » словари. Можно выделить два основных подтипа: учебные и энциклопедические. К первым относится, например, Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary, ко второму типу – Collins English Dictionary.

В первом словаре даны основные энциклопедические сведения, во втором (учебном) определения проще, меньше значений и больше примеров. Следует учитывать, что словари с пометкой **for advanced learners** предназначены именно для продвинутого этапа. Они оптимальны для студентов, изучающих английский как специальность. Начинающим лучше выбрать словари для начального уровня. Издательства Oxford University Press, Cambridge University

Press, Macmillan, Longman, Collins описывают прежде всего британский вариант английского языка, Webster – самое известное издательство американских словарей. В некоторых словарях (Macmillan, Longman Dictionary of the English Language and Culture) даются основные лингвострановедческие сведения. Изданы и специальные лингвострановедческие словари. Мы рекомендуем словари Г. Д. Томахина. Для студентов они удобны тем, что основная информация дается на русском языке. Самый полный фразеологический словарь английского языка составлен А. В. Куниным.

Словари отличаются между собой тем, сколько значений они выделяют у одного слова, рассматривают ли они одинаковые слова как омонимы или как разные значения одного слова. Нужно внимательно прочитать всю словарную статью и определить, какое значение слова подходит по контексту. Например, русское слово «образование» имеет несколько значений. Фразу «начальное образование» следует переводить *primary education*, «образование слов» – *word building*, «образование нового отдела» – *formation of new division*. Одна из главных ошибок при переводе – буквализм. «Детективный роман» – не *detective novel*, а *mystery novel*. Существует немало слов, которые называют «ложными друзьями переводчика». Например, *troops* – не «трупы», а «войска», *corpse* – не «корпус», а «труп».

Рекомендации по организации работы с электронными ресурсами

Все современные словари имеют электронные варианты. Они существуют как в off-line версиях на компакт-дисках, так и в режиме on line. On-line версии, как правило, менее полные, в них нет некоторых опций (например, расширенного поиска и др.). Тем не менее, и они могут быть подспорьем, особенно если доступ в сеть бесплатный. Вот некоторые адреса:

- <http://www.lingvo.ru/lingvo/index.asp> – сайт электронного словаря LINGVO.
- <http://www.translate.ru/rus/> – сайт электронного переводчика PROMT. Следует учитывать, что электронный перевод всегда требует более или менее значительного редактирования. Иногда

редактирование занимает больше времени, чем обычный перевод. Электронный переводчик удобен, если текст крупный по объему, и набирать перевод вручную слишком долго.

- <http://britannica.com/> – сайт Британской энциклопедии.

- <http://www.americana.ru> – сайт лингвострановедческого словаря «Американа».

- <http://www.polyglosso.com/links.htm> – сайт, содержащий много полезных ссылок, в том числе на словари Oxford, Cambridge, Webster's, Macmillan, Encarta, Collins, Longman, самый известный английский тезаурус Роже (Roget's), ссылки для учителей, студентов, тесты on-line и т. п.

- <http://www.cas.okstate.edu/jb/faculty/ketterer/diction.htm> – сайт, содержащий ссылки на Библиотеку Конгресса США, другие библиотеки, энциклопедии, словари (перечисленные выше и многие другие).

- <http://www.onelook.com/> – сайт, в котором одним нажатием кнопки можно получить статьи сразу из нескольких десятков словарей и сравнить их.

Многоязычные словари

- <http://www.ets.ru/udict-r.htm>

- <http://www.ets.ru/abbrdict-r.htm>

- <http://www.yourdictionary.com/>

- <http://wordreference.com/>

Электронные библиотеки

- <http://www.gutenberg.org/> – самая крупная в Интернете бесплатная многоязычная библиотека художественной литературы. Содержит тексты на английском, немецком, французском и многих других языках. Пополняется ежедневно.

- <http://www.bartleby.com/reference/> – полезный справочный сайт, включает также многотомную Библиотеку классической литературы на английском языке, словари, энциклопедии.

Русскоязычные электронные библиотеки

- <http://lib.ru> – библиотека Максима Мошкова – крупнейшая русскоязычная электронная библиотека. Есть раздел «учим английский язык».

- www.lib.aldebaran.ru – библиотека «Альдебаран». Вторая по посещаемости русскоязычная электронная библиотека. Дополняет некоторые разделы библиотеки Мошкова. Большой раздел художественной литературы. Серьезная научная литература практически не представлена. Пополняется ежедневно.

- <http://publ.lib.ru> – библиотека Вадима Ершова.

Другие библиотеки

- <http://fictionbook.ru>

- <http://bookz.ru>

- <http://www.gumer.info/> – научная, философская, религиозная и другая гуманитарная литература.

Рекомендации по организации работы с текстами для чтения

Чтобы научиться понимать и переводить иноязычный текст, необходимо в первую очередь научить студента выделять и понимать содержание на уровне *текста*, *абзаца* и *предложения*, а также дифференцировать основную и второстепенную информацию.

Основные признаки текста: 1) *связность*; 2) *тематичность* (все предложения объединены какой-либо одной темой); 3) *цельность* (использование средств связи между предложениями).

Тема текста. Текст представляет собой сложное суждение, в котором есть текстовый субъект (о чем говорится в тексте?) и текстовый предикат (что говорится в тексте?).

Текстовым **субъектом** является тема текста, которая находит словесное выражение чаще всего в заголовке или в самом начале текста.

Текстовый **предикат** представляет собой группу суждений, раскрывающих тему текста, т. е. сам текст.

Главное содержание текста. Понять содержание текста – значит уяснить его тему и идею.

Тема текста – это предмет данного описания, т. е. предмет, явление, событие, о которых идет речь в тексте.

Идея текста – это главная мысль о данном предмете, авторское отношение к описываемому предмету. Идея текста – это вывод, к которому должен прийти читающий после ознакомления с содержанием текста.

Тема часто сообщается в заголовке или в первом предложении текста. Понять идею можно лишь после прочтения всего текста. Иногда она не имеет словесного выражения, тогда читающий должен сам сделать определенные выводы.

Основное содержание текста. Для этой цели выделяются элементы, в которых заключена основная смысловая информация текста. Они называются “ключевыми фрагментами” (слово, словосочетание, предложение, группа предложений). Каждый абзац имеет ключевое предложение – “абзацную фразу”, если их объединить, то можно получить основное содержание текста. Ключевое предложение может находиться: а) в верхней части абзаца (*дедуктивная* структура – изложение мысли от общего к частному); б) в нижней части абзаца (*индуктивная* структура – изложение мысли от частного к общему); в) в верхней и в нижней части (*рамочная* логическая структура). Другие предложения текста представляют собой способ логического развития мысли в абзаце.

Формы передачи информации. Существуют следующие формы передачи информации: *сообщение, описание, повествование и рассуждение*. Так, ядро самого простого типа информации – сообщения – составляют ответы на следующие вопросы: кто, что, когда, где, как, почему. В текстах психолого-педагогического профиля преобладает тип информации о ситуации или положении дел, а также комбинированный тип информации (сообщение, передача высказывания, информация о событии или факте, о ситуации или положении дел, рассуждение).

Основные виды текстов для чтения

- 1) учебный;
- 2) художественный (story – рассказ, play – пьеса, novel – роман);
- 3) научный и научно-популярный (research work – научный труд, theses – диссертация; monograph – монография; reference – статья из справочной литературы; article – журнальная статья; notes – сообщение).

Методические рекомендации для студентов.

Чтение с полным пониманием прочитанного

Цель – полностью понять содержание текста, выделить главную информацию, передать содержание, оценить его, сравнить с уже известным ранее.

Алгоритм

1. Перед чтением спрогнозируйте по заголовку содержание текста.

2. Читайте текст с полным пониманием, т. е. старайтесь как можно точнее понять содержание и смысл читаемого. При этом догадаться о значении слов вам помогут:

- контекст;
- сходство слов со словами родного языка;
- однокоренные слова;
- разложение сложных существительных на составные компоненты;
- использование словаря.

3. Проверьте, насколько хорошо Вы поняли содержание и смысл текста. Для этого необходимо:

- ответить на вопросы к тексту, позволяющие выделить детали;
- самостоятельно поставить вопросы к тексту;
- составить развернутый план прочитанного.

4. Для подготовки *пересказа* текста необходимо:

- найти в тексте и выписать основные ключевые слова и выражения;
- составить последовательность фактов и событий;
- изложить содержание текста с опорой на ключевые слова и выражения.

5. Для характеристики

6. какого-либо объекта текста необходимо:

- определить объект характеристики;
- выписать слова и выражения, относящиеся к определяемому объекту;

- описать объект;
 - высказать свое мнение о нем.
7. Для подготовки *высказывания* по проблеме текста следует:
- определить исходный тезис;
 - определить основной материал для аргументирования;
 - выписать ключевые слова и словосочетания;
 - аргументировать тезис;
 - привести примеры.
8. Для *обсуждения проблемы* текста следует:
- выделить предмет обсуждения;
 - выделить информацию о предмете;
 - выписать ключевые слова и словосочетания;
 - выразить свое отношение к предмету;
 - аргументировать свою точку зрения.
9. Для *реферирования* текста необходимо:
- зафиксировать основные опорные пункты;
 - распределить информацию по степени важности.
10. Для *аннотирования* текста следует:
- зафиксировать тему и главную мысль;
 - выразить свое отношение.

Чтение с пониманием основного содержания

Цель – получить общую информацию о содержании текста, выделить главную мысль, высказать свое отношение к прочитанному.

Алгоритм

1. Перед чтением спрогнозируйте по заголовку содержание текста.
2. Читайте текст с пониманием основного содержания, то есть:
 - сконцентрируйтесь на основных фактах текста, опуская второстепенную информацию;
 - старайтесь охватить взглядом все предложение или его часть;
 - старайтесь догадаться о значении незнакомых слов или обратитесь к словарю;

- во время чтения подчеркивайте или выписывайте словосочетания и предложения, несущие основную информацию.

3. Проверьте, поняли ли Вы основные факты текста, определите его основную мысль. Для этого необходимо:

- выбрать заголовок из предлагаемых вариантов или сформулировать самому;
- разделить текст на смысловые отрезки;
- ответить на вопросы, выделяющие основную информацию.

4. Для подготовки высказывания следует:

- сформулировать главную мысль текста;
- сказать, что Вы узнали нового;
- кратко изложить основные идеи текста;
- высказаться по проблеме текста.

Схема анализа художественного текста

1. Расскажите известные вам сведения об авторе:

- факты биографии;
- историческое время и социальные условия;
- основные работы.

2. Кратко перескажите текст, обращая внимание на:

- основное содержание;
- представленные факты.

3. Обозначьте проблему текста.

4. Сформулируйте основную идею текста.

5. Дайте общее определение текста:

- рассказ от третьего лица;
- рассказ от первого лица;
- повествование с описанием и диалогами героев;
- повествование с отступлениями (философскими, лирическими, психологическими...);
- перечисление событий с ироничным (сатирическим) описанием общества (персонажа).

6. Определите основное настроение текста: лирическое, драматическое, трагическое, веселое, оптимистическое,

пессимистическое, мелодраматическое, сентиментальное, эмоциональное, неэмоциональное, мрачное, саркастическое.

7. Разделите текст на логически завершённые части и озаглавьте их.

8. Определите структуру текста:

- 1) введение;
- 2) завязка;
- 3) кульминация;
- 4) развязка.

Рекомендуемые клише для анализа текста, написания аннотации, реферата, сообщения, доклада, презентации

1. Используйте фразы и словосочетания, структурирующие изложение содержания текста:

• The article is called ... = The title of the article is ... – Статья называется ...

• The article is published in ... = The article is printed in ... – Статья опубликована в ...

• The article is about / on ... – Статья о ...

• The article is concerned with ... – Статья связана с ...

• The article deals with ... – Статья повествует о ...

• The article touches upon the problem of ... – Статья затрагивает проблему ...

• In the introductory part of the article the author points out ... – В первой части статьи автор указывает, что ...

• The following facts are stressed in the article ... – В статье подчеркиваются следующие факты ...

• The article contains useful information on ... – Статья содержит полезную информацию о ...

• In concluding paragraphs it is pointed out ... – В заключительной части указывается, что ...

• The article contains statistics about ... – Статья содержит данные о ...

• Reader's attention is drawn to ... – Внимание читателя обращается на ...

• I find the article interesting / important ... – Я нахожу статью интересной / важной ...

• You may not believe it, but ... – Это невероятно, но ...

• The most surprising thing is that ... – Самое удивительное заключается в том, что ...

• I'd like to express my own opinion on the problem ... – Хотелось бы выразить моё личное мнение по вопросу о ...

• I agree / disagree with the position of the author ... – Я согласен / не согласен с позицией автора ...

• I share / don't share the author's point of view on the problem ... – Я разделяю / не разделяю позицию автора.

Transitional words and expressions: first of all / at first / secondly / then / besides that / next / in conclusion / finally. – Связующие слова и фразы: прежде всего / во-первых / во-вторых / затем / кроме того / далее / в заключение / и наконец.

The article is devoted to ... – Статья посвящена ...

The story represents the conflict between ... – В рассказе представлен конфликт между ...

The basic theme of the story is ... – Основная тема рассказа ...

The problem raised by the author is ... – Проблема, поднятая автором ...

The main problem may be formulated in the following way: ... – Главную проблему можно сформулировать как ...

In the story the writer dwells upon (raises, touches upon) the problem of ... – В рассказе писатель затрагивает проблему ...

The idea is revealed in the final passage (in the episode where, in concluding sentence) ... – Идея раскрывается в последнем эпизоде ...

The main idea conveyed by the author is ... – Главная идея автора ...

The general mood of the text is ... – основное настроение текста ...

The extract may be divided into (split into, falls into) 3 logically complete parts. – Отрывок можно разделить на три логически законченные части.

They can be entitled as ... – Их можно озаглавить ...

The narration is done in the 1st (the 3rd) person. – Повествование ведётся от третьего лица.

The article is called ... = The title of the article is ... – Статья называется ...

Написание реферата

Реферат - краткое точное изложение содержания документа, включающее основные фактические сведения и выводы, без дополнительной интерпретации или критических замечаний автора реферата.

Реферат включает следующие аспекты содержания исходного документа:

- предмет, тему, цель работы;
- метод или методологию проведения работы;
- результаты работы;
- область применения результатов;
- выводы;
- дополнительную информацию.

Клише для ведения дискуссии

Let's discuss pros and cons– Давайте обсудим «за» и «против»
Let's clear it up. It's the matter of great importance. - Давай разберёмся. Это дело большой важности

Вступаем в дискуссию, озвучиваем тему своего высказывания

What I want to speak about is... То, о чем я хочу поговорить
сейчас - это...
Let me inform you about... – Позвольте мне сообщить вам...
And now about... – А теперь о...
As for... - Что касается...
My speech will be about ... – Речь пойдет о...
I will tell you about... – Я расскажу Вам о...

Оцениваем информацию, которой делимся с окружающими

At first – Во-первых
First of all – Прежде всего
As far as I remember/know... – Насколько я помню/знаю...
If I'm not mistaken... – Если я не ошибаюсь...
If I remember rightly... – Если я правильно помню...
It's common knowledge that... – Это общеизвестно, что...
It's well known that... – Хорошо известно, что...
Everybody knows... – Все знают, что...
No one is surprised to hear that... – Никто не удивится, услышав,
что...
It's important, I think. – Я думаю, это важно.
It's also very interesting that – Также очень интересно...
Frankly speaking – Честно говоря
Strictly speaking – Строго говоря
To say the truth – По правде сказать
In fact – На самом деле
There is no doubt that... – Нет сомнений в том, что...

Озвучиваем ход мысли

Now, where was I? – Итак, о чем я говорил?...
Where were we? – На чем мы остановились?
Getting back to the topic – Возвращаясь к теме
What are you driving at? – К чему ты клонишь?
I just say things that come into my head. – Я просто говорю то, что
приходит на ум.

Дополняем высказывание

In addition... – В дополнение...

I would like to add that – Я бы хотел добавить, что...

By the way – кстати, между прочим

Just for the record – для справки

Заполняем паузы, выигрываем время

Let me think... – Дайте подумать...

Wait a moment / just a moment / minute... – Секундочку....

How could it slip my mind? – Как это могло выскочить у меня из головы?

Oh, it's a pity, I don't remember his name – Жаль, но я не помню его имени...

I'm trying to collect my thoughts. – Пытаюсь собраться с мыслями.

Сомневаемся в понимании услышанного, переспрашиваем, уточняем

What do you mean? – Что Вы имеете в виду?

What does it mean? – Что это значит?

.... What is it? - ... (слово, которое не поняли) Что это?

What do you want to say? – Что Вы хотите сказать?

Could you say it again? – Скажите, пожалуйста, еще раз.

Could you repeat, please? – Не могли бы вы повторить, пожалуйста.

Excuse me, I don't understand. Could you speak not so quickly? – Простите, я не понимаю. Не могли бы вы говорить не так быстро?

I don't quite follow you. – Я не совсем улавливаю мысль.

I'm not sure I get what you mean.- Я не уверен, что понял, что Вы имели в виду.

What did you say? – Что вы сказали?

In other words... – Другими словами...

Paraphrasing we can say... – Иными словами можно сказать...

Подтверждаем понимание

I see... – Я вижу (понимаю)...

I understand... – Понимаю...

And? ..И?

I got it. – Понял.

Реагируем на полученную информацию

Really? – Правда?

Are you sure? – Вы уверены?

I was surprised. – Я удивлен.

That's awful! – Это ужасно!

Shame on you! – Как не стыдно!

It doesn't matter for me. – Это не имеет значения для меня.

It's a pity. – Жаль.

It could be better. – Могло бы быть лучше.

It could have been worse! – Могло быть и хуже.

Dear me! – Вот это да! (удивление)

O my God! – Боже мой! (удивление)

Things happen. – Всякое бывает.

It's terrible! – Это ужасно!

It's boring! – Это скучно!

I didn't like it at all. – Мне это не нравится вообще.

It is great! I like it. – Здорово! Мне нравится.

It's really interesting. – Это действительно интересно.

I can't say it's great. – Не могу сказать, что это здорово.

Not bad. – Неплохо.

I dislike it. – Мне не нравится.

Задаем вопрос

May I ask you... – Можно у вас спросить...

I wonder... – Интересно...

I would like to know... – Мне хотелось бы знать...

Tell me please... – Скажите мне, пожалуйста...

My question is... – У меня такой вопрос
I wish I knew... – Хотел бы я знать...

Реагируем на вопрос

I really don't know. – Я действительно не знаю.
It's an interesting question, thanks a lot. – Это интересный вопрос, спасибо.

Выражаем собственное мнение

In my opinion – По моему мнению
I think – Я думаю
To my mind – По-моему
From my point of view – С моей точки зрения
I believe... – Я считаю...
I suppose – Я полагаю/предполагаю
As for me... – Что касается меняэээ
I'm sure – Я уверен...
Probably – Возможно, вероятно
Something tells me – Что-то мне подсказывает...
It was just my point of view. – Это только моя точка зрения.
I found out that... – И я выяснил, что...
I just wanted to show you... – Я просто хотел показать Вам, что...
That's my opinion! And I don't eat my words. – Это мое мнение, и я не беру своих слов обратно.

Поддерживаем внимание собеседника, расставляем логические акценты

Believe it or not... – Веришь или нет...
Look here... – Послушай...
You know... – Вы знаете...
Please, pay attention to the fact that... – Пожалуйста, обратить внимание на тот факт, что...
As you may know... – Как вы, наверно, знаете...
You see... – Как Вы видите...

Вежливо прерываем собеседника

Excuse me... – Простите...

Pardon me... – Простите...

Sorry to interrupt... – Простите, что прерываю...

May I interrupt (for a minute)? – Можно прервать Вас (на секундочку)?

Can I add something here? – Можно я добавлю здесь....

Выражаем несогласие с аргументами собеседника и приводим встречные аргументы

I'm afraid you aren't quite right... – Боюсь Вы не совсем правы...

I don't understand you... – Я не понимаю Вас...

I should not say so... – Я бы так не сказал...

I doubt it... – Сомневаюсь...

It's an interesting idea but... – Интересная идея, но...

Yes, but ... – Да, но...

Yes, you are right, but... – Да, Вы правы, но...

You may be right, but... – Возможно Вы правы, но...

I may be wrong, but... – Возможно я не прав, но...

Not bad. I just want to pay your attention... – Неплохо. Но я просто хочу обратить Ваше внимание....

But don't forget about... – Но не забывайте о...

It's true but... – Это правда, но...

It might be so, but... – Может быть и так, но...

Far from it... – Совсем не так...

Nothing of the kind. – Ничего похожего.

Nothing like that. – Ничего подобного.

I can't say I agree. – Не могу сказать, что я согласен.

I just want you to understand that... – Я только хочу, чтоб Вы поняли, что...

Most unlikely. – Непохоже, что это так.

I don't think so. – Я так не думаю.

I wish I could agree, but I really can't. – Был бы рад согласиться, но не могу.

To offence, but... – Без обид, но...
It's clear, but... – Понятно, но...
It doesn't prove your idea. – Это не доказывает Вашу мысль.
You had better think about... – Вы бы лучше подумали о...
On the contrary – Наоборот
In spite of this... – Несмотря на это...
I hope you'll change your mind. – Надеюсь, Вы измените свое мнение.
Generally I like your idea, but... – В целом мне нравится Ваша идея, но...
It's a lie. – Это ложь.
It seems me to be false. – Это представляется мне неверным
I understand your position but... – Мне понятна Ваша позиция, но...
What are you talking about? – О чём ты говоришь?
But we must take into account... – Но нам следует принимать во внимание...
But we must take into consideration... – Но нам следует учитывать...
But it is to be noted... – Но необходимо заметить...
Deep down I disagree. – В глубине души я не согласен.
But, please, don't let out of your sight the fact ... – Но, пожалуйста, не упускайте из вида тот факт...
But I dare say – Но я осмелюсь сказать...

Соглашаемся с собеседником

Exactly! –Точно! Именно!
Naturally! - Естественно!
Quite so. – Именно так.
That's right. – Правильно.
I agree with you. – Я согласен.
You read my mind. – Ты читаешь мои мысли.
I dare not protest. – Не смею возражать.
Hmmm... I hadn't thought of that before. – Ммм... Не думал об этом раньше.
It's new to me. – Это новая информация для меня.

Предлагаем собеседнику

Let's – Давай...

Why don't we (+ глагол в начальной форме)... – почему бы нам не (+ глагол в начальной форме)...

May be we will – Может быть

We could... if you like it... – Мы могли бы ... если ты хочешь...

If you don't mind, let's... – Если Вы не против, давайте...

And what about (+Ving) – А как насчет ...?

May be ... What do you think of it? – Может быть... Что ты думаешь об этом?

If I were you I would ... – На твоём месте я бы...

What if... – Что, если...

What do you think about ... – Что ты думаешь насчет...?

Реагируем на предложение

It's worth trying/discussing... – Стоит попробовать/обсудить...

That's interesting. – Это интересно.

Great idea! – Отличная идея!

I have nothing against! – Ничего не имею против.

Why not? – Почему бы нет?

It's fantastic! – Фантастика!

That's great! – Отлично!

OK. – Хорошо.

Of course. – Конечно (разумеется, это и так все знают).

Certainly. – Конечно.

With great pleasure. – С удовольствием.

As you want. – Как хочешь.

It's all the same to me. – Мне без разницы.

What for? – Зачем?

Заканчиваем дискуссию, подводим итоги

People say tastes differ. – Говорят, что о вкусах не спорят.

It's matter of opinion. – Это спорный вопрос.

All in all.. – В конечном счёте, с учётом всех обстоятельств...
Wait and see. – Поживём увидим.
Let's drop the subject. – Давай оставим эту тему.
I don't want to discuss this problem. – Я не хочу обсуждать эту проблему.
In any case it was nice to speak to you. – В любом случае было приятно поговорить с Вами.
Use your own judgement. – Решай сам.
To sum up... – Подводя итог, суммируя все вышесказанное...
In short / in brief / in a word – Короче
In general... – В общем...
In conclusion I would like to say... – В заключение я хотел бы сказать...
After all... – В конце концов, в итоге....
So the main idea is that... – Итак, основная идея заключается в том, что...

ПРИЛОЖЕНИЕ

QUIZ

- 1) What does the Indian word Canada stand for?
 - a. small huts along the shore
 - b. the land of fish eaters
 - c. an animal hunters' village

- 2) Who were Canada's first immigrants?
 - a. the Inuit and the Indians
 - b. the Americans and the Russians
 - c. the Ukrainians

- 3) How many parts does Canada consist of?
 - a. 10 provinces and 2 territories
 - b. fifteen states
 - c. 10 provinces and 2 regions

- 4) What country were the first colonists in Canada from?
 - a. France
 - b. Britain
 - c. the USA

- 5) When did Canada become under the English power as a result of the 7-year war between England and France?
 - a. 1763
 - b. 1715
 - c. 1781

- 6) What is the second largest French-speaking city in the world, often called "the Paris of North America".
 - a. Montreal
 - b. Ottawa
 - c. Toronto

7) When was gold first struck in Canada (in Bonanza Creek, a tributary of the Klondike River).

- a. 1896
- b. 1815
- c. 1848

8) What is the national tree of Canada?

- a. the maple tree
- b. the pine tree
- c. the oak tree

9) Whom does the Governor-General represent in Canada?

- a. Queen Elizabeth II
- b. the Prime Minister
- c. the UN General Secretary

10) Who trumpeted the idea of “America for Americans” in the first half of the 1800s?

- a. nativists
- b. shipbuilders
- c. manufacturers
- d. trade unions

11) How do people protect the basic rights written in the Declaration of Independence?

- a. by supporting independence
- b. by breaking with Britain
- c. by accepting the Declaration of Independence
- d. by forming governments

12) John D. Rockefeller made millions in the oil business. He succeeded in part because ...

- a. he paid close attention to detail
- b. he was a shrewd businessman
- c. he was always trying to improve the quality of his oil
- d. he did all he could to snuff out competition

13) What helped the baby boom in the late 1940s and 1950s?

a. Offering low-interest rates to veterans to encourage the building boom

b. Improvements in health and medical care

c. The building of new schools

d. William Levitt's new way of building houses in the suburbs

14) What is the name of the oil tanker that caused a tremendous oil spill in Alaska on March 24, 1989?

a. Prince William

b. the Exxon Valdez

c. Alyeska

d. Exxon

15) What are three different areas for selecting Pulitzer Prize winners?

a. journalism, letters, music

b. journalism, art, design

c. mathematics, chemistry, physics

d. economics, history, literature

16) According to legendary descriptions, who contributed several deerskin bags of popcorn to the first Thanksgiving dinner?

a. Quadequina, the brother of Chief Massasoit

b. Montezuma, the Aztec emperor

c. Pocahontas, the daughter of Powhatan, an Indian chief

d. Samoset, a Pemaquid Indian who helped the Pilgrims

17) What is the wording along the bottom of the first coin issued by the U.S. government in 1789?

a. Time is money.

b. Mind your business.

c. Business before pleasure.

d. Money has no smell.

18) The stockade around an Iroquois village was typically ...

a. round in shape

b. square in shape

c. hexagonal in shape

d. octagonal in shape

19) On December 7, 1903 the Wright Brothers managed to get a power-driven plane in the air. How long was their first flight?

- a. 59 seconds
- b. 1 minute
- c. 30 seconds
- d. 12 seconds

20) In the United States, a pot luck party is _____.

- a. a party where everyone sings
- b. a party where everyone bangs on pots
- c. a party where everyone brings some food to share

21) In the United States on Thanksgiving, most Americans eat _____.

- a. chicken
- b. ham
- c. turkey

22) In the USA what is hung outside on doors on Christmas?

- a. A wreath
- b. A horseshoe
- c. A star

23) The Declaration of Independence was signed on

- a. July 4, 1986
- b. July 4, 1776
- c. July 4, 1492

24) Who was *not* a signer of the Declaration of Independence?

- a. John Adams
- b. Benjamin Franklin
- c. John Quincy Adams

25) Hawaii became the _____ state.

- a. 49th
- b. 50th
- c. 1st

26) The youngest man elected president in the United States was

- a. John F. Kennedy
- b. Bill Clinton
- c. Ronald Reagan

27) The American National Anthem is

- a. Dixie
- b. The Star Spangled Banner
- c. America, the Beautiful

28) The U.S. Constitution is

- a. the world's newest written constitution
- b. the world's longest constitution
- c. the world's oldest constitution

29) When did the Pilgrims arrive on the Mayflower in New World from Europe?

- a. 1621
- b. 1603
- c. 1620

30) What traditional dishes are served on the Thanksgiving holiday?

- a. Stuffed turkey and pumpkin pie.
- b. Roast turkey and plum pudding.
- c. Stuffed turkey and apple pie.

31) What US president made Thanksgiving a national holiday?

- a. John Adams
- b. George Washington
- c. Abraham Lincoln

32) Who drew up the Declaration of Independence, which was adopted on July 4th, 1776?

- a. Thomas Jefferson
- b. John Adams
- c. Benjamin Franklin

- 33) What American city was called the "Cradle of Liberty"?
- a. Boston
 - b. Philadelphia
 - c. Chicago
- 34) Who wrote the verses to "America, the Beautiful" in 1893?
- a. Ralph Waldo Emerson
 - b. Katharina Lee Bates
 - c. Helen Hunt Jackson
- 35) What is the motto of the state Florida?
- a. "In God We Trust"
 - b. "Nothing Without God"
 - c. "Under God, the People Rule"
- 36) 1. Hollywood is situated in
- a. - Kansas.
 - b. - California.
 - c. - Ohio.
 - d. - Washington.
- 37). When were the boundaries of Hollywood area defined?
- a. - On March 10, 2000.
 - b. - On February 16, 2005.
 - c. - On August 28, 2006.
 - d. - On November 5, 1995.
- 38) 3. When did the construction of the first studio begin?
- a. - In 1621.
 - b. - In 1910.
 - c. - In 1980.
 - d. - In 1909.
- 39) 4. What is the height of Hollywood sign?
- a. 50 meters
 - b. 15 meters.
 - c. 12 meters
 - d. 25 meters

40) 5. Hollywood Wax Museum was opened

- a. - in 1940.
- b. - in 1955
- c. - in 1965
- d. - in 1980

41). Which film company has its studio in Hollywood?

- a. - Kodak.
- b. - Vermont.
- c. - Paramount.
- d. - Biograph Company.

42) 7. Who designed the Hollywood Walk of Fame?

- a. - Oliver Weistmuller.
- b. - Albert Spaulding.
- c. - Andrew Lloyd Webber.
- d. - Oliver Stone.

43). When was the first star awarded on the Hollywood Walk of Fame?

- a. - October 25, 1997
- b. - May 9, 1945
- c. - January 19, 1965
- d. - February 9, 1960

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- a. Queen Elizabeth II
- b. the Prime Minister
- c. the UN General Secretary

53) 1. When did London first appear in history?

- a. - AD 43
- b. - AD 15
- c. - AD 1024
- d. - BC 205

54). When did the city become a capital?

- a. - in 18th century
- b. - in 14th century
- c. - in 10th century
- d. - in 20th century

55). Who built the Defensive London Wall between 190 and 223 AD?

- a. - Romans
- b. - British
- c. - French
- d. - Saxons

56). What year is considered to be the beginning of Medieval?

- a. - 1078
- b. - 1276
- c. - 1499
- d. - 1066

57). What famous building of London was built in 616?

- a. - St. Margaret's Church
- b. - St. Paul's Cathedral
- c. - Big Ben
- d. - Westminster Abbey

58). Who became King of all England by 878?

- a. - King Alfred The Great
- b. - King Edward
- c. - King Charles II
- d. - King James I

59) Who was awarded the Nobel Prize for literature?

- a. John Galsworthy
- b. Herbert Wells
- c. Bernard Shaw

d. Karl Marks

60) When was The Great Fire of London?

- a. - on September 2, 1666
- b. - on September 24, 1514
- c. - on November 1, 1916
- d. - on July 17, 1200

61). When did London host Summer Olympic Games?

- a. - in 1900
- b. - in 1908
- c. - in 1838
- d. - in 1980

62). The Present Queen has reigned since:

- a. 1952
- b. 1962
- c. 1972
- d. 1982

63). Great Britain is:

- a. Absolute Monarchy
- b. Constitutional Monarchy
- c. Parliament Republic
- d. President Republic

64). Judges are appointed by:

- a. The Home secretary
- b. The Prime Minister
- c. The Queen High
- d. The Lord Chancellor

65). What is the Kirk:

- a. the main church in Northern Ireland
- b. the other name of the church of Scotland
- c. a protestant denomination based in Wales
- d. the name often given to Roman Catholics in Britain

66). What is the name and dates of the National Day of Wales:

- a. St. George Day, 23 April
- b. St. Andrew Day, 30 November
- c. St. Francis Day, 19 June
- d. St. David Day, 1 March

67). When did Britain join the European Economic Community:

- a. in 1968
- b. in 1973
- c. in 1982
- d. in 1988

68). When was the Kingdom of Great Britain created:

- a. 1707, 1 May
- b. 1812, 31 July
- c. 1925, 10 December
- d. 1574, 12 March

69) When was the first Christmas tree introduced to Britain?

- a. about 1920
- b. about 1650
- c. about 1830
- d. about 1870

70) Who made the Christmas tree popular in Britain?

- a. Father Christmas
- b. Queen Victoria
- c. Good King Wenceslas
- d. Queen Elizabeth II

71) Which of these things would you not use to decorate your house at X-mas time?

- a. punch
- b. mistletoe
- c. streamers
- d. holly

72) Which of these things would you find on your plate at Christmas?

- a. trinkets
- b. tapers
- c. ivy
- d. sweetmeat

73) Where does the tradition of decorating a house with mistletoe at Christmas come from?

- a. Germany
- b. the Druids
- c. Bohemia
- d. Turkey

74) Who wrote novels of romance under the pseudonym Mary Westmacott?

- a. Jane Austen
- b. Charlotte Bronte
- c. Agatha Christie

75) Which of the books is loosely based on the adventures of a sailor Alexander Selkirk?

- a. "Robinson Crusoe" by D. Defoe.
- b. "Treasure Island" by R. L. Stevenson.
- c. "Gulliver's Travels" by J. Swift.

76) Who is the author of the collection of romances "The Death of Arthur"?

- a. Sir Thomas Malory
- b. Thomas More
- c. Geoffrey Chaucer

77) What country did the main action of the tragedy "Othello" by Shakespeare take place?

- a. Spain
- b. Malta
- c. Cyprus

78) Who wrote the novel "Vanity Fair"?

- a. William Thackeray
- b. Charles Dickens
- c. Wilkie Collins

DO YOU KNOW AUSTRALIA

1. There are 6 states and 2 territories in Australia. Could you name them and mark them on a map. Could you draw a map of Australia?

2. Which three animals or birds do you associate with Australia? Could you draw them?

3. There is the biggest collection of corals in the world not far from the eastern coast of Australian continent. Can you name it?

4. Which Australian city was its first capital?

5. When did Canberra become the capital of the country?

6. Do you know what the word "Canberra" mean in one of the Aboriginal languages?

7. Who is the official head of Australia?

8. When was there "gold rush" in Australia?

9. Name the capitals of the six Australian states.

10. Which political parties of Australia do you know?

11. Which Australian city suffered in the World War II of bombing and later was practically destroyed by a hurricane?

12. Name the deserts of the Australian continent.

13. Which Australian river could be called "Australian Volga" or "Australian Mississippi"?

14. Which Australian universities do you know?

15. How many aborigines are there in Australia now and do they all speak one and the same language?

16. Which is Australia's official language?

17. Where does Australian parliament sit?

18. Name the most famous Australian soprano singer.

19. There is a variety of football which Australians consider their national. How is it called?

20. Which kind of sports do you associate with Australia?

21. Who is the official representative of the Queen in Australia?
22. Which group of stars can one see on the Australian flag?
23. Which superstition is connected in Australia with a twig of wattle (acacia)?
24. Which 2 most common plants in Australia can you name?
25. How cold is it at X-mas and New Year Day in Australia?
26. Which gem could be considered Australian national and why?
27. Which is the most loved and photographed of Australian marsupials?
28. Sing the tune of Waltzing Matilda.
29. What does "koala" mean in an Aboriginal language?
30. Which domestic animal could symbolize Australia?

DO YOU KNOW NEW ZEALAND

1. There are two large islands in New Zealand, one smaller island and a number of small islands. Could you name these two large islands and a smaller one and mark them on a map. Could you draw a map of New Zealand?
2. Which three animals or birds do you associate with New Zealand? Could you draw them?
3. When did Wellington become the capital of the country?
4. Do you know what the word "Aotearoa" means in the Maori language?
5. Who is the official head of New Zealand?
6. When was there "gold rush" in New Zealand?
7. Name the first capital of New Zealand.
8. Which political parties of New Zealand do you know?
9. Which strait separates the two main islands of New Zealand?
10. Name three volcanoes in New Zealand.
11. Why is New Zealand called a country which was discovered three times?
12. Which New Zealand universities can you name?
13. How many Maoris are there in New Zealand now and do they all speak one and the same language?
14. Is there an official language in New Zealand?
15. Where does New Zealand parliament sit?
16. Name the most famous New Zealand soprano singer.

17. There is a variety of football which New Zealanders consider their national. How is it called?
18. Which kind of sports do you associate with New Zealand?
19. Who is the official representative of the Queen in New Zealand?
20. Which group of stars can one see on the New Zealand's flag?
21. Which sea separates New Zealand and Australia?
22. Can one see deer in New Zealand?
23. How cold is it at X-mas and New Year Day in New Zealand?
24. Which gem could be considered New Zealand national stone and why?
25. Which big flightless bird lived in New Zealand many centuries ago?
26. Which Maori dances can you name?
27. What is a hangi?
28. What bird symbolizes New Zealand?

KEYS QUIZ

1	a	2	a	3	a	4	a	5	a	6	a	7	a	8	a	9	a	10	a
11	d	12	a	13	b	14	b	15	a	16	a	17	b	18	c	19	d	20	c
21	c	22	a	23	b	24	c	25	b	26	a	27	b	28	c	29	c	30	a
31	c	32	a	33	a	34	b	35	a	36	b	37	c	38	d	39	b	40	c
41	c	42	a	43	d	44	a	45	a	46	a	47	a	48	a	49	a	50	a
51	a	52	a	53	a	54	b	55	a	56	d	57	d	58	a	59	a	60	a
61	b	62	a	63	b	64	d	65	b	66	d	67	b	68	a	69	c	70	b
71	a	72	d	73	b	74	c	75	a	76	a	77	c	78	a				

COMPETITIONS

DO YOU KNOW AUSTRALIA

1. New South Wales (NSW), Queensland (QLD), South Australia (SA), Tasmania (Tas), Victoria (Vic), Western Australia (WA), Australian Capital Territory (ACT), Northern Territory (NT). 2. koala, kangaroo, emu (kookaburra, echidna, galah, lyrebird, black swan, platypus, cockatoo, parrot, anteater). 3. The Great Barrier Reef. 4. Melbourne. 5. In 1927. 6. meeting place. 7. Queen Elizabeth II. 8. 1851. 9. Sydney, Brisbane, Adelaide, Hobart, Melbourne, Perth. 10. The Australian Labor Party, the Australian Democrats, the Liberal Party, the National Party of Australia. 11. Darwin. 12. Great Sandy Desert; Great Victoria Desert, Simpson Desert. 13. The Darling (2.740 km). 14. About 40: among them Australian National University, Curtin University of Technology, University of New South Wales, Murdoch University, Monash University, University of Wollongong, University of Southern Queensland, University of Western Australia, Swinburne University of Technology, Macquarie, LaTrobe, Flinders, Griffith, Newcastle, Wollongong, New England, James Cook, Deakin Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology, University of Technology, Sydney, University of South Australia (S.A.I.T.), Queensland University of Technology, Victoria University of Technology Canberra, Bond University, Charles Sturt University, etc. 15. About 1,5%, many languages. 16. English. 17. Canberra. 18. Nellie Melba. 19. Australian Rules. 20. Australian Rules, Surfing, bushwalking, horse racing, tennis, cricket, etc. 21. Governor-general. 22. Southern Cross. 23. According to a

superstition a twig of blooming wattle (acacia) brought into a house is bad luck. 24. Gum (eucalyptus), wattle (acacia). 25. It's very hot. 26. Opal. 27. Koala. 29. No water. 30. Sheep.

DO YOU KNOW NEW ZEALAND

1. The North Island, The South Island, Steward Island. 2. Kiwi, Kakapo, tui. 3. In 1865. 4. The Land of the Long White Cloud. 5. Queen Elizabeth II of Great Britain. 6. In the 1860s. 7. Russell. 8. The National party and the Labour party and more than 20 minor parties. 9. The Cook Strait. 10. Egmont, Tangariro, Ruapehu. 11. It was discovered than a thousand years ago by the Maori people, than by the Dutch navigator Abel Tasman in 1642, and the English explorer James Cook in 1769. 12. There are seven universities: 8 The Massey University, Auckland, Canterbury, Otago, Victoria and Waikato, Lincoln. 13. Maoris constitute about 12 percent of the population. They speak several dialects of one and the same language. 14. There are two official languages : English and Maori. 15. In Wellington, in the Beehive. 16. Kiri Te Kanawa. 17. Yes, there is. It's Rugby football. 18. Rugby Union, cricket, tramping, tennis, etc. 19. Governor-general. 20. The Southern Cross constellation. 21. The Tasman Sea. 22. Yes, one can deer in New Zealand. 23. It is hot at X-mas and New Year Day in New Zealand. 24. Nephrite or green-stone. Maori use this gem for jewelry and carving. 25. Moa-bird. 26. Haka, poi dance. 27. It is a Maori oven and a meal cooked in it. 28. Kiwi bird.

GLOSSARY

anthem musical composition to be sung in churches;

Accent individual, local or national way of pronouncing

AD (Anno Domini) in the year of the Lord

background person's past experiences, education, environment

bagpipe musical instrument with air stored in a wind-bag held under one arm and pressed out through pipes in which there are reeds

bilingual speaking, using two languages

bill the special name for a proposal before it becomes law

bishop Christian clergyman of high rank who organizes the work of the Church in a city or district

boundary dividing line; line that marks a limit

break a pause for rest between lessons

chamber room; office; (hall used by a) group of legislators (eg in G8, the House of Commons)

colony country, territory, controlled, administered, and (often) developed by another

Continental Europe the part of Europe that excludes the British Isles

county an administrative area of the UK

currency money that is actually in use in a country

curriculum course of study in a school, college, etc.

degree a university qualification

density the quality of being crowded together in great numbers

dialect form of a language (grammar, vocabulary, pronunciation) used in a part of a country or by a class of people

domestic science cookery and housekeeping

drought continuous period of dry weather; want of rain

extinction making, being, becoming, extinct, i.e. no longer in existence; having died out

famine extreme scarcity of food in a region

hereditary peer a lord who has gained his title by birth

hurricane violent windstorm

immigrate to come and live in a new country

inherit receive property, a title, as heir

life peer a lord who has gained his title by birth a lord whose title will not be inherited by his children

metropolis chief city of a country, capital

invader a person or thing that enters a country with armed forces in order to attack

island piece of land surrounded by water

LEA the Local Education Authority

marsh (area of) low-lying, wet land

kilt of male dress in the Scottish Highlands

mediaeval of the period of history between 1100 and 1500, the Middle Ages

moor open, uncultivated land, covered with heather

oppression ruling unjustly or cruelly; keeping down by unjust or cruel government

patron saint a saint who is strongly associated with a particular country

pollution making dirty, destroying the purity

race any of several subdivisions of mankind sharing certain physical characteristics, colour of skin, colour and type of hair, shape of eyes and nose

pilgrim person who travels to a sacred place

pilgrimage journey of a pilgrim

public school a private school for pupils aged 13-18

selective schools a school which pupils must pass certain exams

set a group of pupils who form a class in a particular subject

sovereign ruler, e.g. a king, queen or emperor

tuition fee teaching costs

tutor a teacher in a college or university who leads a discussion group

tutorial classes period of instruction given by a college tutor university student working for a bachelor's degree

Whitsun 7th Sunday after Easter

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